MONTHLY CURRENT AFFAIRS MAGAZINE

AUGUST 2026



- Detailed release for all exams
- Static GK points included
- Category-wise Compilation
- Live Table of Content

Contents

Important Days **4**
In Table 4
With Static 5
Books **12**
In Table 12
With Static 12
Appointments **14**
Appointments (National) 14
Appointments (International) 17
Awards **19**
Awards (National) 19
Awards (International) 27
Obituaries **30**
National **31**
Eminent Personality in News 47
State **50**
Ladakh 50
Jammu & Kashmir 50
Himachal Pradesh 51
Punjab 52
Delhi 52
Uttar Pradesh 54
Madhya Pradesh 57
Jharkhand 57
Odisha 58
West Bengal 58
Arunachal Pradesh 59
Meghalaya 60
Rajasthan 60
Gujarat 60
Maharashtra 60
Goa 61
Telangana 62
Andhra Pradesh 63
Karnataka 63

Kerala 64
Tamil Nadu 65
Andaman & Nicobar 66
Defence 67
Military Exercises 67
Other Defence News 68
Science & Technology 74
Environment 82
Index/rankings/reports 91
International 92
Sports 96
National/ International Championships 96
Commonwealth Games 2026: Highlights & Milestones 97
Tennis 99
Table Tennis 99
Badminton 100
Squash 101
Cricket 101
Chess 102
Football 103
Athletics 104
Miscellaneous 104
Banking / Finance 105

Important Days

In Table

Date	Day	Theme
1 August	World Wide Web Day	
1 August	National Mountain Climbing Day	
1 August	World Lung Cancer Day	
1–7 August	World Breastfeeding Week	Breastfeeding for a Sustainable Start in Life: Strengthen What Works
2 August (First Sunday of August)	Friendship Day	
3 August	Cloves Syndrome Awareness Day	
4 August	International Clouded Leopard Day	
6 August	International Day of Awareness of the Special Development Needs and Challenges of Landlocked Developing Countries	
6 August	Hiroshima Day	
7 August	National Handloom Day	
7 August	National Javelin Day	
8 August	Quit India Movement Day	
9 August	World Tribal Day	Honouring Indigenous Midwives: Safeguarding Life and Well-being
9 August	Nagasaki Day	
10 August	World Lion Day	
10 August	World Biofuel Day	
11 August	World Steelpan Day	
12 August	International Youth Day	Different Contexts, Common Aspirations
12 August	World Elephant Day	
13 August	World Organ Donation Day	
13 August	International Lefthanders Day	
14 August	Partition Horrors Remembrance Day	
15 August	Independence Day	
19 August	World Photography Day	
12 August – 26 August	World Photography Week	
19 August	World Humanitarian Day	Honouring fallen humanitarians and calling for greater protection of health care
20 August	Nepali Language Constitutional Recognition Day	
20 August	Manipuri Language Day	
20 August	World Mosquito Day	
20 August	Sadbhavna Diwas	
20 August	Indian Akshay Urja Day	
21 August	International Day of Remembrance and Tribute to the Victims of Terrorism	Healing Through Memory
21 August	World Senior Citizens' Day	The Age of Longevity: Rethinking Systems for Longer Lives
21 August	World Entrepreneurs' Day	
22 August	Madras Day	
22 August	International Day Commemorating the Victims of Acts of Violence Based on Religion or Belief	

23 August	National Space Day	Towards Viksit Bharat: Innovating, Collaborating and Aspiring to Global Space Leadership
23 August	International Day for the Remembrance of the Slave Trade and its Abolition	
24 August	Kolkata Day	
26 August	Women's Equality Day	
26 August	International Dog Day	
27 August	World Lake Day	Lakes: the lifeblood of our planet
23 - 27 August	World Water Week 2026	Water for People and Progress
28 August	World Sanskrit Day	
29 August	National Sports Day	Khelega Bharat, Jeetega Bharat" (India Will Play, India Will Win)
29 August	International Day against Nuclear Tests	
30 August	Small Industry Day	

With Static

1 August – World Wide Web Day



- to commemorate the **invention of the World Wide Web by Tim Berners-Lee in 1989**
- By the end of 1990, **Berners-Lee** had successfully **developed the first web server and web browser at CERN**

1 August - World Lung Cancer Day

- **Established in 2012** by the Forum of International Respiratory Societies (FIRS)
- **Purpose**: To educate the **public on lung cancer prevention, symptom recognition, screening** (especially for high-risk individuals), treatment advances, and to combat stigma associated with the disease

Ministry of Women & Child Development to Observe World Breastfeeding Week 2026 from 1st–7th August

- **Since 1992** World Breastfeeding Week is celebrated every year in the **first week of August (1–7 August),** championed **by WHO, UNICEF**
- **THEME: Breastfeeding for a Sustainable Start in Life: Strengthen What Works**

3 August - Cloves Syndrome Awareness Day

- To spread awareness about the rare genetic disorder.
- It is a **rare genetic disorder** which causes enlargement of fatty tissues, vascular malformations, and other skin and **skeletal abnormalities.**
- One gene termed **PIK3CA mutation** is the main cause of Cloves.

4 August International Clouded Leopard Day

- International Clouded Leopard Day 2026 was observed on 2026.
- It **started in 2018 by The Aspinall Foundation and in the same year Howletts Wild Animal Park was the venue of the first celebration of this day.**

6 August Hiroshima Day

- to commemorate the **anniversary of the atomic bombing of Hiroshima**, Japan, by the US during **World War II** on **August 6th, 1945.**
- In 1945, during World War II, the **US dropped an atomic bomb called "Little Boy," on Hiroshima using the B-29 bomber Enola Gay**.

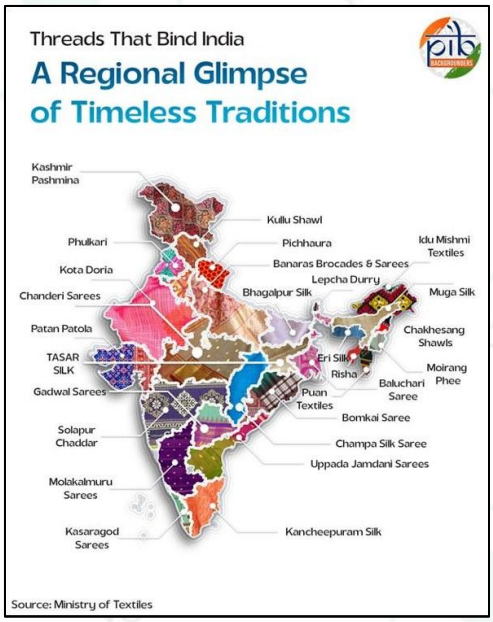
▪ On **August 9, 1945**, the US dropped a second atomic bomb, **"Fat Man" on Nagasaki.** This led to Japan's surrender and **marked the end of World War II.**



6 August International Day of Awareness of the Special Development Needs and Challenges of Landlocked Developing Countries

▪ The **first celebration of this Day** took place **during the Third Conference on** Landlocked Developing Countries in 2025 (**LLDC3**) in Awaza, **Turkmenistan from August 5-8, 2025**

7 August - National Handloom Day



▪ In a tribute to **Swadeshi Movement, which was launched on August 7, 1905**, at Town Hall, Kolkata

▪ **Government of India declared** August 7 as National Handloom Day **in 2015.**

▪ **The Ministry of Textiles** will celebrate the 12th National Handloom Day on 7 August 2026 with a national function at the Rashtrapati Bhavan Cultural Centre (RBCC), New Delhi

▪ The occasion will also witness the release of **four commemorative postage stamps** celebrating India's rich and diverse handloom weaving traditions.

▪ **Two publications—"Earth. Root. Thread – Aal Dyed Handloom Textiles of Central India**" and **the Handloom Awards Book 2025**—will also be unveiled during the function.

7 August National Javelin Day

▪ National Javelin Day is celebrated annually in India on August 7.

▪ **It honors Neeraj Chopra and his historic gold medal win with a throw of 87.58 meters at the Tokyo 2020 Olympics on August 7, 2021**

▪ From 2022 onwards, the date - August 7 - was instituted as the official javelin throw day in India by the Athletics Federation of India (AFI)

8 August – Quit India Movement Day

▪ The Quit India Movement, **launched on August 8, 1942**, under Mahatma Gandhi's leadership, was a significant anti-colonial struggle.

▪ **Gandhi's slogan, "Do or Die,".**

▪ Also called the "**August Kranti Movement,".**

▪ The background of the Quit India Movement lies in the **failure of the Cripps Mission**, economic hardships during World War II, and rising nationalist sentiments from earlier movements like **Civil Disobedience and the demand for Purna Swaraj.**

▪ The All India Congress Committee met at **Gowalia Tank, Bombay, on 8 August 1942** and passed the famous Quit India Resolution.

August 9 World Tribal Day

▪ Also referred to as **World Indigenous Day or International Day of World's Indigenous People**

▪ Observed to support and protect the rights of the world's indigenous people.

▪ The origins of the International Day of the World's Indigenous People date back to **December 1994, when the United Nations General Assembly designated** 9 August for this annual observance.

- 2026 **Theme: "Honouring Indigenous Midwives: Safeguarding Life and Well-being"**

9 August Nagasaki Day

- to commemorate the tragic atomic bombing of Nagasaki, Japan, by the United States during World War II in 1945
- **Bomb: "Fat Man" (plutonium-based)**
- Immediate deaths: Approx. **40,000**; total by end of 1945: **~73,000**

10 August World Lion Day

- Aims to raise awareness about the conservation and protection of lions worldwide.
- In Gujarat, the Asiatic are found only in the Saurashtra region.
- **As Gujarat's Lion Census of 2025 records a historic 891 lions statewide**



About Asiatic Lion:

- **Habitat:** Grasslands, savannas, dense scrub, and open woodlands.
  - Concentrated in the **Gir National Park and Wildlife Sanctuary (Gujarat)**.
  - **Barda Wildlife Sanctuary** has emerged as a **"second home"** for lions.
- **IUCN Status: Vulnerable.**
- Listed in **Schedule I** and **IV** of Wildlife (Protection) Act 1972, in **Appendix I** of CITES.
- Asiatic lions are slightly smaller than African lions.
- **International Big Cats Alliance (IBCA):** Launched in 2023, includes lions.

10 August World Biofuel Day

- To promote the use of biofuels as a sustainable alternative to fossil fuels.
- In India, the **Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas** and the **Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change** started celebrating World Biofuel Day from **2015 onwards.**
- **On August 10, 1893**, **Sir Rudolf Diesel** successfully ran his engine using **peanut oil**, demonstrating for the first time that vegetable oil could power engines.
- The Global Biofuels Alliance **(GBA) launched at the G20 Summit 2023** positions India as a global leader in ethanol trade and technology.

12 August International Youth Day

- **Theme 2026 - Different Contexts, Common Aspirations**
- In 1999 the UN General Assembly declared August 12 as International Youth Day
- **First celebration** took place on **August 12, 2000.**
- **National Youth Day**, also known as Vivekananda Jayanti, is celebrated annually on **12 January,** being the birthday Swami Vivekananda.

12 August World Elephant Day

- On **August 12, 2012**, the **inaugural World Elephant Day** was launched to bring attention to the urgent plight of Asian and African elephants.
- India is home to nearly 60% of the world's wild elephant population, with **33 Elephant Reserves and 150 identified Elephant Corridors**
- Elephant - **National Heritage Animal**
- **Asian elephants** (Indian) are classified as **Endangered on the IUCN Red List**



13 August World Organ Donation Day

- To raise awareness about the importance of organ donation and to make people aware of the misconceptions of organ donation.
- Ronald Lee Herrick was the first person to donate his organ **in 1954,** and **Dr Joseph Murray** was the doctor who carried out **this successful organ transplantation** process.

▪ Later **in 1990, He was honoured with Nobel Prize in Physiology and Medicine** for bringing advances in organ transplantation.

14 August Partition Horrors Remembrance Day

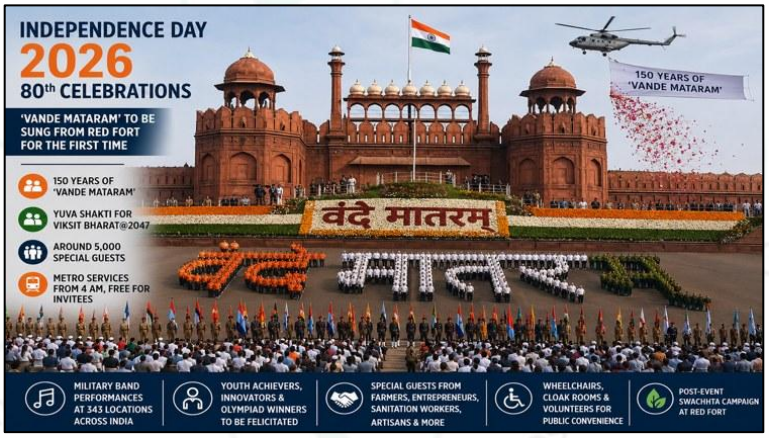
▪ Government declared 14th August as Partition Horrors Remembrance Day **(Vibhajan Vibhishika Smriti Diwas) in 2021**.

▪ 14th August is a day **to honor those who lost their lives** or **were displaced** during the partition.

Independence Day Celebrations 2026

▪ India celebrated its **80th Independence Day on August 15,** with a s**pecial focus on the 150th anniversary of 'Vande Mataram'** and the contribution of youth towards building a 'Viksit Bharat' by 2047.

▪ Prime Minister Narendra Modi led the celebrations at the historic Red Fort, **where he hoisted the National Flag and addressed the nation.**



▪ **For the first time, 'Vande Mataram' was sung from the ramparts of the Red Fort as the Prime Minister arrived at the venue.**

▪ Around 2,500 boys and girls from the National Cadet Corps (NCC) and My Bharat volunteers formed the words 'वंदे मातरम्' on Gyanpath opposite the rampart.

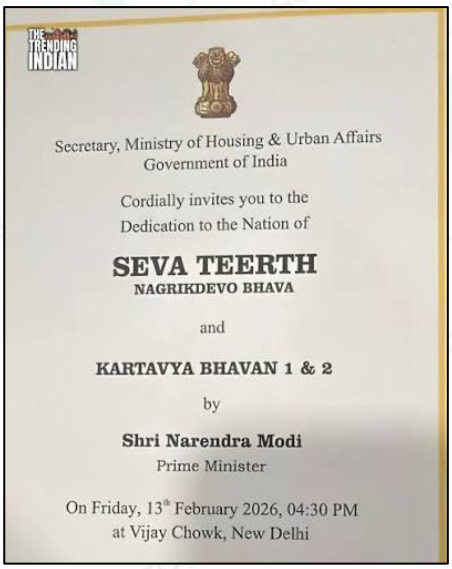
▪ **An Indian Air Force (IAF) Mi-17 helicopter** carried a banner commemorating 150 years **of 'Vande Mataram**' and showered flower petals over the gathering.

▪ **Beneficiaries of schemes such as NAMASTE, PM AJAY and SEED attended the ceremony.**

▪ The **guest list** also included **women entrepreneurs supported under PM Mudra Yojana, PMAY (Urban) beneficiaries, scientists and innovators, Bharat Taxi drivers, PM Surya Ghar Muft Bijli Yojana beneficiaries, artisans covered under PM Vishwakarma,** and farmers performing well under government schemes.

▪ **A cleanliness campaign was conducted** at the Red Fort after the ceremony, **involving NCC cadets and My Bharat volunteers.**

▪ The initiative focused on systematic plogging and prompt removal of waste after spectators left the venue.



'**Seva Teerth'(<u>Executive Enclave</u>)** featured on invitation cards

▪ This year's invitation cards feature '**Seva Teerth', which Prime Minister Modi recently dedicated to the nation.**

▪ The design seeks to highlight the values of duty, compassion, commitment and the principle of 'Nation First'.

19 August World Humanitarian Day

▪ To honour humanitarian workers who risk their lives to help people in crises

▪ **Theme - "Honouring fallen humanitarians and calling for greater protection of health care.".**

▪ The day was **designated by the United Nations General Assembly in 2009** in memory of the 2003 bombing of the UN headquarters in Baghdad, Iraq, which killed 22 people

20 August 35th Nepali Language Constitutional Recognition Day

▪ The 35th Nepali Language Constitutional Recognition Day (Nepali Bhasha Manyata Diwas) was celebrated across India on August 20, 2026.

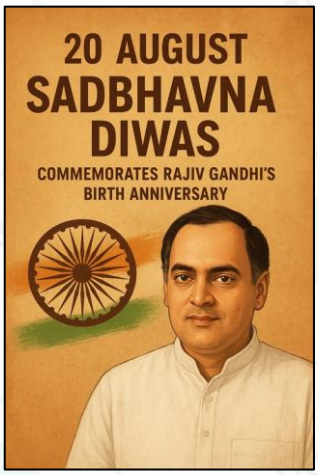
▪ The day marks the historic inclusion of the Nepali language in the Eighth Schedule of the Indian Constitution via the 71st Constitutional Amendment in 1992.

20 August 35th Manipuri Language Day

▪ The 35th Manipuri Language Day was celebrated across the State on August 20, commemorating the **inclusion of Manipuri language in the Eighth Schedule of the Constitution of India on 20th August, 1992.**
▪ The State-level event was held at the Jawaharlal Nehru Manipur Dance Academy (JNMDA) in Imphal under **the theme "State Song 'Sana Leibak Manipur' for Peace, Unity and Integrity".**
▪ Eighth Schedule lists the official languages of the republic of India. **Part XVII of the Indian constitution deals with the official languages in Articles 343 to 351.**
▪ **The Eighth Schedule** to the Constitution consists of the following **22 languages:**
▪ Assamese, Bengali, Gujarati, Hindi, Kannada, Kashmiri, Konkani, Malayalam, Manipuri, Marathi, Nepali, Oriya, Punjabi,Sanskrit, Sindhi, Tamil, Telugu, Urdu, Bodo, Santhali, Maithili and Dogri.
▪ Of these languages, **14 were initially included in the Constitution**.
▪ **Sindhi language was added by the 21st Amendment Act of 1967.**
▪ **Konkani, Manipuri, and Nepali** were included by the **71st Amendment Act of 1992.**
▪ **Bodo, Dogri, Maithili, and Santhali** were added by the **92nd Amendment Act of 2003** which came into force in 2004.

20 August - World Mosquito Day

▪ to raise awareness about the dangers of mosquito -borne diseases such as malaria, dengue, Zika, yellow fever, and chikungunya.
▪ The day commemorates the **discovery made by Sir Ronald Ross in 1897**, who established that **female Anopheles mosquitoes transmit malaria.**



20 August - Sadbhavna Diwas

▪ This national observance commemorates the **birth anniversary of former Prime Minister Rajiv Gandhi**, who was born on **August 20, 1944**, and served as the **sixth Prime Minister of India from 1984 to 1989.**
▪ He became the **youngest Indian prime minister at the age of 40**, succeeding his mother, then–Prime Minister Indira Gandhi, after her assassination.

20 August - Indian Akshay Urja Day

▪ to underscore the significance of renewable energy sources and to highlight the strides India has made in advancing the same.
▪ The **word 'Akshay' is derived from Sanskrit, which means "eternal",** "indestructible" or "imperishable".
▪ **Initiated in 2004** by the **Ministry of New and Renewable Energy,**
▪ the observance provides an opportunity to showcase **India's commitment to renewable energy transition** as it aims at achieving **500 GW of installed electricity capacity from non-fossil fuel by 2030.**

21 August International Day of Remembrance and Tribute to the Victims of Terrorism

▪ In 2017, the General Assembly, established the the day
▪ This year's theme: **Healing Through Memory**

21 August World Senior Citizens' Day

▪ To acknowledge the contributions of senior citizens and to raise awareness about the issues they face globally
▪ **2026 Theme: The Age of Longevity: Rethinking Systems for Longer Lives**

21 August World Entrepreneurs' Day

▪ honours the creativity, dedication, and risk-taking spirit of entrepreneurs around the globe.

22 August Madras Day

- Madras Day 2026 is observed every year on August 22 to commemorate the founding of Madras, now Chennai.
- The occasion marks the **1639 grant through which the East India Company acquired land at Madraspatnam from local rulers.**
- The annual observance was initiated in 2004. Madras Day celebrations focus on the city's history, heritage and evolution.

23 August - National Space Day

- India celebrated its **first National Space Day in 2024**
- Commemorates the **soft-landing** of **Vikram Lander** of **Chandrayaan-3** mission on the lunar surface on **August 23, 2023** (The landing site was named as **'Shiv Shakti' point.**
- **Theme 2026 : Towards Viksit Bharat: Innovating, Collaborating and Aspiring to Global Space Leadership**

ISRO FACTS:

- **Established: 15 August 1969**
- **Founder: Dr. Vikram Sarabhai** (Father of Indian Space Program)
- HQ: **Bengaluru, Karnataka**
- ISRO was previously the Indian National Committee for Space Research (INCOSPAR), set up by the Government of India in 1962, as envisioned by Dr. VikramA Sarabhai.

Key ISRO Missions

- **Aryabhata (1975):** First Indian satellite (launched from USSR).
- **SLV-3 (1980):** First satellite launch from India (Rohini satellite).
- **Chandrayaan-1 (2008):** First Moon mission; discovered water molecules on lunar surface.
- **Mangalyaan / MOM (2013):** First interplanetary mission to Mars; India became the **1st Asian nation** and **4th in the world** to reach Mars orbit.
- **Chandrayaan-2 (2019):** Attempted soft landing near Moon's south pole (orbiter successful).
- **Chandrayaan-3 (2023):** Successful soft landing on Moon's south pole – **India became the 1st country to do so.**
- **Aditya-L1 (2023):** India's first solar mission.
- **XPoSat (2024):** India's first dedicated astronomy mission to study black holes.

23 August - International Day for the Remembrance of the Slave Trade and its Abolition

- **Proclaimed by: UNESCO** in **1997. First observed in 1998**
- The date **23 August 1791** marks the **uprising in Santo Domingo (now Haiti and the Dominican Republic)**.
- The revolt **led to the Haitian Revolution**, which played a crucial role in the **abolition of the transatlantic slave trade**.
- It symbolizes **freedom, human rights, and dignity**.

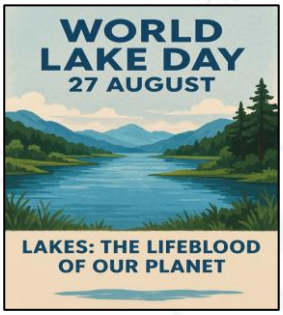
24 August Kolkata Day

- Kolkata, the capital city of West Bengal, celebrates its birthday on August 24 every year.
- Calcutta, an Anglicized version of the Bengali name Kolikata.
- **British merchant Job Charnock founded the city on August 24, 1690, merging three villages — Gobindapur, Sutanuti and Kolikata.**
- On January 1, 2001, Calcutta was officially renamed as Kolkata.

26 August - Women's Equality Day

- **Annual event in the United States,** observed on August 26 since its **inception in 1971**, marking American women's advancements toward equality with men
- **August 26, 1970**, marked the **50th anniversary** of the passage of the **Nineteenth Amendment to the U.S. Constitution, which granted full woman suffrage.**

27 August World Lake Day



- **2026 Theme: Lakes: the lifeblood of our planet**
- **2025 is the first observance** of World Lake Day.
- World Lake Day aims to raise awareness of the importance of lakes and the sustainable management of lake and related ecosystems.
- The **UN Environment Programme (UNEP)** will facilitate the observance of the Day.

23 - 27 August World Water Week 2026

- World Water Week 2026 took place from 23 to 27 August under the theme of **"Water for People and Progress", in Stockholm**
- convening policymakers, practitioners, researchers and civil society to advance solutions for a more just and water-secure future.
- Organized by the **Stockholm International Water Institute (SIWI).**

29 August - National Sports Day

- marks **hockey legend Major Dhyan Chand's birth anniversary**. The day has been nationally **recognised since 2012** and served as the launch platform for the Fit India Movement in 2019.
- **Celebration Theme 2026 - "Khelega Bharat, Jeetega Bharat" (India Will Play, India Will Win).**

Major Dhyan Chand

- Major Dhyan Chand was a prominent **hockey player** in **India's pre-independence period.**
- He is famously known as the **"Wizard of Hockey"** and **"The Magician"** due to his stick work and understanding of the game.
- He played a key role in **India's first hat-trick of Olympic gold medals,** winning at the **1928, 1932, and 1936 Summer Olympics.**
- Between **1926 and 1948,** he played **185 matches** for India scoring over **400 goals.**
- He **retired as a Major** in the **Punjab Regiment of the Indian Army in 1956.**
- He received the **Padma Bhushan,** the third-highest civilian award in **1956.**
- To honour him, the Indian government renamed the **Rajiv Gandhi Khel Ratna Award** to the **Major Dhyan Chand Khel Ratna Award** in **2021.**

29 August International Day against Nuclear Tests

- In **2009, United Nations General Assembly declared** 29 August the International Day against Nuclear Tests
- **2010** marked the **inaugural commemoration** of the Day
- UNGA designated **26 September as the "International Day for the Total Elimination of Nuclear Weapons**
- **India** conducted **two nuclear** tests in 1998.

India Nuclear Weapon Programme

- **Smiling Buddha (1974)**: India's **first successful nuclear test**, conducted at **Pokhran in Rajasthan**, marking India as the **sixth nuclear-capable nation** after the **US, Soviet Union, United Kingdom, France,** and **China.**
- **Operation Shakti (1998)**: **(Pokhran-II)** was a series of **five nuclear tests** under **Operation Shakti**, including a **thermonuclear bomb**.

30 August Small Industry Day

- **India observes** National Small Industry Day every year on August 30 **to recognize the role played by small-scale industries (SSIs)**
- Celebrates the pivotal role of Micro, Small, and Medium Enterprises (MSMEs) in shaping economies
- The day was **first observed on August 30, 2001**
- The **United Nations General Assembly designated 27 June** as **"Micro-, Small, and Medium-sized Enterprises Day"**

Classification criteria for MSMEs

Types of Enterprises	Changes in Investment Limit	Changes in Turnover Limit
Micro Enterprises	Rs 1 crore to Rs 2.5 crore	Rs 5 crore to Rs 10 crore
Small Enterprises	Rs 10 crore to Rs 25 crore	Rs 50 crore to Rs 100 crore
Medium Enterprises	Rs 50 crore to Rs 125 crore	Rs 250 crore to Rs 500 crore

World Sanskrit Day

- World Sanskrit Day is observed on **Shravana Purnima** to celebrate Sanskrit and its extensive contribution to literature, philosophy, science, spirituality and India's broader intellectual heritage.
- In 2026 celebrated on **August 28**
- **Sanskrit Day is officially observed in India since 1969** when the Union Ministry of Education issued notifications for its celebration to the Central and State governments.
- Sanskrit **is one of the world's oldest classical languages** and has a vast literary tradition. **The Vedas, among India's oldest surviving texts, were composed in Vedic Sanskrit.**
- **Panini and Grammar:** The classical form of Sanskrit was systematically described by Panini in the **Ashtadhyayi.**
- Sanskrit literature includes major works such as the **Ramayana, Mahabharata, Abhijnanashakuntalam, Raghuvamsha, Kumarasambhava and Mricchakatika**.
- Important Sanskrit scholars and authors include **Panini, Patanjali, Kalidasa, Bhavabhuti and Ashvaghosha.**

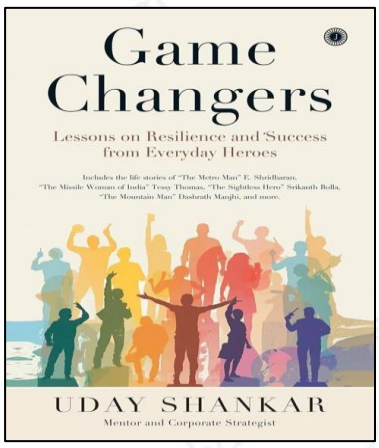
Books

In Table

Book	Author
Game Changers: Lessons on Resilience and Success from Everyday Heroes	Author : Uday Shankar Published by Jaico Publishing House
Triumph of the Indian Republic: My Life, My Struggles	President Ram Nath Kovind's autobiography
Janpriya Neta Venkaiah Naidu: Udayagiri Se Uparashtrapati Tak	Author : Y Lakshmi Prasad
Muslim Identity in Hindi Cinema – Poetics and Politics of Genre and Representation	Author : Mohammad Asim Siddiqui Published by Routledge
China's Wars: The Politics and Diplomacy Behind Its Military Coercion	Author: Vijay Gokhale
The Trees of My Country: A Natural History of India in 50 Trees	Author : T.R. Shankar Raman Illustrated by Manali Patil
Hindi science magazine 'Vigyan Pragati	By Council of Scientific and Industrial Research (CSIR)
Regime Change: Inside the Imperial Presidency of Donald Trump	Maggie Haberman and Jonathan Swan
Belonging: A Journey of Love	Sonia Gandhi's memoir
Sankalp Se Siddhi Ka Modi Yug	Shri Ghanshyam Tiwari

With Static

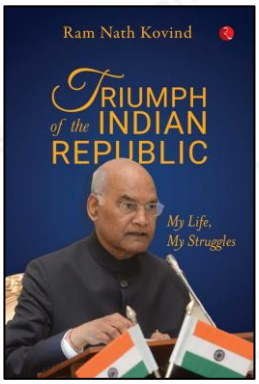
New book - Game Changers



- **Uday Shankar's new book, Game Changers: Lessons on Resilience and Success from Everyday Heroes**,
- **Published by Jaico Publishing House**
- the 236-page book chronicles the journeys of 18 self-made men and women who found success without privilege, influential connections or a safety net.

PM Modi Releases Ram Nath Kovind's Autobiography

- Prime Minister Narendra Modi will release former **President Ram Nath Kovind's**



autobiography, "Triumph of the Indian Republic: My Life, My Struggles," at a function at Vigyan Bhavan in New Delhi

- The autobiography presents a personal account of **Kovind's life journey, tracing his experiences from his early years through his public life and tenure as the 14th President of India.**
- Ram Nath Kovind **served as the 14th President of India from 25 July 2017 to 25 July 2022.**
- He was also the **Governor of Bihar from 2015 to 2017** before becoming President.

Hindi Biography of Former Vice President M Venkaiah Naidu released in national capital

- The Hindi biography of former Vice President M. Venkaiah Naidu, **titled "Janpriya Neta Venkaiah Naidu: Udayagiri Se Uparashtrapati Tak**"was officially released.
- It has been **written by former Rajya Sabha MP Y Lakshmi Prasad.**
- The book which chronicles the inspiring journey of former Vice President and former BJP National President M Venkaiah Naidu in public life and service to the nation is a meaningful effort to introduce readers to his ideas, struggles and contributions.

Book: Muslim Identity in Hindi Cinema – Poetics and Politics of Genre and Representation

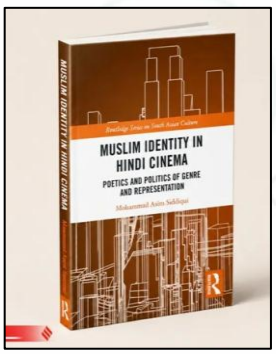
- **Muslim Identity in Hindi Cinema: Poetics and Politics of Genre and Representation by Mohammad Asim Siddiqui**
- is a comprehensive academic monograph that analyzes how Bollywood constructs, marginalizes, and weaponizes Muslim identity.
- **Published by Routledge**

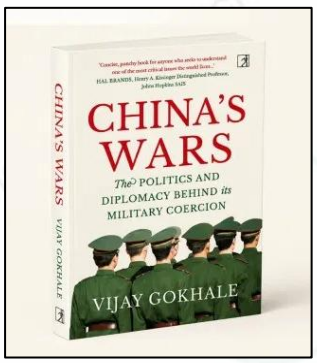
China's Wars by Vijay Gokhale: Decoding Beijing's military strategy and 'fight and talk' approach

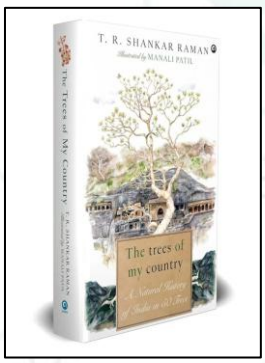
- Book: China's Wars: The Politics and Diplomacy Behind Its Military Coercion
- Author: Former Indian Foreign Secretary Vijay Gokhale
- Key Insight: China uses military force and psychological pressure to gain diplomatic leverage, rather than simply defeating its adversaries.

Review of T.R. Shankar Raman's The Trees of My Country

- **Book - The Trees of My Country: A Natural History of India in 50 Trees** by wildlife scientist T.R. Shankar Raman.
- illustrated by Manali Patil,
- The book explores in detail 50 native tree species across India





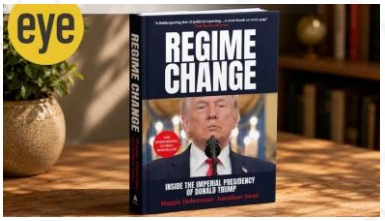


CSIR-NIScPR Organises Platinum Jubilee Ceremony to Mark 75 years of its popular Hindi science magazine, 'Vigyan Pragati'

- **CSIR-National Institute of Science Communication and Policy Research (CSIR-NIScPR)** organised a Platinum Jubilee Ceremony to mark 75 years of its popular **Hindi science magazine, 'Vigyan Pragati'.**

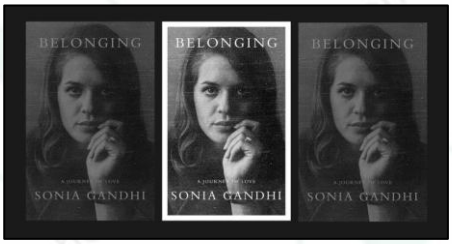
▪ **Launched in 1952**, 'Vigyan Pragati' has played a significant role over the past 75 years in disseminating scientific information among the public in simple and accessible language, promoting scientific temper and awareness, and communicating scientific achievements to society.

Inside Trump 2.0: new book - 'Regime Change'



▪ Book - **Regime Change: Inside the Imperial Presidency of Donald Trump**
▪ Written by : **Maggie Haberman and Jonathan Swan**
▪ Describes the authoritarian, corrupt and morally degraded workings of the Trump administration since his re-election.

Sonia Gandhi's memoir Belonging has been dropped by Penguin India just two months before its scheduled release



▪ Sonia Gandhi's memoir**: Belonging: A Journey of Love.**
▪ Congress leaders claim the publisher caved in by demanding the removal of **sensitive passages critical of Prime Minister Narendra Modi, the RSS, and Chinese intrusions into Indian territory**

Vice President releases Rajya Sabha MP Ghanshyam Tiwari's book 'Sankalp Se Siddhi Ka Modi Yug'

▪ Vice President Shri CP Radhakrishnan released the book **' Sankalp Se Siddhi Ka Modi Yug '**
▪ written by Rajya Sabha **MP Shri Ghanshyam Tiwari at Upa-Rashtrapati Bhavan in New Delhi**.
▪ the author has aptly described **Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi as ' Setu Purush** ' - a **bridge between dreams and reality** - reflecting the connection between the vision of these thinkers and their realization in contemporary India.

Appointments

Appointments (National)

In Table

Person	Appointment
Dr. T.V. Somanathan	Union Cabinet Secretary
Govind Mohan	Union Home Secretary
Deepti Gaur Mukherjee	Higher education secretary
Rahul Navin	Enforcement Directorate (ED) Director
Monisha Chakraborty	Reserve Bank of India Executive Director (ED)
Vishwesh Negi	Indian Ambassador to Iran
Air Marshal Sandeep Thareja	Director General Armed Forces Medical Services (DGAFMS)
Vice Admiral Manish Chadha	Director General Naval Operations (DGNO)
Varsha Ashok Aglawe	Director General of the Geological Survey of India
Tewolde Gebremariam	Air India's Chief Executive Officer and Managing Director
Willie Walsh	IndiGo's Chief Executive Officer (CEO)
N. Chandrasekaran	Resigned from the post of Chairman of Tata Sons
Pradeep Rai	Supreme Court Bar Association president
S. Somanath , Annie George Mathew and Syed Akbaruddin	part-time, non-official director on the Central Board of the Reserve Bank of India.
Sunil Balkrishna Shukre	Chairman of the Maharashtra Lokayukta Institution
Ashish Shelar	President of the Esports Games Federation (ESGF)
Sashidhar Jagdishan	To retire from the HDFC Bank MD & CEO

With Static

Union Cabinet Secretary Dr. T.V. Somanathan and Union Home Secretary Govind Mohan Get One-Year Extension

- **Cabinet Secretary T.V. Somanathan and Union Home Secretary Govind Mohan's tenures have been extended for another year,**
- **Mr. Mohan, a 1989 batch Indian Administrative Service (IAS) officer from the Sikkim cadre**, was appointed Home Secretary in 2024 and assumed office on August 23, 2024. He was serving as Culture Secretary before his present assignment.
- **Mr. Somanathan, a 1987-batch Indian Administrative Service officer of the Tamil Nadu cadre**, was appointed to the post for two years in August 2024.



Deepti Gaur Mukerjee Appointed Higher Education Secretary

- The Centre appointed corporate affairs secretary Deepti Gaur Mukherjee, a 1993-batch Madhya Pradesh cadre Indian Administrative Service (IAS) officer, as the higher education secretary.
- Mukherjee replaces Naresh Pal Gangwar.

Rahul Navin's tenure as ED Director extended by 1 year

- The tenure of **Enforcement Directorate (ED) Director Rahul Navin has been extended by a year beyond August 13.**
- **A 1993-batch Indian Revenue Service officer of the Income Tax cadre**, 59-year-old Navin has been leading the federal anti-money laundering agency as its full-time chief since August 14, 2024.



RBI Appoints Monisha Chakraborty as Executive Director

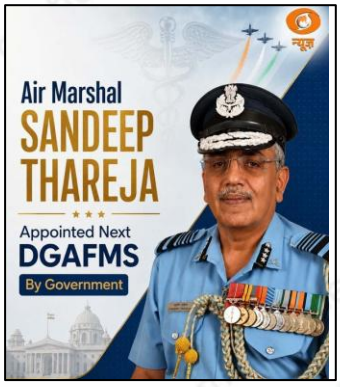
- The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) has appointed **Monisha Chakraborty as Executive Director (ED),** with effect from August 3, 2026.
- Prior to being promoted as ED, Monisha Chakraborty **was serving as Chief General Manager -in- Charge in Department of Supervision.**

MEA Joint Secretary Vishwesh Negi appointed as next Indian Ambassador to Iran



- India has appointed senior diplomat Vishwesh Negi as its **next Ambassador to the Islamic Republic of Iran.**
- Negi, a **2002-batch Indian Foreign Service (IFS) officer**, is currently serving as a Joint Secretary in the MEA.

Air Marshal Sandeep Thareja Appointed DGAFMS



- Government has appointed **Air Marshal Sandeep Thareja**, SM, VSM & Bar, presently serving as the **Director General Medical Services (Air), as the Director General Armed Forces Medical Services (DGAFMS).**
- He **will assume the appointment upon the retirement** of the incumbent DGAFMS **Surgeon Vice Admiral Arti Sarin**, PVSM, AVSM, VSM on August 31, 2026.
- An **alumnus of the Armed Forces Medical College (AFMC), Pune**, Air Marshal Sandeep Thareja was commissioned in December 1986.

Vice Admiral Manish Chadha Assumes Charge as DGNO

- **Vice Admiral Manish Chadha**, AVSM, VSM, **assumed charge as the Director General**

Naval Operations (DGNO)

- He was commissioned on 1 July 1991
- He **received the Vishisht Seva Medal in 2017 and the Ati Vishisht Seva Medal in 2025** for distinguished service in the Indian Navy.

Varsha Ashok Aglawe Becomes First Woman GSI Director General

- Varsha Ashok Aglawe has become the **54th Director General of the Geological Survey of India (GSI),** becoming the **first woman to lead the organisation in its 176-year history.**
- **Succeeds Asit Saha**, who served as the GSI director general for two years.
- **Founded in 1851, the Geological Survey of India is one of the oldest scientific entities in India.**

Air India Appoints Tewolde Gebremariam as CEO and MD

- Air India appointed Tewolde Gebremariam as its Chief Executive Officer and Managing Director on 5 August 2026.
- He will succeed Campbell Wilson, whose resignation took effect in April 2026 and whose departure is scheduled for 30 September 2026.

Willie Walsh Assumes Charge as IndiGo CEO

- **Willie Walsh has assumed charge as IndiGo's new Chief Executive Officer (CEO)**, following the sudden departure of Pieter Elbers
- The airline's promoter and managing director, Rahul Bhatia, had taken interim charge of the company's management.

Tata Sons chairman N. Chandrasekaran to step down in February 2027

- N Chandrasekaran has **stepped down from the post of Chairman of Tata Sons**
- His current tenure will ends in nearly six months on February 20, 2027.

Senior advocate Pradeep Rai elected new Supreme Court Bar Association president

- **Senior advocate Pradeep Rai** was elected as the new president of the **Supreme Court Bar Association (SCBA).**
- Senior advocate Rahul Kaushik and advocate Pragya Baghel retained their posts as vice president and secretary .
- Advocate Meneesh Dubey was re-elected to the joint secretary post.
- Advocate Reepak Kansal was declared elected as the treasurer.

Bar Council of India

- It is a statutory body created by Parliament to regulate and represent the Indian bar.
- It was **established under the Advocates Act, 1961**, based on the **recommendations of the All India Bar Committee.**
- Its main objective is safeguarding the rights, interests, and privileges of advocates throughout India

ISRO's Former Chairman S. Somanath Appointed to RBI Central Board

- Former Indian Space Research Organisation Chairman **S. Somanath was appointed as a part-time, non-official director on the Central Board of the Reserve Bank of India.**
- His appointment took effect **for a four-year term,**
- the Central Government has also **re-appointed Anand Gopal Mahindra as part-time, Non-official Director on the Central Board of Reserve Bank of India for a period of four years** with effect from August 20, 2026, or until further orders, whichever is earlier.
- The Central Board of Directors is **the highest governing body of the Reserve Bank of India.**

Syed Akbaruddin, Annie George Mathew Join RBI Board

- The government has appointed former **senior finance ministry official Annie George Mathew, economist** and **management consultant Janmejaya Kumar Sinha** and **former diplomat Syed Akbaruddin** as part-time, non-official directors on the Central Board of the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) for a four-year term.

- **the current strength of the board is 11**, including the governor and deputy governors. After this appointments**, it will become 14.**
- The government had appointed former ISRO Chairman Somnath S and Mahindra group Chairman Anand Mahindra on the central board of the RBI last week.
- **Mathew, 62, is a former Special Secretary in the Department of Expenditure, Ministry of Finance,** and is currently a full-time member of the Sixteenth Finance Commission.
- **Sinha, 66, is a prominent economist** and management consultant and has held senior leadership positions at the Boston Consulting Group.
- **Akbaruddin, 66, is a former Permanent Representative of India to the United Nations and a former spokesperson of the Ministry of External Affairs**

Justice Sunil Balkrishna Shukre becomes new Chairman of Maharashtra Lokayukta Institution

- Justice Sunil Balkrishna Shukre, former Judge of the Bombay High Court, was sworn in as **the new Chairman of the Maharashtra Lokayukta Institution**
- Maharashtra Governor Jishnu Dev Varma administered the oath of office to Justice Shukre

Maharashtra Minister Ashish Shelar elected President of Esports Games Federation

- Maharashtra Minister for Electronics, Information Technology and Artificial Intelligence Development and Cultural Affairs **Ashish Shelar has been elected President of the Esports Games Federation (ESGF).**
- The ESGF aims to establish a structured system for esports, including national teams, selection processes, competitions, training, rules and international representation, similar to traditional sports.

HDFC Bank CEO Jagdishan to step down, decides not to seek reappointment



- HDFC Bank MD & CEO **Sashidhar Jagdishan** has decided **not to seek reappointment and will step down from his role upon the completion of his current term.**
- India's largest private sector bank announced that Jagdishan will officially retire from his services on October 26, 2026.

Appointments (International)

In Table

Person	Appointment
Andras Baka	New President of Hungary
Abelardo de la Espriella	New President of Colombia
Justice Abha Nayar Patel	The first woman judge of Indian origin on the Zambia Supreme Court
Mohsen Rezaee	Head of Iran's Supreme National Security Council (SNSC)
Mirza Fakhrul Islam Alamgir	Bangladesh President
Flight Lieutenant Arshdeep Singh Dang	First Sikh to graduate as a fighter pilot in Britain's Royal Air Force (RAF).
V. Gopikrishna	First Indian to head the International Federation of Endodontic Associations (IFEA)

With Static

Mohsen Rezaee Appointed Head of Iran's SNSC



- Iran's Supreme Leader Mojtaba Khamenei has appointed former Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps (IRGC) chief Mohsen Rezaee as his representative to the **country's Supreme National Security Council (SNSC),** replacing Mohammad Baqir Zolghadr.

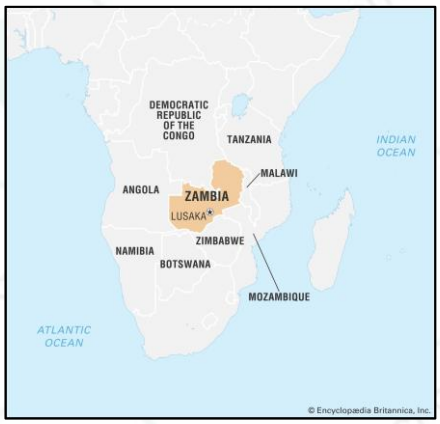
▪ The position was formerly held by Ali Larijani, who was assassinated in US-Israeli strikes in March, and then Mohammad Baqir Zolghadr.



Abelardo de la Espriella Sworn In as Colombia President

▪ Abelardo de la Espriella was sworn in on 7 August 2026 as the 36th President of Colombia for the 2026–2030 term.
▪ He succeeded Gustavo Petro,
▪ Capital: Bogotá
▪ Currency: Colombian peso

Zambia SC's first woman judge, of Indian origin



▪ **Justice Abha Nayar Patel**, the first woman judge of Indian origin on the Zambia Supreme Court,
▪ The event saw the **participation of Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, Justice Vikram Nath and Justice V. Mohana.**
▪ Moved from Delhi as a seven-year-old has said that India continues to hold a special place in her heart even after decades abroad.

Britain's first Sikh fighter pilot since World War II

▪ **Indian-origin Flight Lieutenant Arshdeep Singh Dang, 28**, has become the **first Sikh to graduate as a fighter pilot in Britain's Royal Air Force** (RAF).
▪ He is the **first Sikh to attain wings from a Fighter Squadron of the RAF since World War II.**

Chennai dentist becomes first Indian president of global endodontic body

▪ A Chennai-based endodontist **V. Gopikrishna has reportedly become the first Indian** to head the **International Federation of Endodontic Associations (IFEA).**
▪ He took over as President at the 15th World Endodontic Congress in Sydney, Australia.
▪ IFEA is the apex global body representing national endodontic associations and societies across 49 countries.



Hungary: Former Supreme Court Chief Andras Baka elected as new President

▪ Hungary's parliament elected former Supreme Court chief **Andras Baka as the country's next President.**
▪ **Hungary, landlocked country of central Europe.**
▪ **The capital is Budapest**

Mirza Alamgir elected as Bangladesh President



▪ Veteran Bangladesh Nationalist Party (BNP) leader **Mirza Fakhrul Islam Alamgir was elected as the country's 23rd President.**
▪ It was the country's first contested presidential election since 1991.
▪ **Capital: Dhaka**
▪ **Head Of Government: Prime Minister: Tarique Rahman**

Awards

Awards (National)

1,057 personnel from police, fire, correctional services get medals ahead of Independence Day

- The total of 1057 **Personnel of Police, Fire, Home Guard & Civil Defence (HG&CD) and Correctional Services** have been awarded **Gallantry and Service Medals** on the occasion of the Independence Day, 2026.
- Medal for Gallantry (GM) is awarded **on the ground of Conspicuous act of Gallantry in saving life and property**, or in **preventing crime or arresting criminals**, the risk incurred being estimated with due regard to the obligations and duties of the officer concerned.
- Total 301 Medal for Gallantry (GM) have been awarded.
- **Out of 301 Medal for Gallantry, 272 Police Personnel and 29 Fire Service personnel have been awarded GM respectively.**
- Among the majority of the 301 Gallantry Awards, 197 personnel from Left Wing Extremism affected areas, 51 personnel from Jammu & Kashmir region, 12 personnel from North-East and 41 personnel from other regions are being awarded for their gallant action.
- **Chhattisgarh Police received 141 Gallantry Medals, which was the highest among state police forces.**

SERVICE MEDALS

- President's Medal for Distinguished Service (PSM) is awarded for **special distinguished record in Service and Medal for Meritorious Service (MSM)** is awarded for valuable service characterized by resource and devotion to duty.
- **Total 92 President's Medal for Distinguished Service (PSM) have been awarded.**
- Out of 92 PSM, 83 have been awarded to Police Service, 04 to Fire Service, 03 to Civil Defence & Home Guard Service and 02 to Correctional Service.
- **Total 664 Medal for Meritorious Service (MSM) have been awarded.**
- Out of 664 MSM, 606 have been awarded to Police Service, 28 to Fire Service, 18 to Civil Defence & Home Guard Service and 12 to Correctional Service.

Service-Wise Break Up of Medals Awarded

Name of Medal	Police Service	Fire Service	Civil Defence & Home Guard Service	Correctional Service	Total
President's Medal for Distinguished Service (PSM) (Total Medal Awarded : 92)	83	04	03	02	92
Medal for Meritorious Service (MSM) (Total Medal Awarded : 664)	606	28	18	12	664

78 Gallantry awards announced for Defence Forces, CAPF personnel

- President Droupadi Murmu on August 14 approved 78 gallantry awards, including 13 awarded posthumously, for personnel from the Defence Forces and Central Armed Police Forces.
- The awards include **nine Kirti Chakras**, of which **seven are posthumous; one Bar (conferred second time) to the Shaurya Chakra; and 19 Shaurya Chakras, including one posthumous**
- The awards include **five Bars to the Sena Medals (Gallantry);** 36 Sena Medals (Gallantry), five of them posthumous; three Nau Sena Medals (Gallantry), and five Vayu Sena Medals (Gallantry).

Wartime Highest Gallantry Awards:

- Param Vir Chakra : India's highest military decoration
- Maha Vir Chakra : The second highest war time gallantry award
- Vir Chakra : Country's third-highest wartime gallantry award

Peacetime Highest Gallantry Awards:

- Ashoka Chakra : The highest military award during peacetime
- Kirti Chakra : The second highest peacetime gallantry award
- Shaurya Chakra: The third highest peacetime gallantry award



Other Awards:

1. Sena Medal
2. Nao Sena Medal
3. Vayu Sena Medal

Order of precedence:

- **The Param Vir Chakra**
- **The Ashoka Chakra**
- **The Mahavir Chakra**
- **The Kirti Chakra**
- **The Vir Chakra**
- **The Shaurya Chakra**

1 - Civilian: Bharat Ratna → Padma Vibhushan → Padma Bhushan → Padma Shri

2 - Gallantry: Wartime (Paramvir, Mahavir, Vir Chakra) & Peacetime (Ashoka, Kirti, Shaurya Chakra)

- Also includes Police Gallantry medals and civilian Jeevan Raksha Padak awards.

3 - Service: President's Medal (PSM) & Medal for Meritorious Service (MSM)

- Recognise distinguished service by Armed Forces, Paramilitary and Police personnel.

National Sports Awards 2025 announced; Divya Deshmukh, Gayatri Gopichand, Narender among 17 named for Arjuna Awards

- The Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports announced the National Sports Awards 2025, **with 17 sportspersons given the Arjuna Award and one receiving the lifetime honour.**
- **The Sports Ministry, however, did not name any athlete for the Major Dhyan Chand Khel Ratna Award this year.**
- The awards were announced based on the **recommendations of a selection committee** chaired by the former **Supreme Court judge Justice (Retd.) Arun Kumar Mishra.**

Arjuna Awards for outstanding performance in Sports and Games 2025

Sl. No.	Name of the Sportsperson	Discipline
1.	Shri Tejaswin Shankar	Athletics
2.	Shri Muhammed Ajmal V	Athletics
3.	Ms. Priyanka Goswami	Athletics
4.	Ms.Treesa Jolly	Badminton
5.	Ms Pullela Gayatri Gopichand	Badminton
6.	Shri Narender	Boxing
7.	Shri Vidit Santosh Gujarathi	Chess
8.	Ms. Divya Jitendra Deshmukh	Chess
9.	Shri Dhanush Srikanth	Deaf shooting
10.	Ms. Lalremsiami	Hockey
11.	Shri Rajkumar Pal	Hockey
12.	Shri Surjeet	Kabaddi
13.	Ms. Pooja	Kabaddi
14.	Shri Rudransh Khandelwal	Para-shooting
15.	Ms. Ekta Bhyan	Para athletics
16.	Shri Arvind Singh	Rowing

17.	Shri Akhil Sheoran	Shooting

Arjuna Awards (Lifetime) for outstanding performance in Sports and Games 2025

S. No.	Name of the Sportsperson	Discipline
1.	Shri I Arumainayagam	Football

Rashtriya Khel Protsahan Puraskar 2025

S. No.	Name of the Entity
1.	Army Paralympic Node, Pune

Dronacharya Award for outstanding coaches in Sports and Games 2025

Regular Category:

S. No.	Name of the Coach	Discipline
1.	Shri Parveer Singh	Athletics
2.	Shri Chhote Lal Yadav	Boxing
3.	Ms Neha Nandkumar Chavan	Shooting

Lifetime Category:

S. No.	Name of the Coach	Discipline
1.	Shri. Dharmendra Singh Yadav	Boxing
2.	Shri. Virender Kumar	Wrestling

Major Dhyan Chand Khel Ratna Award:

- The Khel Ratna Award was **instituted in 1991–1992.**
- given for outstanding performances in sports spanning over a **period of 4 years**
- It was **formerly known as Rajiv Gandhi Khel Ratna.**
- In **2021 it got renamed** after Major Dhyan Chand
- **It carries a cash prize of Rs 25 lakh,** a medal and a certificate of honour.
- **first recipient in 1991-92** : Viswanathan Anand (Chess)
- **First woman winner -** Karnam Malleswari (Olympic bronze winning weightlifter) in 1994-95

Arjuna Award (India's 2nd highest sporting honour):

- It was **established in 1961** to recognize outstanding achievements in national sporting events.
- It is given for **good performance over a period of the last four years** and showing qualities of leadership, sportsmanship and a sense of discipline.
- This **award carries a cash prize of Rs 15 lakh,** a bronze statue of Arjun and a certificate of appreciation.

Dronacharya Award:

- It was **established in 1985** by the Government of India to recognize excellence in sports related training.
- **It is given to coaches for doing excellent and commendable work** and enabling players to excel in international events.
- **It carries a cash prize of Rs 15 lakh,** a bronze statue of Dronacharya and a certificate of appreciation.

Nitin Gadkari confers Sarvottam Jeevan Raksha Padak on 12 rat miners

- Recently, the Union Minister of Road Transport and Highway conferred the Sarvottam Jeevan Raksha Padak on 12 rat miners in recognition of their exceptional courage and selfless service during the Silkyara Tunnel Rescue Operation.
- It is conferred on individuals who undertake life-saving efforts during incidents such as drowning, fire accidents, electrocution, natural calamities including landslides, animal attacks, and rescue operations in mines.

Categories: The Jeevan Raksha Padak series comprises three categories.

- **Sarvottam Jeevan Raksha Padak:** It is awarded for conspicuous courage in saving life under circumstances of very great danger to the rescuer.
- **Uttam Jeevan Raksha Padak**: It is conferred for courage and promptitude in saving life under conditions of great danger.
- **Jeevan Raksha Padak**: It is awarded for courage and promptitude in life-saving acts where the rescuer sustains grievous bodily injury

Eligibility for Jeevan Raksha Padak

- The awards are **open to individuals from all walks of life.**
- Members of the Armed Forces, Police Forces and recognised Fire Services are also eligible, provided the **act of bravery is performed beyond the call of normal duty.**
- **Personnel of Central Armed Police Forces and Central Police Organisations are also eligible under the revised framework.**
- It is presented to the awardees by the respective Union Ministries/Organizations/State Government to which the awardee belongs.

Features of Jeevan Raksha Padak Awards

- Its nominations are invited annually from States/UTs and Union Ministries.
- **Final approval is given by the Prime Minister and the President of India.**
- Award: The decoration of the award consists of **a Medal, Certificate, along with a one-time monetary allowance: Sarvottam Jeevan Raksha Padak (₹2 lakh), Uttam Jeevan Raksha Padam (₹1.5 lakh) and Jeevan Raksha (₹1 lakh).**

National Anubhav Awards 2026 to Be Conferred at Vigyan Bhawan

- Union Minister of State for Personnel, Public Grievances and Pensions, Dr. Jitendra Singh, will confer the National Anubhav Awards 2026 at the 9th National Anubhav Awards Ceremony held at Vigyan Bhawan, New Delhi.
- **The Anubhav Awards are annual national honors instituted by the Government of India to recognize and reward outstanding write-ups and case studies submitted by retiring or retired government personnel on the online 'Anubhav' portal,** documenting their institutional knowledge, administrative innovations, and field experiences.
- Nodal Department: **Department of Pension and Pensioners' Welfare (DoPPW), Ministry of Personnel, Public Grievances and Pensions.**
- **For the National Anubhav Awards Scheme, 2026, the 15 selected awardees have contributed to the Nation-building**

Eligibility Criteria:

- **Retiring/retired employees of Central Government Ministries/Departments, Central Public Sector Enterprises (CPSEs), and 12 Public Sector Banks (PSBs).**
- Open to employees **who are retiring within the next 8 months or pensioners who have retired within the past 3 years.**
- All write-ups published on the Anubhav Portal within the preceding financial year are evaluated.

Dr. M.S. Swaminathan Award for Environment Protection 2026

- Two women changemakers—**P. Pechiyammal and Govindhammal were honored with the Dr. M.S. Swaminathan Award** for Environment Protection 2026 at an event in Chennai.
- The Dr. M.S. Swaminathan Award for Environment Protection is **a national recognition awarded to grassroots individuals, community champions, or organizations for outstanding contributions to environmental preservation**, coastal plastic cleanup, biodiversity protection, and sustainable agriculture.
- **Instituted / Supported By:** M.S. Swaminathan Research Foundation (MSSRF) in partnership with CavinKare Pvt. Ltd. and the Rotary Club of Madras East (RI District 3234).

Eligibility:

- **Grassroots Champions & Organizations:** Open to individuals, local community workers, smallholder farmers, fisherfolk, and non-governmental entities operating across India.
- **Candidates must demonstrate tangible, measurable improvements in areas such as marine waste management, sustainable farming, seed preservation, or biodiversity restoration.**

Contributions:

- **Pechiyammal (Ramanathapuram, Tamil Nadu)**
- Field: Marine Conservation & Ocean Plastic Management
- Led community efforts **to remove abandoned fishing nets from coastal waters and shorelines.**

Govindhammal (Villupuram, Tamil Nadu)

- Field: Sustainable & Climate-Resilient Agriculture
- **Promoted organic farming, soil health, and climate-resilient agricultural practices.**

President of India presented Handloom Awards 2025 on Aug 7, National Handloom Day.

- President Droupadi Murmu will present the prestigious Handloom Awards 2025 during the National Handloom Day celebrations on August 7.
- This year, **22 awardees will be honoured, including three recipients of the Sant Kabir Handloom Award and 19 recipients of the National Handloom Award,**
- for their **exceptional work in preserving traditional craftsmanship** while advancing innovation, design development, marketing, entrepreneurship and the overall growth of the handloom sector.
- The awardees **under the Handloom Marketing Assistance (HMA)** component of the **National Handloom Development Programme (NHDP).**
- **The Sant Kabir Handloom Award, the highest honour for handloom weavers in India**, recognises artisans who have demonstrated exceptional craftsmanship and lifelong dedication to preserving and promoting traditional weaving practices.
- **Awardees receive a mounted gold coin, a tamrapatra (copper plaque), a shawl and a certificate.**

The Sant Kabir Handloom Award

Sl. No.	State	Category	Sub-Category	Applicant Name	Name of the Craft/Product
1	Odisha	Weaving	Weaving	Ram Meher	Bichitpar Khadi Saree
2	Assam	Weaving	Women	Runima Chetiya Choudhury	Muga Silk Saree
3	Uttar Pradesh	Weaving	Languishing Weaves	Shah Muhammad Ansari	Zarbaft Shewatambari Awadh Jamdhani Saree

Vikram Sarabhai Medal

- Recently, astrophysicist **Annapurni Subramaniam has been awarded the COSPAR Vikram Sarabhai Medal – 2026.**
- She is the director of Indian Institute of Astrophysics (IIA), Bengaluru, and holds the additional charge as director of the Centre for Nano and Soft Matter Sciences (CeNS).
- She is also involved in the **Thirty Metre Telescope (TMT),** in which India is one of the participating member countries in the international consortium.
- **In 2024, Subramaniam was bestowed with Rashtriya Vigyan Puraskar** – Vigyan Shri in the Space Science and Technology category.
- Vikram Sarabhai Medal is an **international medal awarded to scientists from developing countries for their outstanding contributions to the field of space research**.



- It is awarded **jointly by the Committee on Space Research (COSPAR) and the Indian Space Research Organization (ISRO).**
- Eligibility: For a candidate to be eligible for this award, her or his relevant work must have been carried out mainly in the five year period ending one year before the COSPAR Scientific Assembly at which the medal is to be presented.
- **Annapurni Subramaniam is the only fourth Indian to receive this medal, in addition to being the first Indian woman scientist and only the third female recipient of this honour.**

Gaj Gaurav Awards 2026 conferred for Exemplary Contributions to Elephant Conservation and Management

- The Gaj Gaurav Awards 2026 were conferred **during the national celebrations of World Elephant Day in Visakhapatnam, Andhra Pradesh.**
- The ceremony was **hosted by the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change** and recognised frontline contributions to elephant conservation and management in India.
- **Launched in 1992** as a **Centrally Sponsored Scheme**, **Project Elephant** has completed more than three decades of dedicated efforts **towards protecting elephants, their habitats and corridors**, addressing HEC and ensuring the welfare of captive elephants.
- The Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change **released the document titled "30 Giant Steps",** which listed 30 achievements and policy initiatives under Project Elephant from 2020 to 2026.

Dr. Padma Gurmet Conferred UT Ladakh State Award 2025 for Exemplary Service to Sowa-Rigpa Medicine

- **Dr. Padma Gurmet, Director, National Institute of Sowa-Rigpa, Leh**, has been conferred the UT Ladakh State Award for the year 2025 in recognition of his contribution to the **preservation, promotion and development of the Sowa-Rigpa system** of medicine in Ladakh.
- The award was conferred by the Lieutenant Governor of Ladakh, Vinai Kumar Saxena, during the UT State Awards ceremony,

National Gopal Ratna Awards

- Recently, the **department of Animal Husbandry and Dairying under the Ministry of Fisheries, Animal Husbandry** has invited nominations for the National Gopal Ratna Award 2026.
- NGRA are the **country's highest honours in the livestock and dairy sector.**
- It was **established under the Rashtriya Gokul Mission in 2021.**
- The "**Rashtriya Gokul Mission (RGM)", was launched in December 2014**, with a view to conserve and develop **indigenous bovine breeds in a scientific manner.**

The NGRA will be **conferred in the following categories**

- **Best Dairy farmer** rearing indigenous cattle/buffalo breeds (list of registered breeds Annexed).
- **Best Dairy Cooperative Society (DCS)/** Milk Producer Company (MPC)/Dairy Farmer Producer Organization (FPO).
- **Best Artificial Insemination Technician (AIT).**
- There is also a provision of **Special award for the North Eastern Region (NER) and Himalayan States so as to encourage and boost the dairy development activities in these States/UTs.**
- The Award consists of a **cash prize of Rs. 5 lakh for 1st rank, Rs. 3 lakh for 2nd rank, Rs. 2 lakh for 3rd rank and Rs. 2 lakh for Special Award for North Eastern Region,** along with a Certificate of merit and a memento in the first two categories i.e Best Dairy Farmer and Best DCS/FPO/MPCs.

Sangeet Natak Akademi Announces 2024 and 2025 Awards

- President Droupadi Murmu will confer the Sangeet Natak Akademi Fellowships (Akademi Ratna) and Awards (Akademi Puraskar) for **2024 and 2025 on 115 artists** at a special investiture ceremony at **Vigyan Bhawan in New Delhi.**
- It is **India's national academy for music, dance, and drama.**

- It is the first national academy of the arts set up by the Republic of India.
- It was **set up by the Indian education ministry in 1952** and became functional the following year, with the **appointment of its first chairman, Dr. P. V. Rajamannar.**
- **Dr. Rajendra Prasad, the first President of India, inaugurated it on 28 January 1953.**
- Currently, it is an autonomous body of the Ministry of Culture, Government of India.
- **Headquarters: New Delhi**
- The honour of **Akademi Fellow carries a purse money of Rs. 3,00,000/- (Rupees three lakh only) while the Akademi Award carries a purse money of Rs. 1,00,000/- (Rupees one lakh only),** besides a Tamrapatra and Angavastram.

IIT Bombay Professor Karthikeyan Lanka Selected for NASI Young Scientist Award 2026

- Professor **Karthikeyan Lanka** of the Indian Institute of Technology Bombay has been selected for the **NASI Young Scientist Award 2026.**
- He is an Associate Professor at the Centre of Studies in Resources Engineering and an associate faculty member in the Interdisciplinary Programme in Climate Studies at IIT Bombay.
- Professor Lanka's research areas include remote **sensing of terrestrial processes, land-atmosphere interactions, and agricultural droughts.**
- The award presentation is **scheduled during the 96th Annual Session and Symposium of the National Academy of Sciences, India, at Banaras Hindu University, Varanasi**, on 4–5 December 2026.



- The NASI Young Scientist Platinum Jubilee Award is conferred by the National Academy of Sciences, India (NASI) to **recognize outstanding contributions of early-career researchers across various scientific disciplines.**
- The National Academy of Sciences**, India is one of the oldest science academies in the country and was established in 1930.**
- **It is based in Prayagraj, Uttar Pradesh**, and it conducts annual sessions, symposia, and academic recognitions for scientists in India.

Publication Division of MIB receives seven awards for excellence in Book Production

- **The Publications Division of the Ministry of Information and Broadcasting** has won **seven awards at the Federation of Indian Publishers (FIP) Awards** for Excellence in Book Production 2026, recognising its editorial and publishing work **across Hindi, English and Urdu.**
- The Division secured **four second prizes** and **three third prizes in various categories** covering reference books, general and trade books, journals, children's publications and art and coffee-table books.
- Among the publications receiving second prizes, **'Bharat 2026'** won in the Reference Books – Hindi category, while '**Wings to Our Hopes – Volume 2**' was recognised in the General and Trade Books – English category.
- **'Yojana – July 2026', themed 'Viksit Bharat@2047',** received the second prize in the Journals and House Magazines – Hindi category.
- **'Kurukshetra – A Rural Development Monthly Since 1952'** also secured a second prize in the Journals and House Magazines – English category.
- Three Publications Division titles **received third prizes**. **'Dharti Ki Sehat'** was recognised in the Children's Books (General Interest) (0-10 Years) – Hindi category, while **'Rangoli Roop Sur Lay Ki**' won in the Art and Coffee Table Books – Hindi category.
- **'Ajkal Urdu – July 2026'** secured the third prize in the Journals and House Magazines, Indian Languages (Urdu) category.
- The Federation of Indian Publishers (FIP) is a representative body of publishers in English, Hindi and other Indian languages, with members from across the country.

POWERGRID Wins PMIS Partner Company Award

- **Power Grid Corporation of India Limited (POWERGRID), a Maharatna public sector undertaking** under the Ministry of Power, **received the PMIS Recognition of Partner Company Award** in the category of Innovation in Exit Pathways
- The award ceremony was held by the Ministry of Corporate Affairs at the India Habitat Centre in New Delhi
- **Mahindra & Mahindra Limited was named the Overall Industry Champion at the same event.**
- **The Prime Minister Internship Scheme (PMIS) was launched in 2024 as a national internship initiative for youth engagement with industry**

Ashutosh Parida to Receive 47th Sarala Puraskar

- Noted Odia poet, essayist and fomer scientist at CSIR-IMMT **Ashutosh Parida** has been selected for the **prestigious Sarala Puraskar for his poetry collection 'Bishwas De Pruthwi'.**
- The award, **given annually by the Indian Metals Public Charitable Trust (IMPaCT)** for the best literary achievement
- His poetry collection 'Bishwas De Pruthwi', **published by Prabha Publication** in year 2024.
- the writer will be presented with a citation, **copper plaque and award amount of ₹7 lakh**

National Teachers' Awards 2026

- National Teachers' Awards 2026 will be conferred **by President Droupadi Murmu on 5 September 2026 (Teachers' Day) at Vigyan Bhawan, New Delhi.**
- 5 September is observed as **Teachers' Day in India (Dr Sarvepalli Radhakrishnan was born on 5 September 1888.)**
- This year, **48 outstanding school teachers from across India have been selected for their exceptional contribution to education,** innovation in teaching, and positive impact on students' lives.
- The awards are presented **annually by the Ministry of Education**
- **The award was instituted in 1958** and is presented every year on Teachers' Day (5 September) to celebrate the contribution of teachers towards nation-building.
- Of the 48 awardees, 26 are male and 22 are female teachers
- Each award carries a certificate of merit, a **cash award of Rs. 50,000** and a silver medal.
- The 2026 awardees include teachers from government schools, PM SHRI schools, Kendriya Vidyalayas, Jawahar Navodaya Vidyalayas, Eklavya Model Residential Schools, Sainik Schools and other recognised institutions.
- The National Teachers' Awards 2026 ceremony will be broadcast live on Doordarshan and the Ministry of Education's SWAYAM PRABHA channels.

FPAI Awards 2026: Mizo footballer Lallian-zuala Chhangte named Indian Footballer of the Year 2026

- India midfielder and Mohun Bagan player Lallianzuala Chhangte was named **Indian Player of the Year** at the **Football Players' Association of India's Indian Football Awards 2026,** while **Manisha Kalyan took home the Indian Women's Player of the Year honour.**
- **Organised by the Football Players Association of India,** the award is decided through votes from fellow players.
- **Indian Player of the Year**: Lallianzuala Chhangte
- **Indian Women's Player of the Year:** Manisha Kalyan
- **Young Player of the Year**: Sanan Mohammed K
- **Women's Young Player of the Year:** Sanfida Nongrum
- **Foreign Player of the Year:** Miguel Figueira Damasceno
- **I-League Player of the Year**: Phrangki Buam
- **Coach of the Year**: Owen Coyle
- **Women's Coach of the Year**: Anthony Andrews
- **Coach Education Award:** Savio Medeira

Dr. Y.S. Rajasekhara Reddy Award-2026 to be conferred on M.S. Swaminathan Research Foundation

- The Dr. YSR & Dr. KVP Foundation will confer the Dr. Y.S. Rajasekhara Reddy Award-2026, **carrying a cash prize of ₹25 lakh,** on **the M.S. Swaminathan Research Foundation (MSSRF)** in recognition of its **contribution to agriculture, food security, sustainable development and rural livelihoods.**
- **MSSRF chairperson Soumya Swaminathan will receive the award.**

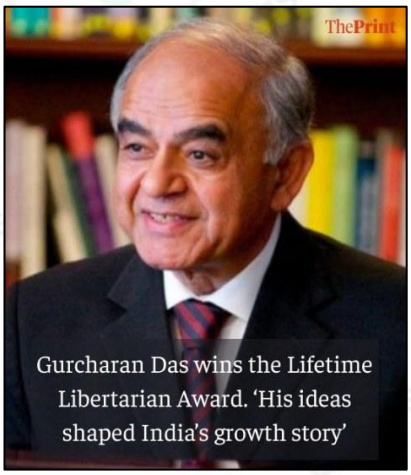
Awards (International)

Indian Physicist Deepak Dhar Wins 2026 Dirac Medal



- **Theoretical physicist Deepak Dhar** has been awarded the 2026 Dirac Medal by the International Centre for Theoretical Physics (ICTP) for his contributions to statistical mechanics and complex systems.
- **The ICTP Dirac Medal was first awarded in 1985 in memory of British physicist P.A.M. Dirac**, one of the leading physicists of the 20th century.
- The award recognises scientists who have made major contributions to theoretical physics.
- **Previous recipients include renowned physicists such as Stephen Hawking.**
- The other recipients are **Bernard Derrida**, Honorary Professor at the College de France; **Marc Mezard,** Professor of Theoretical Physics at Bocconi University; and **Haim Sompolinsky**, Professor of Neuroscience and Physics at the Hebrew University of Jerusalem and Visiting Professor at Harvard University.
- **Deepak Dhar is one of four physicists chosen this year for their contributions to statistical mechanics.**
- Deepak Dhar's most recognised contribution is what's known as Dhar's burning algorithm, developed while studying sandpile models.
- **Born in 1951 in Pratapgarh, Uttar Pradesh,**
- He studied at Allahabad University, then moved to IIT Kanpur for his MSc, before heading to Caltech in the US, where he earned a Richard Feynman fellowship and worked directly under Feynman himself, completing his PhD in 1978.
- Rather than staying abroad, Dhar returned to India, joining TIFR Mumbai and later teaching at IISER Pune for nearly eight years, shaping generations of young physicists along the way.
- **In 2022, he became the first Indian to win the Boltzmann Medal**, the top award in statistical physics.
- **In 2023, the Government of India recognised his contributions with a Padma Bhushan**, the country's third-highest civilian award.

Renowned author Gurcharan Das was awarded the Lifetime Libertarian Award



- Gurcharan Das, the author and public intellectual, has become **the first Indian to receive the Lifetime Libertarian Award**, handed to him at the 40th Liberty International World Conference in Kathmandu.
- The citation recognised his "**lasting contribution to the advancement of liberty,"** a theme that has run through his writing for over three decades, spanning freedom, entrepreneurship, and individual responsibility.
- **Liberty International, founded in 1982**, has now held 40 world conferences, bringing **together scholars, entrepreneurs, and policymakers committed to the ideals of a free and open society.**
- **The first, India Unbound, India Grows at Night followed, Dilemma of the Indian Liberal, The Difficulty of Being Good and Kama: The Riddle of Desire.**

The Fields Medal 2026



- The 2026 Fields Medal—mathematics' highest honor—was awarded to **Yu Deng, John Pardon, Jacob Tsimerman, and Hong Wang at the International Congress of Mathematicians.**
- Hong Wang made history as only the third woman in the medal's 90-year history to receive the honor, while she and Yu Deng became the first Chinese nationals awarded since 1982.
- Often referred to as the **Nobel Prize of Mathematics**, the Fields Medal is the most prestigious global award recognizing outstanding mathematical achievement for existing research and the promise of future accomplishment.
- **Administering Body: Awarded by the International Mathematical Union (IMU) every four years** during the International Congress of Mathematicians.
- **Origin: Established in 1936** from a trust fund established by **Canadian mathematician John Charles Fields at the University of Toronto.**
- **Candidates must be younger than 40 years old on January 1st of the award year,** celebrating early-career breakthroughs and future potential.
- **Funded through the J.C. Fields Trust at the University of Toronto**, supplemented by institutional partners and the Fields Institute.

18-year-old is world's youngest male professor, breaks 306-year-old record



- **At just 18 years and 346 days old, Nathan Thomas** has become the **world's youngest male professor** after landing a teaching position.
- Thomas, a Florida, US, resident, also shattered a Guinness World Records milestone that had remained unbroken for more than 300 years.
- **Thomas bagged a teaching role at Miami Dade College in August 2023** and began instructing students in the course COP 2270: C For Engineers.
- Thomas surpassed the previous record set by **Scottish mathematician Colin Maclaurin, who became a professor at 19 in the early 18th century.**
- The record had remained unbroken for 306 years.
- Thomas is also 16 days younger than **Alia Sabur, who became the world's youngest woman professor in 2008 at 18 years and 362 days old,** Guinness World Records stated.

Three Indians Join Guinness World Record Skydive in Libya

- Three UAE-based Indian skydivers participated in a Guinness World Record skydive over **Benghazi, Libya**, on **7 August 2026**.
- **Participants: 65 skydivers** representing **38 nationalities** took part.
- **Aircraft:** All skydivers exited a single **Ilyushin Il-76TD military aircraft**.
- **Altitude:** The jump was conducted from **13,000 feet**.
- **Record:** The team set a **new global record for the most skydivers simultaneously jumping with national flags from a single aircraft**.



Haryana yoga teacher set a Guinness World Record

- **Kamal Kaloi**, a 38-year-old yoga teacher and aquatic athlete hailing from Hisar, Haryana, has set a new Guinness World Record for performing 86 underwater push-ups on a single breath

Kaziah Liz Mejo, Kerala's 19-year-old Miss Universe India 2026 winner



- **Kaziah Liz Mejo of Kerala** has been crowned **Miss Universe India 2026,** emerging from 53 contestants at the prestigious pageant finale held in Jaipur
- **Vaishnavi Gannesh from Tamil Nadu became the 1st runner-up, while Anushri Satavlekar from Gujarat** bagged the Miss International India 2026 title as the 2nd runner-up.
- **Mejo will now represent India at the 75th Miss Universe pageant, scheduled for November in Puerto Rico.**

Over 200 Indian Peacekeepers Receive UN Medal in South Sudan

- Over 200 Indian peacekeepers deployed with the UN mission in **South Sudan** have been awarded the **prestigious UN medal for their exceptional service.**
- **India is the second-largest contributor of uniformed personnel to UN Peacekeeping**.

Putin's secrets, power and inner circle: 'Shocking' book on Russian leader wins French literary prize





- The newly established **French literary award, the Prix Strasbourg**, has been won by a book about Russian President Vladimir Putin titled **The Tsar in Propria Persona: How Vladimir Putin Deceived Us All.**
- Authored by - **Russian investigative journalists Roman Badanin and Mikhail Rubin,**
- The prize, awarded **by EBRA, France's largest regional newspaper group**
- the prize seeks to distinguish itself through its substantial endowment, with **€20,000 (S$29,637) awarded to the overall winner and €55,000 distributed across all categories.**

Ved Mehta International Prize in creative non-fiction

- A new international book award celebrating creative nonfiction has been launched **by Ashoka University's Centre for the Creative and the Critical and Balliol College, Oxford.**
- The Ved Mehta International Prize in Creative Nonfiction, worth **£10,000, will be awarded annually to the best book of creative nonfiction published in English anywhere in the world.**
- The first prize will be given in 2026 for books published in 2025.
- A distinguished jury—Merve Emre, Seamus Perry, and Vijay Seshadri—will select the winner.
- Translated works are eligible, with an additional £2,000 for translators.
- **No submissions are accepted; the jury will select from published works.**

Zelenskyy awards Elon Musk Ukraine's Order of Freedom for Starlink role

- Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy awarded Elon Musk the **Order of Freedom, one of Ukraine's highest state honours, for his "outstanding personal merits" in protecting human life and freedom** and strengthening ties between Ukraine and the United States.
- The award recognises Musk's role in Ukraine's war effort through **Starlink, SpaceX's satellite internet network, which has become a crucial communications lifeline for both the military and civilians** since Russia's full-scale invasion in 2022.

Ramraj enters Asia Book of Records for creating Mundukalam

- **Tiruppur-based Ramraj Cotton textiles** has entered the **Asia Book of Records for creating Mundukalam,** a **display of pookkalam using dhotis.**

▪ The company created a **Mundukalam that was 30 feet long in diametre using as many as 3,000 dhotis at** Forum Mall, Kochi, Keralam.

Obituaries

Eminent Marxist historian and scholar of modern Indian history, Sumit Sarkar, died



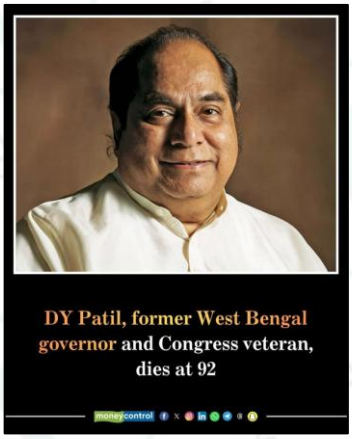
▪ He spent several years **teaching History at the University of Delhi, and was a Fellow of Wolfson College, Oxford.**
▪ His works include **Swadeshi Movement in Bengal, 1903-1908 (1973), Modern India (1989), and Writing Social History (1998)**, among others.
▪ He also co-edited **Women and Social Reform in Modern India (2007) and Caste in Modern India (2013)** with his wife, Tanika Sarkar.

M.P. Parameswaran, renowned nuclear scientist and Marxist theorist, dies at 92



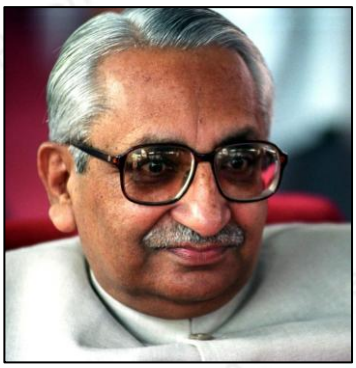
▪ **M.P. Parameswaran**, an Indian nuclear **scientist, science communicator and Marxist theorist**, died at his residence in Thrissur, Kerala.

Veteran Congress leader, former West Bengal Governor D.Y. Patil passes away at 92



▪ Former West Bengal Governor and senior Congress leader D.Y. Patil passed away due to prolonged illness at his residence in Maharashtra's Kolhapur
▪ Widely recognised in **Maharashtra as "Shikshanmaharshi," or visionary educationist**
▪ served as the **Governor of Tripura, Bihar, and West Bengal.**
▪ He served as the mayor of Kolhapur from 1957 to 1962, and was elected as an MLA from the Panhala constituency in 1967 and 1972.
▪ **In 1983, he established the Ramrao Adik Institute of Technology (RAIT), the first engineering college in Navi Mumbai.**
▪ In recognition of his contributions to education and social service, **he was honoured with the prestigious civilian award, the Padma Shri, in 1991.**
▪ The D Y Patil Stadium in Navi Mumbai is named after him.

Justice M.S. Liberhan, who headed Babri Masjid inquiry commission, passes away



▪ Justice M S Liberhan, who achieved national prominence as the **head of the judicial commission** constituted to **investigate the Babri Masjid demolition**, died at age 87 in Chandigarh.
▪ Justice Manmohan Singh Liberhan was a **former judge of the Punjab and Haryana High Court** and a **former Chief Justice of the Andhra Pradesh and Madras High Courts**.
▪ The Justice Liberhan Commission submitted its report on the December 6, 1992, demolition of the Babri mosque by kar sevaks after nearly 17 years, becoming **one of the longest-running commissions of inquiry in India's history.**
▪ He also served as the Bar Council's secretary from January 1976 to June 1983.

Veteran Nepalese mountaineer Purja dies in avalanche on Broad Peak in PoK



- Veteran Nepalese mountaineer Nirmal Purja died in an avalanche on Broad Peak, located in Pakistan-occupied Kashmir's Gilgit Baltistan,
- Born in Nepal, Purja, 43, was among 10 climbers swept away by the avalanche that **struck Broad Peak, located in the Karakoram range near K2,** at an altitude of around 7,000 metres
- Purja had successfully climbed all 14 peaks above 8,000 metres around the world in just six months and six days, setting a new record in 2019. He was about to complete his mission of climbing all 14 eight-thousanders twice after completing the Broad Peak.

Tim Curry, 'The Rocky Horror Picture Show' and 'It' star, dies at 80

- Tim Curry, the British actor whose flamboyant performances in The Rocky Horror Picture Show and Stephen King's It made him a cult icon across generations, has died at the age of 80.
- His career included work in television, music and voice acting across more than five decades, including **including Star Wars: The Clone Wars, The Wild Thornberrys and The Adventures of Jimmy Neutron, Boy Genius.**

Sonya Gill, AIDWA leader and women's rights activist, dies at 70

- Sonya Gill, women's rights activist and former Maharashtra Secretary of All India Democratic Women's Association (AIDWA), died.
- **She was the co-founder and trustee of PARI (People's Archive of Rural India).**

Norway's King Harald V Dies at 89



- Norway's King Harald V has died at the age of 89, the royal palace in Oslo announced
- Harald, who **became Norway's ceremonial head of state in 1991, was Europe's oldest reigning monarch.**
- Harald was Norway's first king born in Norway since the 14th Century.
- **He has been succeeded by his son Haakon**

National

PM Modi Unveils Sapta Dhara Framework for Viksit Bharat

- Saptadhara is a **seven-point development vision announced by Prime Minister Narendra Modi** on India's 80th Independence Day, August 15, 2026.
- It focuses on **manufacturing, agriculture and food processing, technology and innovation, Gati Shakti, defence, green and blue economy, and soft power** as key drivers of India's future growth.
- The framework aims to strengthen India's economic and strategic capabilities and accelerate the country's journey towards Viksit Bharat.
- PM Modi said these **seven areas can provide a strong base for the journey towards Viksit Bharat by improving India's economic strength, technological capabilities, infrastructure, security and global influence.**
- Referring to the idea of 'Sapta Sindhu', he described Saptadhara as a new flow of national strength that can help India achieve in the next 5-7 years what could not be achieved over several previous decades.

Govt invites 100 beneficiaries of PM Vishwakarma as 'Special Guests' to witness 80th Independence Day Ceremony

- The Government of India has invited **100 beneficiaries of PM Vishwakarma from the Delhi-NCR region as 'Special Guests'** to witness the 80th Independence Day Ceremony at the Red Fort, Delhi.
- It is a **central sector scheme launched in 2023.**
- It is aimed at **providing comprehensive support to artisans and craftspeople engaged in traditional trades**.
- Objective: Promoting the socio-economic empowerment of artisans, strengthening traditional crafts and ensuring sustainable livelihoods.
- The scheme provides **assistance through skill upgradation**, modern tools, financial support, digital enablement and market linkages.
- **Nodal Ministry: Ministry of Micro, Small, and Medium Enterprises.**
- **Time period: Five years (FY 2023-24 to FY 2027-28).**

Eligibility & coverage

- It is available for rural and urban artisans and craftsmen across India.
- **It covers 18 traditional crafts such as Boat Maker; Armourer; Blacksmith; Hammer and Tool Kit Maker; etc.**
- **Aged 18+, engaged in traditional trade, no similar loans in the past 5 years.**

Independence Day 2026: Crafts from four states adorn President's At Home invite

- The parcel comprised some rare craft items and an invite — to participate in the At Home reception hosted by President Draupadi Murmu on August 15.



- Around 650 guests, including over 100 eminent citizens, invited to the 80th Independence Day high tea.
- The focus of this year is to highlight the heritage and traditions of four states — **Maharashtra, Goa, Madhya Pradesh and Chhattisgarh**
- The specially curated menu includes '**patoleo' from the Konkan region,** comprising rice-flour parcels filled with coconut and jaggery**; mini farra from Chhattisgarh; khamang Kakdi from Maharashtra** and **Jabalpur's gatpat, a tangy mix of potatoes and tomatoes sauteed in ghee**, from Madhya Pradesh.
- The invite bag—designed in collaboration with the **National Institute of Design, Ahmedabad.**
- Its **outer cover** was inspired by the **Kaavi art of the coastal Konkan region.**
- A wrought iron bell was attached to the address slip, which has been **handcrafted by tribal ironsmiths in Bastar using recycled scrap iron.**
- The bag also contained a handwoven **Maheshwari stole that was used to welcome guests upon their arrival.**
- It also included a display frame featuring figurines handcrafted using **'Lauh Shilp' or Pitwa art, a world-renowned tribal craft from Bastar.**
- A pair of **Azulejo tiles** in the bag depicted Goa's Khajan lands, which are community-managed coastal wetlands, reclaimed from mangrove forests.
- — Earlier this year, the **Republic Day at Home focused on the vibrant heritage and handicrafts of the eight northeastern states**

Nation celebrates "Har Ghar Tiranga" with national pride and patriotism

- Ahead of Independence Day, the **'Har Ghar Tiranga' campaign is bringing a strong feeling of patriotism across the country.**
- Tiranga rallies and many other programmes are being organised across the state.
- **The campaign is being held from August 9 to 17**
- **People have been urged to hoist the national flag at their homes, shops and establishments from August 13 to 15.**

Cabinet Approves Samudra Manthan Offshore Exploration Scheme

- Recently, the Union Cabinet has approved **'Samudra Manthan' – the National Offshore Exploration Scheme** with a total outlay of ₹84,084 crore.
- It is also called the National Offshore Exploration Scheme.
- Nodal Ministry: It is **a Central Sector Scheme of the Ministry of Petroleum & Natural Gas.**
- Implementation Period: Up to **FY 2030–31.**
- The scheme aims at unlocking India's vast offshore energy potential

Features of Samudra Manthan Scheme

- It encompasses a comprehensive set of interventions across the offshore exploration value chain.
- It provides for large-scale acquisition, processing and **interpretation of high-quality seismic data, accelerated deepwater** and ultra-deepwater **exploratory drilling, and scientific drilling in frontier basins.**
- It involves development of common offshore production and evacuation infrastructure, and establishment of an **integrated Oil & Gas Manufacturing and Services Zone.**

Cabinet Approves Pradhan Mantri Surya Sarovar Yojana

- It is a scheme for the **development of Floating Solar Photovoltaic (FSPV) Projects** with Energy Storage Systems (ESS).
- It envisages the **development of 5,000 MW of Floating Solar Photovoltaic projects** with co-located Energy Storage Systems having a **minimum storage capacity of two hours i.e.,10,000 MWh.**
- Time Period**: The projects will be sanctioned during FY 2026-27 to FY 2030-31**, with disbursement of financial support continuing up to FY 2032-33.
- **Financial Assistance:** Central Financial Assistance (CFA) of **Rs. One crore per MW** will be provided for **eligible Floating Solar Photovoltaic projects after successful commissioning.**
- In addition, CFA of up **to Rs.50 lakh per project will be available for undertaking feasibility studies**, including bathymetry and hydrography assessments, environmental studies, and other preparatory activities required for de-risking the project development.
- It would enhance the floating Solar PV capacity in the country by 5,000 MW, which is presently around 700 MW only.

Cabinet Extends PM-KISAN Scheme for Five Years

- The Union Cabinet has approved the **continuation of the PM-KISAN for the next 5 years,** reaffirming the Government's commitment to farmers' prosperity as the foundation of national prosperity.

The Key Facts About PM-KISAN

- **About: PM-KISAN** is a **Central Sector Scheme** launched in **2019 t**o provide assured **income support to landholding farmer families with cultivable land.**
- The Union Budget 2026–27 allocated ₹60,000 crore for PM-KISAN, reflecting continued support for farmers' income security.
- The Union Cabinet has approved the Scheme's **continuation** from **2026–27 to 2030–31 .**
- Financial Assistance: Under the scheme, **each eligible farmer family receives ₹6,000 per year in three equal installments of ₹2,000 each.**
- **Mode of Transfer**: The amount is transferred directly into Aadhaar-seeded bank accounts through the **Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT) mechanism.**
- **Objective:** The scheme aims to **increase farmers' income**, support purchase of agricultural inputs such as seeds and fertilisers, improve crop health and productivity, and reduce dependence on informal credit.

The Revamped Khelo India Scheme

- The Union Cabinet, chaired by Prime Minister of India, **approved an expanded, revamped Khelo India Scheme** along with an enhanced **Assistance to National Sports Federations (ANSFs) scheme.**

- The Khelo India Scheme is the central flagship initiative of the **Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports.**
- It is designed to **revive India's sports culture at the grassroots level, identify athletic talent, construct modern sports infrastructure,** and establish a structured pathway to national and international excellence.
- **Original Launch**: First introduced in 2016–17 (and **extensively restructured in 2017–18**) by consolidating legacy schemes like the Rajiv Gandhi Khel Abhiyan, Urban Sports Infrastructure Scheme, and National Sports Talent Search System.
- **Implementation Period (Revamped Framework): FY 2026–27 to FY 2030–31.**
- Aim: Aligned with the Khelo Bharat Niti 2025 and NEP 2020, the scheme integrates sports with education, expands India's talent pool, builds high-performance ecosystems, and supports future Commonwealth and Olympic hosting ambitions.

Key Features of the Revamped Scheme:

- Introduces the **Emerging Khelo India Athletes** (E-KIAs) category alongside existing Khelo India Athletes (KIAs), **expanding the structured athlete development ecosystem nearly ten-fold under professional coaching and scientific support.**
- Launches two dedicated school initiatives—**Khelo India Feeder Schools (KIFS) and Khelo India Utkrishta Vidyalayas (KIUV)—**to embed physical education into mainstream school curricula and enable early talent identification.
- Establishes a seamless tier of **training centers** comprising National Centres of Excellence (NCOEs), Khelo India State Centres of Excellence (KISCEs), SAI Training Centres (STCs), and Youth Sports Companies (YSCs) operated by the Armed Forces.
- **National Coach Accreditation Board (NCAB):** Sets up the NCAB to **standardize coaching qualifications**, enforce high-performance professional benchmarks, and upscale sports science support personnel across India.
- Constructs a centralized digital platform integrating athlete databases, talent assessments, and funding trails, while expanding the Fit India Movement into remote, border, and marginalized communities.

India steps up container manufacturing push with ₹10,000 crore assistance scheme

- The Government has proposed a **₹10,000 crore Container Manufacturing Assistance Scheme (CMAS)** to strengthen domestic production of shipping containers.
- It is a targeted initiative to establish a **competitive domestic container manufacturing industry through financial and institutional support.**
- It also aims to enhance manufacturing capacity to meet India's growing demand for shipping containers.
- The initiative targets **an annual domestic manufacturing capacity of around 10 times the existing container production capacity upto 7.5 lakh Twenty-foot Equivalent Units (TEUs).**
- Financial Outlay: ₹10,000 crore over five years.
- **Capital assistance** for establishing **new Greenfield manufacturing facilities.**
- Support for **expansion of existing Brownfield manufacturing units.**
- Operational support to improve the competitiveness of domestic container manufacturing.

Union Cabinet approves ₹23,731 crore GOBARdhan scheme to fuel CBG sector growth

- The GOBARdhan (Galvanising Organic Bio-Agro Resources Dhan) is a National Circular Bioenergy Scheme that creates a nationwide **waste-to-energy ecosystem**.
- It aims to **increase domestic Compressed Biogas (CBG) production nearly ten-fold**, mobilize large-scale private investment and create a vibrant circular bioeconomy across the country.
- Time Period**: It will be implemented from FY 2026-27 to FY 2035-36 and** will establish Compressed Biogas as a major pillar of India's future energy mix.
- **Nodal Ministry: Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas.**

Components of GOBARdhan Scheme

- Under this, a dedicated framework requires **City Gas Distribution entities to meet a notified CBG blending obligation of 3% in FY27, 4% in FY28, and 5% from FY29 onwards in CNG and PNG segments.**

- It introduces a **stable administered CBG price of Rs.2,110 per Metric Million British Thermal Unit (MMBTU).**
- Eligible **greenfield CBG projects** will receive capital assistance of **up to Rs.2 crore per ton per day (TPD)** of installed CBG capacity.
- **Brownfield projects** expanding their production capacity **will also be eligible.**
- The Scheme supports **both cluster-based and standalone pipeline infrastructure connecting CBG plants** with trunk pipelines and City Gas Distribution networks.
- **A dedicated Credit Guarantee mechanism** will strengthen lender confidence and expand the flow of institutional credit to eligible MSME-based CBG projects.
- **GOBARdhan establishes a dedicated CBG Ecosystem Challenge Fund to accelerate district-level implementation** and strengthen local value chains across the CBG ecosystem

The Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises Development (Amendment) Bill, 2026

- Parliament passed the Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises Development (Amendment) Bill, 2026, after its approval by the Rajya Sabha.
- The MSME Development (Amendment) Bill, 2026 amends the Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises Development Act, 2006 to **improve the business environment for MSMEs through faster payments, streamlined dispute resolution, flexible classification, and decriminalised compliance.**

Flexible Classification of MSMEs:

- Removes fixed statutory investment thresholds.
- Empowers the **Central Government to classify MSMEs based on investment in plant & machinery/equipment and turnover through notifications.**
- Makes MSME **registration voluntary** for all enterprises.
- Enables registration through a Central Government digital platform, with States also permitted to establish digital registration portals.
- Makes it mandatory for Central Public Sector Enterprises (CPSEs) **to settle all MSME procurement invoices through the Trade Receivables Discounting System (TReDS).**
- Allows Central and State Governments to extend this requirement to other public entities.
- Mandates that payment-related mediation before MSME Facilitation Councils or mediation providers must be **completed within 90 days from the first hearing.**
- Requires **arbitration to commence within 30 days if mediation fails.**
- Arbitration awards must be delivered **within 90 days after completion of pleadings.**
- If court **proceedings exceed six months**, **at least 50% of the awarded amount must be paid to the MSME supplier.**
- **Replaces criminal penalties** with a graded system of warnings and monetary penalties.
- Introduces **higher penalties for repeated violations.**
- **Minimum penalty**. amounts will automatically **increase by 10% every three years**
- Appoints the **Development Commissioner (MSME) as the adjudicating authority.**
- Appeals against adjudication orders will lie before the MSME Secretary.

One lakh fishing vessels to be fitted with transponders developed By ISRO soon

- Recently, the Union Department of Fisheries approved the national rollout of the **Vessel Communication and Support System (VCSS)** under the **Pradhan Mantri Matsya Sampada Yojana.**
- It envisages installation of indigenously developed transponders on one lakh marine fishing vessels covering mechanized and motorized vessels of all 13 coastal states and UTs
- It also focuses on **establishment of the required earth station and associated communication infrastructure** and development of the 'Nabhmitra' application in regional languages.
- The transponders are **provided free of cost to eligible fishermen under the project.**
- **Financial Assistance**: The project will be implemented on a **60:40 cost-sharing basis between the Centre and the states, while Union Territories will receive 100 per cent central assistance**.

- Nodal Ministry: **Ministry of Fisheries, Animal Husbandry & Dairying**
- The Vessel Communication and Support System is a satellite **based two-way communication system.**
- It helps the fishers out at sea for sea-safety and security, **provides alerts during adverse weather conditions, 'No Fishing Zones', International Maritime Boundary Line (IMBL) with geo-fencing** and integration with the Nabhmitra App.
- It is being **implemented** with technical support of **Indian Space Research Organization (ISRO).**
- ISRO has also developed the '**Nabhmitra' application** to provide **real-time communication and support services to the marine fishing community.**
- Nabhmitra' application offers a range of features including **periodic position reporting, two-way messaging, emergency and SOS alerts, automatic geo-fencing-based boundary crossing warnings,** weather and cyclone advisories, emergency weather alerts, Potential Fishing Zone (PFZ) information, navigational assistance, and an e-Token/Trip Declaration system.

The Bankers' Books Evidence Bill, 2026

- The Lok Sabha passed The Bankers' Books Evidence Bill, 2026 by voice vote amid Opposition protests.
- The Bill seeks to repeal and **replace the Bankers' Books Evidence Act, 1891.**
- The Bankers' Books Evidence Bill, 2026, is an updated legislative **framework that regulates how bank records are admitted as valid, primary evidence in legal proceedings.**
- Allows certified physical and electronic bank records as admissible evidence without producing original ledgers.
- **Modernizes banking evidence laws to cover digital, virtual, and cloud-based records**.
- **Requires a technical certificate for electronic records, authenticated by designated bank officials.**
- Protects bank officials from routine court appearances unless ordered by a court for a special cause.

Parliament passes Mines and Minerals Amendment Bill

- Parliament passed the Mines and Minerals (Development and Regulation) Amendment Bill, 2026, which seeks to **restrict the power of state governments to levy taxes on mineral rights and mineral-bearing lands.**
- Under the Constitution, **Parliament has the power to regulate mines and mineral development,** to the extent Parliament declares such regulation expedient in the public interest by law **(Entry 54 of Union List).**
- **States** have the power to **regulate mines and mineral development, subject to the provisions of the Union List (Entry 23 of the State List).**
- **States** also have the **power to tax mineral rights, subject to any limitations imposed by Parliament** by law relating to mineral development (Entry 50 of the State List).
- The Mines and Minerals (Development and Regulation) Amendment Bill, 2026 provides for restrictions on states' powers to tax mineral rights and mineral bearing lands.
- The Statement of Objects and Reasons of the Bill notes that **uneven imposition of taxes and other levies by states** in the absence of reasonable limitations has led to several issues.

These include:

(i) a heavy tax burden on the mining sector,
(ii) **unpredictable introduction of taxes**, cess and other levies after commencement of mining operations,
(iii) **multiple taxes and levies on mineral** production or dispatch,
(iv) non-uniform rates across states, and
(v) retrospective imposition of such taxes and levies.

- It states that these issues **increase the cost of mining, discourage mineral extraction, and may make operations commercially unviable**.

Lok Sabha passes Bill to authorise Govt. to permit banks to levy charges on UPI transactions

- Lok Sabha passed a Bill to amend the **Payment and Settlement Systems Act, 2007** that authorises the **government to permit banks and other service providers to levy charges on payments through unified payments interface (UPI)** and other notified electronic payment modes.

- The amendment seeks to remove the existing legal provision **that prevents banks and payment service providers from charging Merchant Discount Rate (MDR)** on notified electronic payment modes.
- Real-time payments made through **RTGS and NEFT are done by paying a service charge.**
- However, **UPI transactions have been exempted from such charges so far.**
- The proposed changes in Payment and Settlement Systems Act is a part of comprehensive legislation on taxation.

Parliament passes Taxation and Other Laws (Amendment) Bill, 2026

- Parliament has passed the Taxation and Other Laws (Amendment) Bill, 2026.
- **The Bill seeks to repeal and replace the Income-tax (Amendment) Ordinance, 2026 issued on June 5, 2026.**
- The Ordinance amended the Income-tax Act, 2025 to **provide exemptions to certain foreign investors in government securities.**
- It also amends the: (i) Finance Act, 2026 and (ii) Payment and Settlement Systems Act, 2007.
- The Bill exempts **foreign institutional investors (FIIs) and the Bank for International Settlements (BIS)** from paying income tax on:
  (i) **interest earned on investments in government securities**, and
  (ii) **capital gains arising from sale, exchange or transfer of such securities**.
- The exemption will **apply to income arising on or after April 1, 2026.**
- The Finance Act, 2026 levies a **surcharge of 10% on income-tax payable by every domestic company** opting for concessional tax rates.
- The **Bill raises surcharge rate to 25%** for a special purpose vehicle of a business trust.
- Business trusts (e.g. REITs and InvITs) pool money from investors to buy and manage assets.
- The Bill also **exempts unit holders of a business trust from tax on the income representing dividends** from such a special purpose vehicle.
- Grants **tax exemptions** to eligible foreign **diamond companies and electronics manufacturers**, including income from **rough diamond sales** and **storage of electronic components in customs bonded warehouses.**

Tribunals Reforms Bill, 2026 passed in Lok Sabha

- Lok Sabha passed the Tribunals Reforms Bill, 2026, which seeks to **replace the Tribunals Reforms Act, 2021**, with a new framework for **appointments, tenure and functioning of tribunals.**
- It comes after the Supreme Court struck down key provisions of the 2021 law in its **November 2025 judgment in Madras Bar Association vs Union of India.**
- The 2021 Act had introduced a common framework for the appointment and service conditions of tribunal Chairpersons and Members. **It prescribed a minimum age of 50 years, a four-year term and required selection committees to recommend a panel of two names for each vacancy.**

National Tribunals Commission proposed

- The biggest change is the creation of a National Tribunals Commission (NTC). **The 2021 Act did not have such a body.**
- The proposed Commission will **oversee the selection of tribunal Chairpersons and Members, review tribunal performance, handle complaints against members and maintain a National Tribunals Data Grid.**
- The Bill provides for **a five-member Commission comprising a Chairperson, two Judicial Members and two Technical Members.**
- The Central Government will appoint the members, after **consulting the Chief Justice of India before appointing the Chairperson and Judicial Members.**

Selection process changes

- The **2021 Act placed the Chief Justice of India (CJI) or a Supreme Court judge nominated by him** at the head of the Search-cum-Selection Committee for most tribunals.
- **Two government secretaries were also members of the committee.**

- The 2026 Bill changes the composition of these committees. **They will be constituted by the NTC and will include members of the Commission, retired High Court judges, a government secretary and experts who assess candidates.**

The recommendation process also changes in the new Bill.

- Under the 2021 Act, **the committee had to recommend two names for each vacancy.**
- Under the 2026 Bill, it will recommend one suitable candidate, along with **another name to be kept on a waiting list.**
- The Bill also changes the timeline for appointments. The 2021 Act said the government should take a decision "**preferably within three months**" of receiving the recommendation.
- The **2026 Bill requires the appointment to be made within three months.**

Five-year tenure replaces four years

- The 2021 Act provided a **four-year term for both Chairpersons and Members, subject to the upper age limits of 70 years and 67 years respectively.**
- The 2026 Bill increases **the tenure to five years**, while retaining the existing upper age limits.
- It also **removes the 2021 Act's provision that a person below 50 years could not be appointed as a Chairperson or Member.**
- The 2021 Act allowed removal for grounds including insolvency, conviction involving moral turpitude, incapacity, conflict of interest and abuse of position.
- The **2026 Bill adds incompetence or inefficiency and undertaking a paid assignment during the term as grounds for removal.**

Existing tribunals remain

- The **2021 Act covered 16 tribunals**, including the National Green Tribunal, Central Administrative Tribunal, Armed Forces Tribunal, Debt Recovery Tribunals, NCLAT, NCDRC and Income-tax Appellate Tribunal.
- **The 2026 Bill continues with the same broad set of 16 tribunals**.
- In September 2023, Navin was made acting director of the agency.
- The Enforcement Directorate is a specialized financial law enforcement and economic intelligence agency operating **under the Department of Revenue, Ministry of Finance, Government of India.**

Parliament passes bill to amend NCDC Act to boost cooperative sector

- The National Co-operative Development Corporation (Amendment) Bill, 2026 was introduced in Lok Sabha on August 10, 2026.
- The Bill seeks to **amend the National Co-operative Development Corporation Act, 1962.**
- The NCDC, a **statutory organisation** under the **Ministry of Cooperation, was established in 1963** under the National Cooperative Development Corporation Act, 1962.
- The National Cooperative Development Corporation Act**, 1962, was amended in 1973, 1974 and 2002.**
- The Bill provides that the Corporation will plan, promote, and finance programmes for co-operative development in **specified areas.**
- Co-operative development is defined as **providing assistance directly or through any intermediary, to co-operative societies.**
- The Act defines foodstuffs to include items such as **eggs, milk, meat, and vegetables.**

The Bill expands the definition to include:

(i) **processed food and other edible products and**

(ii) **any other food items notified by the central government.**

- The Bill also allows the Corporation to **undertake its activities in industrial goods.**

Under the Act, industrial goods are defined as products of specified entities **situated in rural areas:**

(i) industrial co-operatives,

(ii) cottage and village industries, or

(iii) allied industries.

- The Bill **removes the requirement for such entities to be situated in rural areas.**

- The Bill **allows the state governments to also extend funding from the Corporation** to any entity engaged in co-operative development.
- Further, the Corporation may also **provide loans and grants directly to any co-operative society** or entity engaged in co-operative development.
- Under the Act, the **Corporation may invest in the share capital of national-level co-operative societies and those operating in more than one state.**
- The Bill empowers the **Corporation to collect and furnish credit information or other information for efficient discharge of its functions.**

Draft SHANTI Rules 2026 on Nuclear Liability

- The government has released the **draft SHANTI Rules, 2026**, proposing a framework for **nuclear operator liability, insurance and financial security** to support the expansion of nuclear power and greater private-sector participation.
- Under the proposed rules, **nuclear operators would be strictly liable on a no-fault basis** for nuclear damage, including damage caused during the **transportation of nuclear material**.
- **Rule 77** requires nuclear operators to maintain **financial protection** against potential nuclear damage through **insurance, financial security, or a combination of both**, as prescribed under the Act.
- Financial security must remain irrevocable and valid until all spent fuel is removed from the spent-fuel storage pool after discharge from the reactor core.
- Where shares, bonds or other financial instruments are used as security, they must be pledged to the Central Government, **with a 1:1.33 security margin.**
- The proposed framework aims to expand nuclear technology beyond electricity generation to process heat, hydrogen production, medical isotopes, education, training and research.
- For licensed nuclear facilities, **operators would need financial arrangements covering civil liability, operating costs, spent-fuel and radioactive-waste management, decommissioning and site remediation, covering the installation's entire lifecycle**.
- In specified cases, such operators would be exempt from obtaining insurance or other financial security, **with the Central Government assuming liability for damages attributable to the operator.**
- The draft also proposes **a five-yearly review of the maximum civil-liability limits for nuclear damage by an expert group comprising specialists in nuclear science and engineering,** actuarial science, insurance and law, along with public-interest representatives.

Srijan: Voices from the Loom

- The Ministry of Textiles is organising '**Srijan: Voices from the Loom'** in New Delhi to **celebrate the contribution of women weavers to India's handloom heritage.**
- Srijan: Voices from the Loom is a special programme **recognising the stories, skills and contributions of women weavers engaged in India's handloom sector.**
- It provides women artisans a platform to narrate their experiences of resilience, creativity and preservation of traditional weaving practices.

The One Herb, One Standard (OHOS) Initiative

- **The Ministry of Ayush and the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare (MoHFW)** renewed their partnership under the **'One Herb, One Standard' initiative for an additional three years**.
- The 'One Herb, One Standard' initiative is an inter-ministerial collaborative framework designed to establish **unified, scientifically synchronized quality and testing standards (monographs) for medicinal plants used across different systems of medicine in India.**

Implementing Organisations:

- **Pharmacopoeia Commission for Indian Medicine & Homoeopathy (PCIM&H):** Under the Ministry of Ayush.
- **Indian Pharmacopoeia Commission (IPC):** Autonomous body under the Ministry of Health & Family Welfare.

▪ **To eliminate conflicting** quality parameters across different pharmacopoeias, establishing single, clear, and scientifically reliable standards for medicinal herbs to improve the quality, safety, and international credibility of Indian botanical products.

Government Removes 12-Minute Ad Cap for TV Channels

▪ The government has decided to remove the 12-minute advertisement duration cap for television channels to promote fair competition and ease of doing business.

▪ **Dependence on Advertising: In India, television channels—both pay and free-to-air (FTA)—are heavily dependent on advertising revenue.**

▪ The earlier cap created an uneven playing field between traditional television and digital media, as digital platforms are not subject to a similar advertisement-duration restriction.

▪ **The 12-minute cap was introduced in 2006 under the Cable Television Networks Rules, 1994, when India had only 62 TV channels.**

Bharat International Rice Conference to Be Held in October



▪ The Bharat International Rice Conference (BIRC) 2026 is the second edition of the event and will be held from 23 to 25 October 2026 at Bharat Mandapam in New Delhi.

▪ BIRC is a trade platform for the rice sector and is linked to international rice commerce, price discovery, and supply-chain discussions.

▪ The 2026 edition is planned as a global forum for rice exporters, buyers, and industry stakeholders from more than 120 countries.

▪ The inaugural BIRC 2025 was held on 30 and 31 October 2025 at Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi.

Union Minister of State for Health Anupriya Patel unveiled the e-Pratyaropan Digital Platform.

▪ During the 16th Indian Organ Donation Day event in New Delhi, Union Minister of State for Health Anupriya Patel unveiled the e-Pratyaropan Digital Platform.

▪ e-Pratyaropan is an integrated, national-level unified digital platform **designed to digitize and streamline India's organ donation and transplantation ecosystem.**

▪ It serves as a central interface connecting hospitals, transplant surgeons, organ donors, waiting-list recipients, and administrative regulatory bodies into a single, technology-enabled framework.

Ministry Launches 'As Seen on Netflix' on Incredible India Portal

▪ The Ministry of Culture and the Ministry of Tourism launched the '**As Seen on Netflix' section on the Incredible India portal on 5 August 2026.**

▪ The feature was developed with **Netflix India to connect films and series with real locations, cultural traditions, and travel experiences in India.**

▪ The initiative is Netflix's first collaboration with a tourism body in South Asia.

▪ **Similar tourism-linked initiatives have been associated with France, Indonesia, and Korea.**

India Observes 16th Indian Organ Donation Day

▪ The 16th Indian Organ Donation Day on August 3, 2026, featuring key events led by the **Ministry of Health and Family Welfare at the Dr. Ambedkar International Centre in New Delhi.**

▪ The observance focused on **promoting the "Ang Daan – Maha Daan" vision**, releasing new NOTTO digital initiatives, and honoring donor families.

5th edition of SEMICON India 2026 to take place from Sept 17

- Prime Minister Narendra Modi will inaugurate the fifth edition of Semicon India 2026 on September 17.
- The three-day event, to be held between September 17 and 19 in New Delhi,
- **the theme 'Silicon to Systems: Building the Ecosystem',**

New Delhi to host GI & Beyond 2.0 Summit on 5 August

- The **Ministry of Textiles** will organise the '**GI & Beyond 2.0 Summit' in New Delhi** on August 5 to **promote India's Geographical Indication (GI)-tagged handloom and handicraft products** and strengthen their presence in domestic and international markets.
- The summit, being **organised by the Office of the Development Commissioner (Handlooms)** in **association with the Handloom Export Promotion Council (HEPC),** will be held at the Dr. Ambedkar International Centre.
- It will bring together **overseas buyers from around 10 countries, exporters, multinational corporations, registered proprietors of GI products**, government officials and representatives from textile brands, retail chains, e-commerce platforms, academia and industry.
- The Ministry will also launch the **'Digital Handloom Atlas',** a digital platform aimed at **showcasing India's handloom products, including GI-tagged products, and connecting artisans with global markets**.
- The Diamond Jubilee logo of the Handloom Export Promotion Council will also be unveiled.



TRAI launched a revamped version of "TRAI MyCall

- The Telecom Regulatory Authority of India (TRAI) launched a revamped version of "**TRAI MyCall', a mobile application** that enables telecom consumers to **directly assess and report the voice-calling experience.**
- It is a mobile application **launched by the Telecom Regulatory Authority of India (TRAI).**

Bharat Petroleum launches Bharatgas Lite ZIP, a 10kg fibre composite LPG cylinder

- Bharat Petroleum Corporation Limited (BPCL) launched **Bharatgas Lite ZIP – a premium Free Trade LPG (FTL) with instant connection and express delivery.**
- The Lite ZIP comes with a **10kg fibre composite LPG cylinder**.

PM Modi Inaugurates Param Pragya Supercomputing Facility at IIT Delhi

- The Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Delhi held its 57th Convocation Ceremony, with Prime Minister Narendra Modi in attendance as the chief guest.
- PM Modi also inaugurated Param Pragya, an AI-powered high-performance supercomputing facility set up at IIT Delhi's Sonipat campus. Sonipat is a city in the state of Haryana.

NeGD partners with AAERI to launch new digital platform 'AAERI Verify'

- **The National e-Governance Division- NeGD**, under the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology, has **partnered with the Association of Australian Education Representatives in India**, AAERI, to launch a **new digital platform, AAERI Verify.**
- The platform is **integrated with DigiLocker**, will enable Indian students applying to Australian universities to **securely and digitally verify their academic, identity and financial documents.**

On August 1, 1920, Mahatma Gandhi launched the Non-Cooperation (Asahayog) Movement

- The Non-Cooperation Movement (NCM) was the **first nationwide movement launched by Gandhiji in 1920** during British rule.
- **Rowlatt Act and the brutal Jaliawala Bagh Massacre were the immediate causes** for launching the movement.

▪ However, the movement was **called off by Gandhi on February 11, 1922**, **following the Chauri Chaura** incident in the Gorakhpur district of Uttar Pradesh.

5 August - Article 370 abrogation



▪ It is now seven years since the abrogation of Article 370 of the Constitution and the reorganisation of the erstwhile state of Jammu and Kashmir into two Union Territories (UTs).

▪ **Article 370** in the Indian constitution **gave special status to Jammu and Kashmir,** a region disputed by India, Pakistan and China.

▪ It **was drafted by N Gopalaswami Ayyangar,** a member of the **Constituent Assembly** of India, and was **added to the constitution as a 'temporary provision' in 1949.**

▪ It **allowed the state to have its own constitution, flag and autonomy** over most matters **except defence, foreign affairs and communications**.

▪ It was **based on the terms of the Instrument of Accession,** which was **signed by** the ruler of Jammu and Kashmir, **Hari Singh, in 1947 to join India** after an invasion by Pakistan.

RSVC-AMRIT Platform

▪ Recently, the **Principal Scientific Adviser** to the Government of India **launched the RSVC AMRIT platform.**

▪ It is **developed by NABARD** in **collaboration with the Office of the Principal Scientific Adviser** (OPSA) to the Government of India.

▪ **AMRIT Platform serves as the digital backbone of the RuTAGe Smart Village Centre (RSVC) ecosystem.**

▪ **Focus:** It supports rural innovation and technology transfer and enables **wider adoption of appropriate technologies in rural areas.**

▪ It is designed as a comprehensive digital ecosystem supporting the complete RSVC lifecycle, from technology discovery and validation to deployment tracking, collaboration, monitoring and knowledge management.

▪ The platform will **progressively bring together innovators, technology providers, startups, validators, accelerators, implementation partners, funding agencies, academic institutions and rural communities on a shared platform.**

What is The Rural Technology Action Group (RuTAG)?

▪ It is an initiative of the **Office of the Principal Scientific Adviser (OPSA) which was launched in 2004.**

▪ It was conceptualized as a **mechanism to provide a higher level of Science &Technology intervention and support for rural areas.**

Tobacco Board enhances interest-free loans under Growers' Welfare Scheme

▪ The Tobacco Board has increased the **interest-free loans offered under its Growers' Welfare Scheme** for various purposes, including **medical treatment, marriage of daughters, education, and repair of damaged barns.**

▪ The government has enhanced **not just the interest-free loans but also the death grant,** following amendments to the Board's Growers' Welfare Schemes.

▪ The death grant has been raised **from ₹50,000 to ₹1,00,000 in cases of natural death**, and from **₹1,00,000 to ₹2,00,000 in cases of accidental death.**

▪ **The interest-free loan for treatment of major illness** or accident cases requiring surgery has been increased from **₹50,000 to ₹1,00,000.**

▪ A similar enhancement **— from ₹50,000 to ₹1,00,000** — has been **made for the marriage of daughters and the education of dependent children of growers.**

▪ For **repair of barns damaged by natural calamity or fire,** the loan amount has **been increased from ₹20,000 to ₹40,000 for partial damage, and from ₹50,000 to ₹1,00,000 for full or heavy damage.**

Institution / Board	Headquarters
Coffee Board of India	Bengaluru (Karnataka)

Rubber Board of India	Kottayam (Kerala)
Tobacco Board of India	Guntur (Andhra Pradesh)
Tea Board of India	Kolkata (West Bengal)
Spices Board of India	Kochi (Kerala)
National Turmeric Board	Nizamabad (Telangana)

Friends of MY Bharat' Initiative

- Recently, the **Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports** has launched a new digital initiative, **'Friends of MY Bharat' initiative.**
- It is an initiative of the Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports.
- It strengthens **engagement with Indian-origin youth living across the world and provides them opportunities to participate in India's nation-building and youth-led programmes.**
- It is developed through the **Mera Yuva Bharat (MY Bharat) platform**
- It will **enable Indian-origin students, young professionals and other youth residing outside India to access information about nation-building activities**, volunteering opportunities and youth programmes hosted on the MY Bharat platform.
- A dedicated **'Know Your India' section will offer curated information on India's culture, heritage, history, tourism, travel** and prominent leaders.

What is MY Bharat Platform?

- **MY Bharat (Mera Yuva Bharat) was launched in October 2023** under the **Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports**.
- The initiative aims to **place youth at the centre of nation-building by providing opportunities for volunteering, skill development, leadership and civic participation.**
- It serves as a digital platform that connects the Government, educational institutions, non-profit organisations and industry to create meaningful youth engagement

National Medical Commission proposes single licence for doctors to practise across India

- The National Medical Commission (NMC) has proposed a **registration system under which a medical practitioner**, once **registered with a State Medical Council** and **allotted a Unique Identification** (UID) number in the National Medical Register, would be **eligible to practise across India without obtaining fresh registration or a licence in another State.**
- It is a **statutory body constituted by the National Medical Commission Act, 2019**, which came into force on September 25, 2020.
- It replaced the **Medical Council of India (MCI)** and serves as the **top regulatory authority for medical education, medical professionals, and medical institutions in India.**
- It grants recognition of medical qualifications, gives accreditation to medical schools, grants registration to medical practitioners, monitors medical practice, and assesses the medical infrastructure in India.
- **Headquarters: New Delhi**
- National Medical Commission consists of **33 members, including the Chairperson (medical professionals only), 10 ex-officio members and 22 part-time members.**

Dak MITRA and Dak Sewa Apps

- Recently, the Union Minister for Communications launched the **revamped Dak Sewa App and Dak MITRA App at a function in New Delhi.**

About **Dak MITRA App**

- The **upgraded Dak MITRA** (Mobile Interface for Transactions & Rural Assistance) application **serves as a unified operational platform for more than 1.4 lakh Branch Post Offices.**
- It is developed **indigenously by the Centre for Excellence in Postal Technology (CEPT) under the Advanced Postal Technology (APT) platform** as part of DoP IT 2.0 Modernization,
- It enables Branch Postmasters to undertake paperless and real-time postal and financial transactions.

- It includes mail booking, **OTP-based doorstep delivery, Core Banking Services, insurance services, Aadhaar-based biometric e-KYC, cash deposits and withdrawals etc**

Key Facts **about Dak Sewa App**

- It provides **citizens with 24×7 access to postal services, including tracking, booking, complaints; Post Office and PIN code locators, and financial calculators.**
- It supports 23 Indian languages through BHASHINI

SAIL Bhilai Steel Plant Launches CO2 Dashboard

- **Steel Authority of India Limited (SAIL) launched a digital CO2 Dashboard at Bhilai Steel Plant.**
- **SAIL is a Maharatna public sector undertaking** under the **Ministry of Steel.**
- The platform **tracks carbon emissions** for Bhilai Steel Plant in Chhattisgarh and Chandrapur Ferro Alloy Plant in Maharashtra.
- The CO2 Dashboard provides **real-time calculation and analysis of daily carbon dioxide emissions.**

National Campaign on Entrepreneurship-II Launched for Rural Women

- **Ministry of Rural Development** launched the **'National Campaign on Entrepreneurship- II'** under **the Deendayal Antyodaya Yojana–National Rural Livelihoods Mission (DAY-NRLM)** for another **three months**, from 21 August to 21 November 2026, with an expanded **focus on both Farm, Non-Farm enterprises and marketing of SHG products.**
- The campaign has been designed to promote and focus intensively on promoting rural women entrepreneurship.
- 'Sankalp Shakti', the first Rural Enterprise Technical Bulletin, was also released , This Bulletin will be a monthly feature.

GENESIS EIR Cohort-3 Launched for Early-Stage Startups

- The **Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY),** through **MeitY Startup Hub (MSH),** has launched the third cohort of its **GENESIS Entrepreneur-in-Residence** (EIR) **programme** to support **aspiring entrepreneurs, innovators, researchers, students and early-stage startup founders** in turning technology-driven ideas into viable ventures.
- GENESIS EIR 3.0 was launched at the GENESIS NextGen Startup Summit – Coimbatore Edition.
- The programme is part of the **GENESIS (Gen-Next Support for Innovative Startups) scheme**, which seeks to identify, support and accelerate startups, particularly **those emerging from Tier-II and Tier-III cities.**
- Under the Entrepreneur-in-Residence component, selected innovators will **receive financial assistance of up to Rs 10 lakh through participating GENESIS incubators, along with incubation, mentorship and access to the wider startup ecosystem.**
- Applicants must be Indian citizens and may include entrepreneurs, innovators, researchers, students or founders and co-founders of early-stage startups.

Pradhan Mantri Jan Dhan Yojana completes 12 years

- **PMJDY completes 12 years on August 28, 2026**, emerging as the **world's largest financial inclusion programme**.
- Nearly **100% households** and over **90% adults** in India now have a bank account.
- **Launched in 2014**, PMJDY was designed to provide **universal access to banking for the unbanked.**
- Its objectives include **zero-balance accounts, RuPay debit cards, insurance, pensions, and Direct Benefit Transfers (DBTs).**
- The scheme has reduced reliance on moneylenders and informal credit networks, historically a trap for the poor.

The Prime Minister of India chaired the 53rd meeting of the PRAGATI platform

- **PRAGATI** (Pro-Active Governance and Timely Implementation) is the Government of India's flagship **platform launched in 2015.**
- It focuses on **fast-tracking projects, schemes, and grievance redressal through direct, real-time review by the Prime Minister,** in partnership with States and Union Ministries.

- The system has been **designed in-house by the PMO team with the help of the National Informatics Center (NIC).**
- It uniquely brings together three modern technologies—digital data management, video conferencing, and geospatial technology.
- It is a **three-tier system (PMO, Union Government Secretaries, and Chief Secretaries of the States**).
- At the **apex level**, the **Prime Minister chairs PRAGATI review meetings with Chief Secretaries of States and Secretaries of Central Ministries/Departments** to resolve issues related to identified projects and schemes.
- The design is such that when PM reviews the issue, he should have on his screen the issue as well as the latest updates and visuals regarding the same.
- Following the meetings, **a multi-tier follow-up mechanism ensures timely implementation of decisions.**
- **Projects are monitored by the Cabinet Secretariat**, while schemes and **grievances are reviewed at the Ministry level under continuous oversight of the Prime Minister's Office (PMO).**
- Issues to be flagged before the PM are picked up from the available database regarding public grievances, ongoing programmes, and pending projects

5 Years of e-Shram Portal completes five years

- The e-Shram Portal is **India's first comprehensive, Aadhaar-authenticated National Database of Unorganised Workers (NDUW).**
- It assigns **every registered worker a portable 12-digit Universal Account Number (UAN)** and serves as a unified digital platform connecting the informal workforce to social security benefits, job portals, skilling opportunities, and pension plans.
- **Launch Date: August 26, 2021.**
- **Nodal Ministry: Ministry of Labour and Employment (MoLE), Government of India.**
- Aim: To build a **centralized, verifiable national registry of the unorganised workforce**, facilitate the convergence and portability of multi-ministerial **welfare schemes, and ensure seamless delivery of social security benefits**—especially during economic disruptions and national emergencies.
- **The One-Stop Solution brings together 15 Social Security and Welfare Schemes on a single platform**.
- The portal **connects workers with the National Career Service (NCS) for employment opportunities.**
- Workers can also use mySchemeto identify government schemes for which they may be eligible.

National Shipping Board

- Recently, the National Shipping Board (NSB) held its **first 'Sagar Samvad'** and has **proposed a five-point roadmap to add 100 vessels to India's merchant fleet over the next five years.**
- National Shipping Board is a **permanent statutory body established in 1959, under Section 4 of Merchant Shipping Act, 1958.**
- It **advises the Govt. of India on matters related to shipping** including the development.

Composition

- It **consists of Chairman and Members.**
- **Six Members elected by Parliament** (Four from the Lok Sabha and two from Rajya Sabha from amongst its Members).
- **Tenure: The Chairman and other members of the Board held office for a period of two years.**
- **Nodal Ministry: Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways**

'Khelo India Samvad – Khel Ki Baat PM Ke Saath' aims to connect youth with vision of national sports

- The Union Ministry of Youth Affairs & Sports is organising **'Khelo India Samvad – Khel Ki Baat PM Ke Saath**' in two colleges in **every district of Punjab and Haryana and the Union Territory of Chandigarh** on August 27 with an aim to **connect youth with the national vision of sports, fitness and youth-led nation building.**
- The Samvad will be organized by Mera Yuva Bharat (MY Bharat) of the Department of Youth Affairs of the Ministry.

- During the programme, youth will also be encouraged to register on the MY Bharat portal and will have the opportunity to submit their suggestions digitally through the MY Bharat Suggestions Box.
- The Viksit Bharat Young Leaders Dialogue (VBYLD) 2027 Quiz will also be promoted among the participants.

The Union Rural Development Minister launched the Mission Samriddh Gaon scheme

- It is aimed at **developing poverty-free, employment-rich villages equipped with assured basic amenities.**
- The pilot models will be developed in Budni block of Sehore district and Khategaon block of Dewas district(MP).
- Objective: To develop model villages where every family has an employment or livelihood opportunity, basic amenities are available and people do not have to migrate out of compulsion.
- **Nodal Ministry: Ministry of Rural Development**

Gnani Artha Sovereign AI Stack

- Vice President of India launched 'Gnani Artha', an indigenously developed sovereign Artificial Intelligence (AI) stack comprising the Evon 3.3 language model and the Plexus agentic platform.
- Gnani Artha is an end-to-end, indigenous sovereign AI technology stack designed specifically for Indian enterprises and public institutions.
- To build indigenous, secure, and cost-effective frontier AI capabilities that safeguard data sovereignty, address linguistic nuances across Indian languages, and reduce enterprise dependence on proprietary foreign AI models and cloud systems.

It integrates two core components:

- **Evon 3.3**: An open-weights, 30-billion-parameter foundation **Large Language Model (LLM)** fine-tuned with Indic-language datasets and domain-specific tokens.
- **Plexus:** An enterprise-grade agentic AI orchestration platform that translates raw machine intelligence into autonomous, goal-oriented workflows across institutional applications.
- **Company: GNANI AI** (a Bengaluru-based conversational and voice-AI deep-tech startup).

The Union Ministry of Tribal Affairs launched the Jago AI Assistant.

- It is an **AI conversational assistant to extend the reach of tribal welfare schemes and programmes**.
- It is an initiative of the **Ministry of Tribal Affairs.**
- The AI-powered chatbot is designed **to simplify access to information related to tribal welfare schemes, government policies, programmes, guidelines, and official documents.**
- It enables them to **ask questions in simple language and receive relevant responses faster.**
- Currently the languages **available in Jago are English and Hindi.**

Hon'ble Vice President of India to Release "Mission Rangeen Machhli 2031" Strategic Action Plan for Ornamental Fisheries Development



- The Department of Fisheries, Ministry of Fisheries, Animal Husbandry & Dairying Government of India is organizing an **Outreach Programme of Ministry of Fisheries, Govt. of India at Agatti, Lakshadweep .**
- The Hon'ble Vice President will Release **"Mission Rangeen Machhli 2031" Strategic Action Plan for Ornamental Fisheries Development.**

The Integrated Fertilizer Management System (iFMS)

- The **Department of Fertilizers** has transitioned the **Integrated Fertilizer Management System (iFMS)** into a **comprehensive, data-driven oversight platform** by integrating it with **state land records, Meri Fasal Mera Byora (MFMB), and the central AgriStack.**
- The Integrated Fertilizer Management System (iFMS) is a **national end-to-end digital tracking and enterprise resource platform.**

▪ It **monitors every stage of India's fertilizer ecosystem**—from domestic production and port imports to railway/road movement, district stock availability, Point of Sale (PoS) retail transactions to verified buyers, and direct-benefit-transfer (DBT) subsidy settlements.

▪ **Nodal Department: Department of Fertilizers, Ministry of Chemicals and Fertilizers**, Government of India.

▪ Aim: To ensure transparent and equitable fertiliser supply, prevent diversion, and enable verified DBT subsidy payments based on actual retail sales.

Legal Metrology (Indian Standard Time) Rules, 2026

▪ The Union government has notified the **Legal Metrology (Indian Standard Time) Rules, 2026**, mandating Indian Standard Time (IST) as the **single reference for legal, administrative, commercial and official purposes.**

▪ The Rules will **come into force 180 days after publication in the Official Gazette.**

▪ The Rules establish IST as India's uniform official time standard, ensuring that government, commercial and critical digital systems use a common, synchronised time reference.

▪ **Nodal Ministry: Ministry of Consumer Affairs, Food and Public Distribution.**

▪ Technical Institutions: **CSIR–National Physical Laboratory (NPL), ISRO and Legal Metrology laboratories**, along with other participating institutions.



Need for Uniform IST:

▪ **Digital Synchronisation**: Banking, payments, telecom and computer networks require precise timestamps for reliable transactions and records.

▪ **Critical Infrastructure**: Power grids, railways, airports and emergency services require synchronised timing for safe operations.

▪ **Strategic Autonomy**: Dependence on foreign satellite timing sources creates vulnerabilities for critical national infrastructure.

Key Features:

▪ **Single National Standard:** Makes IST the mandatory reference for legal, administrative, commercial and other official purposes.

▪ **180-Day Transition:** Provides organisations time to upgrade and synchronise existing systems.

▪ **Indigenous Timing Sources: Enables NavIC and other approved Indian sources for secure time dissemination.**

▪ **White Rabbit Technology:** Demonstrates high-precision IST transmission for banking, telecom, power, transport and digital governance.

▪ **Domestic Timing Network**: Builds dissemination infrastructure through Indian institutions and Legal Metrology laboratories, reducing reliance on foreign systems.

Eminent Personality in News

The Prime Minister paid tributes to Pingali Venkayya on his birth anniversary (2nd August)

▪ **Born on 2nd August 1876** in a village **near Machilipatnam in Krishna District, Andhra Pradesh**.

▪ **In 1916**, Pingali Venkayya published a **booklet titled A National Flag for India**, featuring nearly 30 designs for a **potential Indian flag,** inspired by flags of other nations.

▪ **Venkayya's design for the National Flag** was finally **approved by Mahatma Gandhi** in a **Congress meeting in Vijayawada in 1921.**

▪ In 2009, a **postage stamp** was released for his contribution.

President V V Giri birth anniversary

▪ **On 10th August 1894**, Varahagiri Venkata Giri was **born in Berhampur, Odisha.**

- VV Giri served as the **4th president of India from 24 August 1969 to 24 August 1974** and **3rd vice president of India** from 13 May 1967 to 3 May 1969.
- He is the **first president to be elected as an independent candidate**.
- **Bharat Ratna in 1975.**
- Giri died on 24 June 1980.

Nation remembers Dr. Vikram Sarabhai, Father of India's Space Programme, on his birth anniversary.

- Vikram Sarabhai was **born on August 12, 1919.**
- Based on his persuasion, the Indian government agreed to set up the **Indian National Committee for Space Research (INCOSPAR)in 1962**. He was **the first chairman of the committee.**
- The **INCOSPAR** was restructured and **renamed as Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) in 1969.**
- **Sarabhai founded the Physical Research Laboratory in Ahmedabad in 1947.**
- He also **set up India's first rocket launch site in Thumba,** a small village **near the Thiruvananthapuram airport in Kerala**.
- Vikram Sarabhai was also **responsible for bringing cable television to India.** His constant contact with NASA paved a way for the **establishment of Satellite Instructional Television Experiment (SITE) in 1975.**
- Sarabhai was **the mastermind behind building India's first satellite, Aryabhata.**
- He was **one of the founding members of the Indian Institute of Management, Ahmedabad (IIMA).**
- Vikram Sarabhai received **the Padma Bhushan in 1966** for his contribution to India's progress. He was also awarded **the Padma Vibhushan in 1972, posthumously.**

PM paid tributes on Sri Aurobindo's Birth Anniversary

- **Sri Aurobindo was** a yogi, **philosopher, spiritual leader, and freedom fighter** who linked nation-building with spiritual evolution.
- **Full Name**: **Aurobindo Ghose**
- **Born: 15 August 1872, Kolkata** (then Calcutta)
- **Died**: **5 December 1950**, Pondicherry (now Puducherry)
- **Education: Studied in England** (Manchester, London, Cambridge).
- **Returned to India in 1893** and worked in Baroda as an academic and administrator before entering nationalist politics.
- One of the **early leaders of Indian nationalism** against British colonial rule.
- **Advocated Purna Swaraj** (complete independence) much before it became the Congress demand.
- After 1910, withdrew from politics and settled in **Pondicherry**
- **Founded Sri Aurobindo Ashram in 1926** with Mirra Alfassa ("The Mother")
- **Developed Integral Yoga, blending material progress with spiritual growth.**

Literary Contributions:

- **Philosophical Works** – The Life Divine, The Synthesis of Yoga, Essays on the Gita.
- **Poetry and Epics** – Savitri: A Legend and a Symbol.
- **Political and Cultural Writings** – The Human Cycle, The Ideal of Human Unity.

Death Anniversary of Atal Bihari Vajpayee Observed on August 16, 2026

- **Born**: **25 December 1924**, Gwalior, Madhya Pradesh (then British India)
- **Died**: **16 August 2018**, New Delhi
- **Entered national politics during Quit India Movement of 1942** .
- In 1947, Vajpayee started working as a journalist for newspapers of **Deendayal Upadhyaya**
- Later, influenced by **Syama Prasad Mookerjee, Vajpayee joined the Bharatiya Jana Sangh in 1951.**

Political Career

- **Parliamentary Career:** Elected to Lok Sabha **10 times** between 1957 and 2009.
- **Foreign Minister (1977–79)** in the Morarji Desai government → remembered for his speech in **Hindi at the UN General Assembly** (1977), a first for an Indian minister.
- **Prime Minister of India:**
  - **May 1996** → First BJP PM; government lasted only 13 days.
  - **1998–1999** → Formed government but lost majority after 13 months.
  - **1999–2004** → Full 5-year term, first non-Congress PM to complete a full tenure.

Awards & Recognition

- **Bharat Ratna** (2015) – India's highest civilian award.
- **Padma Vibhushan** (1992).
- **Pandit Govind Ballabh Pant** Award for **Best Parliamentarian** (1994).
- His birthday, **25 December**, is observed as **Good Governance Day** in India since 2014

Birth Anniversary Maharaja Bir Bikram Kishore Manikya Bahadur



- Bir Bikram Kishore Manikya Bahadur was a **king of Tripura State - born on 19th August 1908** in Tripura
- He is known as **"the architect of modern Tripura".**
- He was **succeeded by his son, Maharaja Kirit Bikram Kishore Debbarman**, who was the nominal king for two years till the **state's merger into India in 1949**
- He **established the first higher educational institution,** advocated for **land reforms, and reserved land for the indigenous people**, leading to the formation of the **Tripura Tribal Areas Autonomous District Council (TTAADC).**
- He was the **first ruler of Tripura to visit Europe and America** (1931-1939).
- He **passed away at the young age of 39 in 1947** untimely death impacted the development of Tripura.
- **Agartala airport, earlier known as Singerbhil Airport**, was **renamed after Maharaja Bir Bikram Kishore Manikya Bahadur in July 2018.**

Tripura:

- Capita: Agartala
- Tripura is the **2nd most populous in the northeast region (after Assam),** sharing borders with **Bangladesh, Mizoram and Assam.**

Death anniversary of Shehnai maestro and Bharat Ratna awardee Ustad Bismillah Khan

- Ustad Bismillah Khan, the legendary shehnai maestro, belonged to the **Banaras Gharana**
- **Originally known as Qamruddin Khan**, Bismillah Khan was **born on 21st March 1916 in Dumraon, Bihar and Orissa province**, British India.
- **Died : 21 August 2006**
- He has **played at the first Republic Day celebration in 1950.**
- Bismillah Khan was the **first Indian to be invited** to perform at the prestigious **Lincoln Centre Hall** in the United States of America.

Year	Award
1956	Sangeet Natak Akademi Award
1961	Padma Shri
1980	Padma Vibhushan
1992	Talar Mausiquee from Republic of Iran
2001	Bharat Ratna, the nation's highest civilian award

▪ **Ustad Bismillah Khan Yuva Puruskar** was instituted by the **Sangeet Natak Akademi** in the name of Bharat Ratna Ustad Bismillah Khan **for young performing art practitioners up to the age of 40 years** in 2006.
Ur▪ The **Yuva Puraskar carries a purse of Rs 25,000/-** (Rupees twenty-five thousand only), a plaque and an angavastram.

26 August - Mother Teresa Birth Anniversary

▪ **Born on August 26, 1910, in Skopje, Macedonia**
▪ **On October 7, 1950, Mother Teresa established** the **Missionaries of Charity in Kolkata**
▪ Mother Teresa garnered numerous awards, including the **Ramon Magsaysay Peace Prize in 1962** and the **Nobel Peace Prize in 1979**
▪ **Passed away on September 5, 1997.**

State

Ladakh



Ladakh to Launch India's First High-Altitude Wildlife Safari

▪ Ladakh approved India's first guided high-altitude wildlife safari on 6 August 2026.
▪ The plan covers **snow-leopard and bird-watching** trails in **Hemis National Park, Changthang, Karakoram Wildlife Sanctuary, Nubra, Zanskar, Sham, Kargil and Drass.**
▪ The safari will use specially designed open-back jeep vehicles.
▪ The vehicles are **modelled on safari operations in Kaziranga National Park and Ranthambore National Park.**

Nation's First Black-Necked Crane Festival

▪ India's inaugural **Black-Necked Crane Festival** takes place from August 11–14, 2026, **across Leh, Tso Kar, and Hanle in Ladakh.**
▪ There are around 16,000 Black-Necked Cranes distributed across **India, Bhutan, China and Nepal.**

Conservation Status of **Black-Necked Crane**

▪ **IUCN: Near Threatened**
▪ **CITES: Appendices I**
▪ **Wild Life (Protection) Act, 1972: Schedule I**
▪ It is also protected under the Convention on the Conservation of Migratory Species of Wild Animals.

Cabinet approves establishment of Bench of High Court of Jammu and Kashmir in Ladakh

▪ The Union Cabinet has decided to establish a High Court Bench in Ladakh, a move aimed at improving access to justice in the Union Territory.
▪ The High Court currently functions from Srinagar and Jammu, and the Ladakh bench will become its third location.

Jammu & Kashmir

Bhairav Yatra now has a cultural heritage tag

▪ The historic Bhairav Yatra **of Rajouri district in Jammu and Kashmir** has been added to the National Inventory of Intangible Cultural Heritage of India.
▪ **Rajouri's Bhairav Yatra is a centuries-old sacred procession.**
▪ While its exact origin year is not historically documented, generations have celebrated the vibrant festival.
▪ It is held annually in the **main markets of the border district just before Holi.**
▪ The procession is **dedicated to Lord Kaal Bhairav, an avatar of Lord Shiva.**

- During the procession, a devotee embodies the form of 'Baba' Bhairav Dev, with his entire body painted black.
- Devotees receive blessings by symbolically touching the chimta (ritual tongs) held by the 'Baba'.
- **India also submits one nomination every year for inclusion in the UNESCO Intangible Cultural Heritage of Humanity list.**

Ujh Multipurpose Project



- The Union Minister of State for Prime Minister's Office recently reviewed the status and phased implementation roadmap of the **Ujh Multipurpose Project in the Kathua district of Jammu and Kashmir.**
- It is a multipurpose (Hydropower, Irrigation, and Drinking) project in the Kathua District of Jammu and Kashmir on the River Ujh, which **is a major tributary of River Ravi.**
- The project, which was declared as a **"national project" in the year 2008**, involves the construction of a 116-metre-high concrete-faced rockfill dam.
- It is expected to generate between **186 MW and 212 MW of hydroelectric power.**
- It is designed to provide irrigation to nearly 90,000 hectares of agricultural land across Kathua and Samba districts in Jammu and Kashmir, besides Pathankot and Gurdaspur districts in Punjab.

Mushk Budji



- **Kashmir's indigenous aromatic rice variety, 'Mushk Budji',** which was **granted the GI tag three years ago**, is facing the problem of plenty with the government's crop expansion to **"unsuitable" areas hitting prices**, farmers said recently.
- It is a **highly aromatic short-grain rice variety native to Kashmir.**
- It is **usually grown at an altitude ranging from 5000 to 7000 ft** above mean sea level in the Highland Himalayas in the higher reaches of the Kashmir Valley.
- It is often used on **special occasions and festivals.**
- It received a Geographical Indication (GI) tag on 31 July 2023
- **Grain & Appearance:** It has a light, ivory colour and a slightly translucent appearance.
- **Cooked grains remain slightly sticky**, somewhat chewy, and imbued with fragrance.
- **It has a delicate, nutty flavour.**
- It is rich in **carbohydrates, fiber, and select B-vitamins.**
- It's light on fat and easy to digest, making it suitable even for fasting or digestive-sensitive meals

Jammu hosts 'Euphoria' cultural event at Tawi Wonderland Park

- **Jammu Smart City Limited (JSCL)** recently hosted a massive cultural event titled **"Euphoria – An Evening to Celebrate Culture"** at the newly inaugurated **Tawi Wonderland Park** in Bhagwati Nagar, Jammu.
- Organised by Jammu Smart City Limited.
- The evening featured Ganesh Vandana, Dogri and Punjabi songs, traditional Dogri and Kashmiri dances and Punjabi performances.

Himachal Pradesh

Indo-China border trade through Himachal's Shipki La to resume after six-year

- The cross-border trade between India and China through **Shipki La**, known as the ancient Silk Route joining India with Tibet, **resumed (August 1, 2026) after a gap of six years.**

▪ He also inaugurated a modern trade mart (Chhuppan Trade Mart) constructed in the **Shipki La area in the border Gram Panchayat of Namgya in Himachal's Kinnaur district** at a cost of ₹1.70 crore to facilitate border trade,
▪ It is a high mountain pass, **bordering India and China in the tribal district of Kinnaur in Himachal Pradesh.**
▪ Situated at an altitude of 3,930 meters, **it is one of the highest motorable passes.**
▪ The **old name of Shipki La was Pema La, or Shared Gate,** also known as Shared Pass.
▪ It was declared the Line of Actual Control post-1962, and later, the Indo-Tibetan Border Police named it Shipki La.
▪ **The Sutlej River (known as Langqen Zangbo in Tibet) enters India through this pass**, flowing from the Tibet Autonomous Region.

Himachal Pradesh Becomes Fifth State to Ban Sale of Analogue Paneer

▪ Himachal Pradesh issued a **state-wide ban on the manufacture, storage, distribution and sale of non-dairy analogue paneer .**
▪ Analogue paneer is a **paneer-like food product made without full dairy milk solids.**
▪ Under the state order, such products cannot be sold or displayed as "paneer" in Himachal Pradesh.
▪ The other states that have taken similar action are **Maharashtra, Gujarat, Chhattisgarh and Madhya Pradesh**

Punjab

Short news

▪ In Punjab, **National Commission for Women (NCW)** launched its "Yashoda AI" initiative in Jalandhar to promote digital empowerment and greater participation of women in emerging technologies

Delhi

CIC Launches AppCoMS 2.0 for RTI Appeals



▪ The Central Information Commission (CIC) launched the **upgraded Appeal and Complaint Management System 2.0 (AppCoMS 2.0) in New Delhi.**
▪ The portal is **used for Second Appeals and Complaints under the Right to Information Act, 2005.**
▪ AppCoMS is the CIC's **online case-management platform for registration, scheduling, notice generation, and decision upload.**
▪ The upgraded system provides dedicated user accounts for applicants, linked with email IDs and mobile numbers.
▪ Applicants can **file appeals, track case timelines, and download notices and decisions through the portal.**

India to host 12th BRICS Environment Ministers Meeting in New Delhi



▪ India will host the twelfth BRICS Environment Ministers Meeting in New Delhi
▪ The event will be held under the overarching theme of India's BRICS Chairship 2026 **– Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability.**
▪ The BRICS Environment Ministers' Meeting would be presided over by Union Minister for Environment, Forest and Climate Change, Bhupender Yadav.
▪ The priority areas are **Promoting Sustainable Lifestyles, Afforestation, Forest Fire Management and Disaster Resilience, Circular Economy, and Adaptation.**

Delhi government has approved 20% horizontal reservation for ex-Agniveers in direct recruitment to fire operator posts in Delhi Fire Services

- Delhi Lieutenant Governor (LG) Taranjit Singh Sandhu has **approved a 20% horizontal reservation for former Agniveers in direct recruitment to the post of fire operator in the Delhi Fire Services and to posts of warder and matron in the Prison department.**
- **Age Relaxation**: Former Agniveers will receive an exemption of **three years over** and above the regular upper age limit.
- **First Batch Benefit: Candidates belonging to the very first batch of the Agnipath scheme will get an extended five-year age relaxation.**
- **The 20 per cent reservation will be available to all ex-Agniveers on the lines of other horizontal reservation categories.**

President unveils statue of freedom fighter & social reformer Utkalmani Pandit Gopabandhu Das in New Delhi

- President of India unveiled the statue of eminent freedom fighter, social reformer, and pioneer **journalist Utkalmani Pandit Gopabandhu Das** at Lajpat Bhawan in New Delhi.
- Utkalmani Pandit Gopabandhu Das (1877–1928) was an iconic freedom fighter, social reformer, educationist, poet, and pioneering journalist from Odisha.
- Revered with the title **Utkalmani (meaning The Jewel of Odisha), he dedicated his life to national independence, linguistic consolidation of Odia-speaking regions**, open-air education, and the selfless service of flood and famine victims.
- Appointed as the **founding President of the Utkal Pradesh Congress Committee (UPCC) in 1920,** bringing Odisha into the mainstream of the national movement led by the Indian National Congress.
- **Spearheaded Mahatma Gandhi's Non-Cooperation Movement across Odisha**, encouraging youth to leave British schools and courts.
- **Satyabadi Bana Bidyalaya (1909):** Founded an open-air residential school at **Sakhigopal near Puri based on the Gurukula model.**
- Started the historic **Odia newspaper The Samaja** in 1919, Written in simple, lucid Odia prose.
- He authored inspiring **nationalist literature during his incarceration, including Bandi R Atmakatha (Story of a Prisoner), Dharmapada, and Kara Kabita.**
- he passed away on June 17, 1928, at the age of 50.

A workshop on the AIKosh platform was organised at the India Habitat Centre, New Delhi

- It is a **national platform for datasets, AI models and related resources.**
- It aims to enhance access to datasets and models from various **sources to boost AI innovation, support AI solution development with shared toolkits**, and showcase use cases to inspire new applications.
- It also features AI sandbox capabilities through an integrated development environment along with tools and tutorials.
- It is an **initiative under the IndiaAI Mission.**
- Nodal Ministry: **Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY).**

What is IndiaAI Mission?

- It was initially launched as a **joint initiative** between the **Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology and Nasscom in 2023.**
- **Aim: To bolster India's AI ecosystem by making high-end computing resources accessible to startups and researchers.**

Short News

▪ The Vice President, Shri C. P. Radhakrishnan, inaugurated 'MALHAR 2026', a youth-centric, monsoon-themed celebration of Indian classical music by Antar Hriday Connect, in New Delhi.

Uttar Pradesh

UP govt to provide free travel in State Roadways buses for women aged 60 years and above



▪ The Uttar Pradesh government provides free travel in state-run roadways (UPSRTC) buses for **women aged 60 years and above.**

▪ The state **government allocated ₹100 crore in the First Supplementary Budget** of the financial year 2026–27 to implement this scheme and compensate the Uttar Pradesh State Road Transport Corporation (UPSRTC)

▪ **Eligible Passengers: Only women who are 60 years of age or older.**

▪ The corporation issues **dedicated free travel cards embedded with personal information** to eligible passengers.

▪ Existing Concessions for Others: **men/women above 80 years can already travel for free, while senior citizens above 65 years receive a 30% discount on standard ticket pricing.**

The Sprite Tejas Express



▪ Indian Railways and IRCTC awarded **full commercial train-branding rights for the Lucknow–Delhi–Lucknow Tejas Express (Sprite Tejas Express)** to beverage brand Sprite for **six months.**

▪ The 'Sprite' Tejas Express is **India's first privately branded, fully air-conditioned corporate superfast train operated by the Indian Railway Catering and Tourism Corporation (IRCTC) featuring full external/internal brand advertising rights.**

▪ Operates Between: **Lucknow** Junction (LJN), Uttar Pradesh **to New Delhi** (NDLS).

'Rang De Basanti' campaign launched in Prayagraj to connect with Gen Z through poetry

▪ In Uttar Pradesh, a unique initiative to connect with **young people, particularly Gen Z and understand their thoughts through the medium of poetry** has been launched in **Prayagraj.**

▪ **The "Rang De Basanti" campaign started and will continue in various cities across the state until August 14.**

▪ The **next event will be held in Lucknow** in the form of a graffiti wall initiative, **where artists will create live public murals depicting the impact of mafia culture.**

PM pays tributes to the courage of patriotic Indians at Kakori on its centenary

▪ Prime Minister Narendra Modi, Home Minister Amit Shah and Defence Minister Rajnath Singh paid tribute to the freedom fighters who participated in the Quit India Movement and the Kakori Train Action.

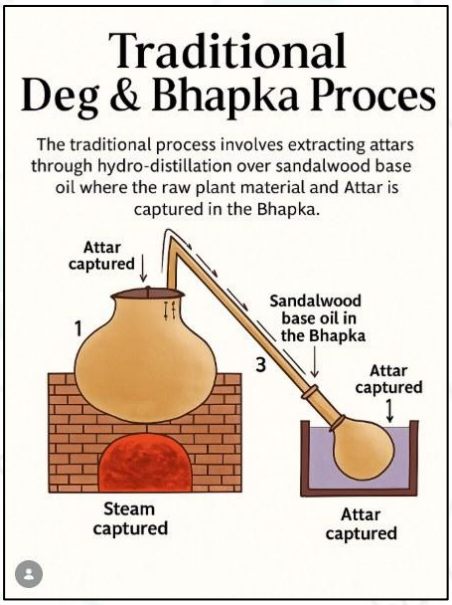
▪ Recently, the **Government of Uttar Pradesh has renamed 'Kakori Kand',** an important movement in the history of India's freedom struggle**, to 'Kakori Train Action'.**

▪ The **Kakori Rail Conspiracy** — often referred to as the Kakori Train Robbery — took place **on August 9, 1925,**

▪ when **members of** the Hindustan Republican Association **(HRA),** including Ram Prasad Bismil, Ashfaqulla Khan, Chandrashekhar Azad, Rajendra Lahiri, and Roshan Singh, **stopped the 8-Down train on the Saharanpur–Lucknow line near Kakori railway station** in Uttar Pradesh.

▪ **Ram Prasad Bismil, Ashfaqulla Khan, Rajendra Lahiri, and Roshan Singh were executed in 1927**, while others received long prison sentences. Chandrashekhar Azad managed to evade capture and continued the struggle until his death in 1931.

Kannauj perfume gets GI protection: The centuries-old craft behind the scent



▪ For centuries**, Kannauj in Uttar Pradesh has been associated with the art of making traditional fragrances.**

▪ Known for **its itra or attar**, Kannauj continues to be associated with traditional fragrance-making techniques in **which flowers, herbs, spices and aromatic woods are distilled to create perfumes.**

▪ The Uttar Pradesh **government's One District One Product (ODOP) portal identifies Itra (Scents) and Perfume Products as products**

THE TRADITIONAL DEG-BHAPKA PROCESS

▪ Kannauj's traditional perfumery is the **deg-bhapka method, a form of hydro-distillation that uses copper vessels to extract and blend fragrances.**

▪ The traditional process **involves distilling aromatic materials such as flowers, herbs, spices and aromatic woods.**

▪ The work requires an understanding of ingredients, heating, distillation and the delicate blending of fragrances.

▪ The choice of ingredients, **the manner in which they are heated and distilled, and the eventual blending all require knowledge built through generations of practice.**

Uttar Pradesh: Parichha Weir Gets ICID Heritage Recognition

▪ The International Commission on Irrigation and Drainage (ICID) designated the **140-year-old Parichha Weir in Jhansi as a World Heritage Irrigation Structure (WHIS)**

▪ The heritage recognition will be formally presented in France in October during the **26th ICID International Congress and 77th International Executive Council meeting.**

▪ The structure **is linked to the Betwa Canal system, which irrigates land in Uttar Pradesh and Madhya Pradesh.**

▪ The recognition also underscores the engineering legacy of traditional water-management systems.

▪ the project go back to **1855, when Captain Strachey proposed a canal system for Bundelkhand after conducting a detailed survey.**

▪ The canal system **was commissioned in 1886.**

▪ **In 2022, the Sukwa-Dukwan Weir in Jhansi was included in the ICID heritage list.**

UP CM Yogi Adityanath announces 'Youth Brigade Scheme' to boost employment opportunities on 80th Independence Day

▪ Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath announced the launch of the 'Youth Brigade Scheme' (**Mukhyamantri Yuva Udyami Vikas Abhiyan)** to provide robust support to the state's **younger generation in business and enterprise**.

▪ To provide significant support to our youth in the realms of employment and business.“

▪ **The proposed Integrated Youth Policy will cover those in the 16-35 age group.**

▪ **The Youth Welfare Department is acting as the nodal department**

▪ The policy is expected **to bring education and skill development, entrepreneurship, employment and innovation, digital empowerment, health, sports, leadership development**, and culture and heritage under one framework.

▪ The government is considering taking the scheme to **every university and college campus, giving students access to preparation for examinations such as UPSC, JEE and NEET without requiring them to travel to established coaching hubs.**

India's First Large-Scale Biopolymer Plant Set for October Launch

- India's first large-scale biopolymer plant is under construction in Lakhimpur Kheri district of Uttar Pradesh and is scheduled for commissioning in October 2026.
- **Biopolymers are polymers derived from renewable biological sources such as plant biomass, starch, or sugar-based feedstock.**
- The plant will **convert locally grown sugarcane into sugar and then into Polylactic Acid, commonly called PLA**, which is a biodegradable thermoplastic used in packaging and disposable products.

North Eastern Railway Runs Longest Awadh Mahashakti Freight Train

- North Eastern Railway's longest freight train: North Eastern Railway (NER) has operated its longest-ever freight train**, 'Awadh Mahashakti'.**
- The train**, operated by the Lucknow division**, is aimed at increasing the railway's freight carrying capacity.
- the zonal railway operated the long-haul freight train from Gonda to Sitapur in Uttar Pradesh.
- The train covered a distance of around 160 km in 3 hours and 50 minutes. It was operated at an average speed of 42 kmph.
- The Gonda-Burhwal-Sitapur section is part of HDN-4 (High-Density Network-4), an important railway route connecting Delhi with Guwahati.
- The section plays a crucial role in rail connectivity between the northern and eastern regions of the country.

Rudrastra – India's longest freight train

- Last year, Indian Railways operated its longest-ever freight train, 'Rudrastra', which was about 4.5 km long. The train was formed by combining six empty BOXN rakes, comprising 354 wagons and seven engines.
- The freight train was operated by the Pandit Deen Dayal Upadhyay (DDU) Division of East Central Railway (ECR). It covered around 200 km from Ganjkhwaja station to Garhwa Road station in five hours, at an average speed of 40 kmph.

Uttar Pradesh Cabinet Approves 180-Day Maternity Leave Twice

- The Uttar Pradesh Cabinet approved a proposal to allow **180-day maternity leave to state government women employees, twice during their entire service period (including in cases of adopted children)** without the condition of a two-year gap between the two leaves.
- **The Maternity Benefit Act, 1961**, is a central law that regulates **maternity leave and related benefits for women employees in India.**
- The Code on Social Security, 2020, consolidates labour welfare provisions and includes maternity-related entitlements under a broader social security framework.
- The amendment **removes the earlier rule** that required a **minimum two-year gap between the first and second maternity leaves.**

18th BRICS Academic Forum begins in Lucknow as part of India's BRICS Presidency

- **18th BRICS Academic Forum started in Lucknow** as part of India's BRICS Presidency.
- The **Observer Research Foundation (ORF),** in partnership with the **Research and Information System for Developing Countries (RIS) and the University of Lucknow, are the convener of the forum.**
- Held under the **theme, "Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability"**
- The Forum brings together academics, researchers, experts and policymakers from BRICS countries to discuss key global challenges and explore practical, policy-relevant pathways for strengthening cooperation.

In Uttar Pradesh, elderly parents can now disinherit children for neglect or abuse

- The Uttar Pradesh Cabinet has approved amendments to the **Uttar Pradesh Maintenance and Welfare of Parents and Senior Citizens Rules, 2014,** strengthening provisions to protect elderly parents from neglect and abuse.
- Under the amended rules, **parents can seek disinheritance of children who fail to provide proper care or subject them to abuse.**

- The procedure has been made **clearer and time-bound, with complaints to be heard within 30 days.**
- **A toll-free helpline** will also be launched to assist senior citizens in filing complaints.
- **Complaints can be submitted to the District Magistrate (DM),** who will submit a monthly report on such cases to the State Government.
- The amendments aim **to promote elderly care, accountability and respect for senior citizens within families.**

Madhya Pradesh

Indore Gets India's First Virtual Zoo

- India's First Virtual Zoo Opens in Indore at Kamla Nehru Zoological Garden in Madhya Pradesh. Chief Minister Dr Mohan Yadav inaugurated the facility on August 16.
- **The project includes a virtual jungle safari and a 14-D cinema theatre.**
- Both facilities were developed under the Public-Private Partnership (PPP) model at a cost of Rs 4.5 crore.
- The facilities combine wildlife education, technology and entertainment for visitors.

What is a Virtual Zoo?

- A Virtual Zoo uses digital technology to provide an immersive experience of wildlife and natural habitats.
- **At Indore, the virtual jungle safari allows visitors to experience forests and wildlife without entering an actual forest.**
- The facility is designed to make nature and wildlife learning more engaging for children and tourists.

Vaishya Tekri

- The Madhya Pradesh government has begun **restoring Buddhist monuments linked to the Mauryan emperor Ashoka**, starting with a fresh excavation at Vaishya Tekri.
- In his 2011 paper, Aśoka and Buddhist Nuns: Early Buddhism in Ujjain and Malwa, academic Peter Skilling wrote: "**The largest stupa, popularly called Vaisya Tekri, is about 350 feet at its base and 100 feet high.**
- **Nearby is a smaller stupa, called Kumbhar (or Kumhar) Tekri.**
- **Both are relatively undisturbed**, except for the unfortunate fact that a power line runs between them, and a giant pylon squats rudely on Kumbhar Tekri's shoulder."
- — Initial excavations by the Department of Archaeology of the **erstwhile Gwalior State in 1938–39 unveiled large bricks and punch-marked coins,** prompting archaeologists to date the structures to the Mauryan period.
- Instead of a **conventional solid brick structure, the heart of the monument was made from local blackish murum, rammed hard to form the massive core**.
- The exterior was then faced with brick masonry laid in mud mortar.

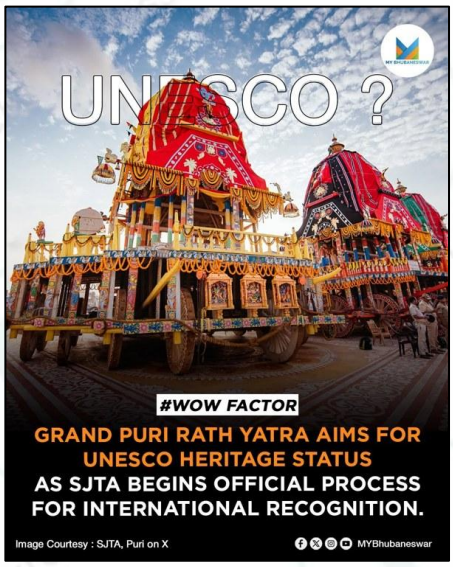
Jharkhand

Dimna Lake

- **Dimna Lake, Jamshedpur's iconic reservoir** and lifeline, was among 25 lakes across the country after which **spectator galleries were named during** the **80th Independence Day celebrations at Delhi's Red Fort.**
- It is an **artificial lake located in the city of Jamshedpur in Jharkhand.**
- It is located in the foothills of the **Dalma mountain range.**
- Constructed under the **Dimna Nala Water Supply Scheme by Tata Steel**, the reservoir was built with a storage **capacity of around 7,500 million gallons** to meet the future water needs of a rapidly expanding industrial city.
- **Work on the project began in 1940 and was completed in 1944,** with water from the **lake supplied to Jamshedpur for the first time on April 17, 1944.**
- The lake was created by **damming the Subarnarekha River.**

Odisha

The Proposal for UNESCO Tag for Puri Rath Yatra



- Odisha Chief Minister urged the Centre to nominate Puri's Shree **Jagannath Rath Yatra for inclusion in UNESCO's Representative List of the Intangible Cultural Heritage of Humanity.**
- The proposal, prepared by the Shree Jagannatha Temple Administration (SJTA), seeks formal recognition from UNESCO for the annual Rath Yatra (Chariot Festival) held at Puri, Odisha.
- **Textual descriptions of the Rath Yatra** appear in ancient Hindu scriptures such as the **Brahma Purana, Padma Purana, Skanda Purana, and Kapila Samhita.**
- Documented by European travelers since the 13th century, with detailed accounts recorded from the 17th century onward.
- **Annual Occurrence:** Celebrated annually during the bright fortnight **(Shukla Paksha) of the Hindu lunar month of Ashadha (June–July).**
- Three massive, distinct wooden chariots—**Nandighosha (Lord Jagannath), Taladhwaja (Lord Balabhadra), and Darpadalana (Goddess Subhadra)—**are newly constructed every year using specific timber types (Phassi, Dhausa) brought traditionally from the ex-princely state of Dasapalla along the Mahanadi River.
- The construction follows ancient architectural canons (Shilpa Shastras) executed by The three deities are brought out of the 12th-century Jagannath Temple in a grand procession (Pahandi Bije) and placed on their chariots aligned on the Bada Danda (Grand Avenue), where **millions of devotees pull them to the Gundicha Temple.**
- After a seven-day stay at the Gundicha Temple (regarded as the deities' birthplace/aunt's home), the deities embark on their return journey (Bahuda Rath Yatra**), during which they stop near the Mausi Maa Temple to receive an offering of Podo Pitha.**

Dhabaleswar Temple

- The president recently offered prayers at the **Dhabaleswar Temple near Berhampur, marking the final engagement of her three-day visit to Odisha.**
- The famous, ancient island temple of the same name is a Hindu temple dedicated to **Lord Shiva.**
- It is located **on an island on River Mahanadi near Cuttack, Odisha .**
- It is one of the oldest temples in Odisha. **It dates back to the early 10th and 11th century.**
- The temple structure was constructed during the rule of the **Somavamshi dynasty by King Yayati Keshari**.
- The **present-day temple was constructed by King Bir Kishore of Khurda around 1232 AD**
- It is built in the **Kalinga style of architecture.**
- The main temple structure is built **of sandstone.**
- It has a **square plan with a pyramidal roof.**
- The temple has a **beautiful entrance known as Jagamohan.**
- Intricate carvings of animals, birds, and mythological figures decorate it.
- Around the temple, there is a marble-covered raised platform.
- **The distinctive feature of the Dhabaleswar Temple is its two-tiered roof, which is made of terracotta tiles**

West Bengal

West Bengal Hosts First Kaushal Mahotsav in Balurghat

- West Bengal hosted its **first Kaushal Mahotsav at Balurghat Stadium in Dakshin Dinajpur district.**

- It was the 11th Kaushal Mahotsav and was organised by the Union Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship, the National Skill Development Corporation, and the Government of West Bengal.
- **Kaushal Mahotsav is a large-scale job fair linked to the Skill India Mission.**
- It **connects employers with job seekers for recruitment, screening, and placement across multiple sectors.**

West Bengal govt to form 'Arjun Bahini' disaster-response force with Agniveers

- The West Bengal government is set to form a **new disaster-response force** called the **"Arjun Bahini" by recruiting the Agniveers to deal with emergencies.**
- The force will become operational in September.
- So far, 200 personnel have been selected through the Sainik Board.
- The force will be equipped with modern machinery, and they will be able to **respond immediately to any kind of disaster.**
- A 20 per cent reservation would be provided for Agniveers in recruitment to the Fire and Emergency Services, Forest Department, Police and Disaster Management Department.

West Bengal government to introduce 'Janatar Darbar' for quicker grievance redressal

- West Bengal government is all set to introduce **'Janatar Darbar' (Public Hearing) at government offices to ensure quicker redressal of public grievances.**
- directed field-level officials from the district to the block level to meet members of the public **every Tuesday and Thursday, from 10:30 AM to 1 PM. No prior appointment will be required.**
- Officials will also have to **record complaints and the action taken on them on the 'Apnar Sarkar Apnar Pashe' portal.**

Arunachal Pradesh

Glaw Lake becomes Arunachal Pradesh's First Ramsar Site; India's Ramsar Sites tally reaches 101

- Union Minister for Environment, Forest and Climate Change, announced the designation of **Glaw Lake (also known as Glow Lake) in Arunachal Pradesh as India's 101st Ramsar Site.**
- This landmark recognition marks **Arunachal Pradesh's very first Ramsar Site.**
- Glaw Lake is a **high-altitude, pristine, natural freshwater lake located in the Eastern Himalayas.**
- Spread across an estimated area of 8 square kilometers at an elevation of approximately 1,168 meters above sea level, it serves as a **major source for the perennial Kamlang River.**
- **District: Lohit District, Arunachal Pradesh** (near the town of Wakro).
- **Protected Area:** Lies deep inside the **Kamlang Tiger Reserve and Wildlife Sanctuary** (bounded by the Lang River to the north and **Namdapha National Park** to the south).
- Local Indigenous Habitat: Surrounded by traditional territories inhabited by the Miju Mishmi, Digaro Mishmi, and Idu Mishmi tribal communities.



Origin:

- Formed through **natural tectonic activity** and land-block warping typical of the Eastern Himalayan structural fold belt, creating a **natural high-altitude depression that impounds alpine run-off.**
- The lake basin is one of the rare Himalayan eco-zones supporting all four major big cat species—**Bengal Tiger, Indian Leopard, Clouded Leopard, and Snow Leopard.**

NOTE - On the occasion of World Environment Day (5th June), Prime Minister Narendra Modi announced the addition of **India's 100th Ramsar site – Jai Prakash Narayan Bird Sanctuary (Surha Tal) in Ballia, Uttar Pradesh.**

Arunachal Pradesh launches e-Bhavishya pension system

- The Arunachal Pradesh Government has rolled out the e-Bhavishya Pension Sanction and Tracking System, a paperless platform to streamline pension processing and ensure timely retirement benefits for government employees.
- the initiative included a three-day training programme conducted by the National Informatics Centre (NIC) for officials from 25 pilot departments.
- Developed for the Department of Audit & Pension, the platform digitises the entire pension process, reducing paperwork, minimising delays and errors, and enabling real-time monitoring of pension cases.

Meghalaya

Meghalaya Launches Read & Rise Programme

- The Meghalaya government launched the **CM-IMPACT Read & Rise Meghalaya programme** to **improve foundational reading skills and address learning gaps among schoolchildren**.
- The goal is that every child should be able to read and write by the age of seven.

Rajasthan

Recently, the Supreme Court banned any construction or development within 100 m of the Jojari River in Rajasthan.

- **Jojari River is a seasonal river** which originates in **Pandalu village of Nagaur, Rajasthan.**
- Course: It passes **through Jodhpur and merges with the Luni River near Balotra city.**
- It is the **only right-bank tributary of the Luni River**.
- It is the only branch of the Luni River **which does not come from the Aravalli Mountains.**
- It is facing severe contamination problems from industrial waste and untreated sewage.
- It is majorly impacted by the chemical-laden water from Jodhpur's textile and steel industries flowing into the river

Gujarat

Gujarat to Get Asia's First Desert-Themed Night Safari

- **The Central Zoo Authority (CZA)** approved the proposal for the **Desert Zoological Park and Night Safari at Deesa in Gujarat's Banaskantha district** to develop **Asia's first desert-themed drive-through night safari.**
- The proposed Desert Zoological Park and Night Safari is being developed over about 103 hectares of government land at Deesa.

Gramin Gyan Setu App Launched in Gujarat

- Union Home Minister Amit Shah launched the '**Gramin Gyan Setu' app, an initiative aimed at interconnecting libraries across the Gandhinagar Lok Sabha constituency of Gujarat** and promoting a **culture of reading among children and young people.**
- the initiative seeks to **establish a library in every village, preferably at a central location near schools**, and provide rural readers access to a much larger pool of books through a **technology-enabled hub-and-spoke model.**

Maharashtra

The Dahi Handi Festival

- The Maharashtra government announced that it will make formal efforts to **secure a UNESCO Intangible Cultural Heritage tag for the traditional Dahi Handi festival.**
- Dahi Handi (also known as Gopalakala or Utlotsavam) is a **traditional socio-cultural festival and adventure sport celebrated as part of Krishna Janmashtami** (marking the birth of Lord Krishna).

- Teams of participants, known as Govindas, form multi-tier **human pyramids to reach and break an earthen pot (handi) suspended high in the air, filled with curd (dahi), milk, butter, and fruits.**
- Mythological Roots: Commemorates the childhood (Bal Leela) of Lord Krishna in Gokul and Vrindavan.

Region of Major Celebration:

- Primary Hub: Celebrated with immense scale across Maharashtra (**especially in Mumbai, Thane, Pune, and surrounding Konkan regions).**
- Other Names/Regions: Celebrated as Gopalakala in western India and as Utlotsavam in Andhra Pradesh and Telangana.

Maharashtra government launches state-wide 'Reel for Soil and Water Conservation' competition

- The Maharashtra government has organised a state-level 'Reel for Soil and Water Conservation' competition across all 36 districts to spread awareness about soil and water conservation among young people and the wider public.
- **Youth aged 15 to 30 can participate by uploading 30 to 60-second Instagram reels between August 15 and 19.**
- Participants can create reels on topics including soil conservation, water saving, rainwater harvesting, farm ponds, check dams, watershed development, tree plantation and successful conservation initiatives in villages.
- **Storytelling, acting, music, dance, animation, short films, before-and-after visuals and drone footage can be used,** but the main message must focus on soil and water conservation.
- **The top three district-level winners will receive Rs 25,000, Rs 15,000 and Rs 10,000 respectively, along with recognition as 'Yuva Mrud-Jaldut'.**

Maharashtra Bans Analogue Paneer for One Year

- Maharashtra, has imposed an immediate, state-wide ban on the manufacture, storage, distribution, transportation, and sale of analogue or artificial (non-dairy) paneer for a period of one year.
- The directive, issued under the leadership of FDA Commissioner Tukaram Mundhe, signals a major crackdown on adulterated dairy products in restaurants, hotels, and catering services.
- Serving analogue or synthetic paneer in place of genuine dairy paneer has been designated as an unfair trade practice under Section 24 of the FSS Act, 2006.

Maharashtra Makes Snakebite a Notifiable Disease

- Maharashtra declared **snakebite a notifiable disease** under the state public health framework.
- The order **makes reporting mandatory for government hospitals, private hospitals,** medical colleges, and healthcare practitioners for every suspected, probable, or confirmed case and death.

Notifiable Disease

- A notifiable disease is a disease that **health authorities require medical institutions to report to the government.**
- In India, notifiable disease lists are used for surveillance, outbreak tracking, and public health planning under state and national health systems.

Goa

8th BRICS Oceanic-Polar Science and Tech Meet Begins in Goa

- As part of India's BRICS Presidency 2026, the **8th Meeting of the BRICS Working Group on Ocean and Polar Science and Technology (OPST) is being held in Goa** from August 12 to 14.
- The meeting is being **hosted by the National Centre for Polar and Ocean Research (NCPOR)** under the Ministry of Earth Sciences (MoES).

Rajnath Singh inaugurates re-developed Hutatma Smruti Smarak in Goa

- Raksha Mantri Shri Rajnath Singh, inaugurated the newly re-developed **Hutatma Smruti Smarak at Patradevi, a historic site associated with the state's liberation struggle from Portuguese rule.**
- On August 15, 1955, thousands of volunteers from across **India participated in a peaceful satyagraha in Goa**

ICAR-CCARI Launches Carbon Pathshala for Goa Farmers

- **The ICAR–Central Coastal Agricultural Research Institute (ICAR-CCARI), Goa**, in collaboration **with Core CarbonX Solutions Pvt. Ltd., Hyderabad.**
- Organised a **one-day workshop on 'Carbon Pathshala**: Voluntary Carbon Market (VCM) for Farmers' at ICAR-KVK, Old Goa, on August 21.
- the programme aimed **to familiarise farmers with carbon markets, carbon sequestration and the potential of biochar-based carbon credits.**

Telangana

The postal department launched a postal cover and a postal stamp on the historical Medak fort



- It is a historic hill fort located in Medak town, Telangana.
- The **fort was built during the 12th century** under the reign of the **Kakatiya ruler, Pratapa Rudra**, and it was initially called '**MethukuDurgam' in Telugu.**
- It served as a command post for the Kakatiyas and later for the Qutub Shahis.
- It has three main entrances, namely the "**Prathama Dwaram**", the "**SimhaDwaram"** which features two snarling lions at the top of these entrances while the "**GajaDwaram**", or the Elephant's Entrance features a sculpture where two elephants are majestically interlocked on both sides of this entrance.
- The main entrance features the double-headed **"Gandabherundam", the emblem of Vijayanagara Empire** built by the great ruler Srikrishna Devaraya.
- The fort also has a 17th-century mosque on its premises built by the Qutub Shahis, as well as granaries

IIT Hyderabad Launches ANUGYAN Nuclear Training Programme

- The **Indian Institute of Technology Hyderabad (IITH) launched ANUGYAN** – Nuclear Technology Orientation Programme (NTOP) in **collaboration with the Crimson Energy Experts Private Limited (CEEPL).**
- Anugyan is India's first industry – academia programme introduced **to provide engineers and industry professionals for the civil nuclear energy sector growing at a rapid pace.**
- The programme aims to help candidates to gain academic learning along with real-world industrial exposure.

Thoti Tribe Faces Rapid Population Decline in Telangana

- It is a small tribal community concentrated in northern Telangana.
- **They are classified as a Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Group (PVTG).**
- They have historically served as **village messengers, ballad singers, and folk artists,** maintaining a rich heritage of storytelling and indigenous cultural practices.
- Historically, **they were oral storytellers, narrating episodes from the Mahabharata using traditional instruments such as the burra, maddela, and harmonium.**
- They speak **Gonti as their mother tongue.**
- The social structure of this community is hierarchically organized.
- The village head and elders of the community exercise authority over most social, political, and legal matters related to the community and its members.
- They **worship and believe in their community God called "Persapen"** and other village deities, and celebrate a festival known as "Nagappa Jathara" (Chariot festival).
- **During ceremonial occasions, Thotis play the kingri, a three-stringed fiddle, and blow trumpets.**
- Many Thoti women are skilled tattoo artists, and they are responsible for the complex tattoos covering the arms, shoulders, and chests of many Gond women.
- The Thotis have been known to practice endogamy.

Andhra Pradesh

PM Modi inaugurates Andhra Pradesh's new international airport

- Prime Minister Narendra Modi inaugurated the **Visakhapatnam Alluri Sitarama Raju International Airport at Bhogapuram** and announced that the Centre will extend all its support to the upcoming Visakhapatnam Economic Region.
- The Bhogapuram airport had been named after freedom fighter Alluri Sitarama Raju, who sacrificed his life for the rights of tribal communities..
- A recent performance of the **traditional Dhimsa dance** by more than 13,000 tribal women and girl students at the Alluri Sitarama Raju International Airport in Bhogapuram was **recognised by Guinness World Records as the "largest Dhimsa dance".**
- It is a popular tribal dance performed by tribes, including **Bagata, Valmiki, Poraja, Khond, Gadaba, Kondadora, Mukadora, and Kotia in Andhra Pradesh .**
- It is performed during festivals, weddings, and at the time of the **"hunting festival" in April when men and women dance for hours together.**
- There are 12 varieties of Dhimsa and the origin can be traced to the Koraput area, the home of the Ghond Tribe.

Performance:

- Typically performed by a group of 15 to 20 women dressed in traditional, colorful ethnic sarees and ornaments, the dancers move in synchronous circles to the rhythm of native instruments played by male community members.
- The beauty of this dance centres on the movements of the dancers without much emphasis on expression or literary texts.
- Unique tribal musical instruments accompanying this dance form include the Mori (a wind instrument), Thudum (drum), and Dappu.
- Themes: Various themes of the Dhimsa, are woven around their mythologies, folktales, ethos, mores, economic activities, and kinship and marital life, etc

RIL Proposes India's First Integrated Underground Coal Gasification Complex in Andhra Pradesh

- **Reliance Industries Limited** has proposed an investment of about ₹2.73 lakh crore over 30 years for **India's first integrated Underground Coal Gasification (UCG) complex in Eluru district, Andhra Pradesh.**
- Underground Coal Gasification is an in-situ process that **converts coal into synthesis gas, or syngas, without conventional mining.**
- The method **uses controlled injection of oxidants into deep coal seams to produce a combustible gas mixture** that can be used as an industrial feedstock.

Karnataka

Karnataka Approves SAMASTA for Health Record Digitisation

- Karnataka approved the **phased rollout of SAMASTA**, an integrated community digital health platform **for digitising health records and replacing manual paper-based record-keeping.**
- The platform is linked with the **Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission and is designed for use at Ayushman Arogya Kendras and Primary Health Centres.**
- It is intended for use by ASHA workers, Auxiliary Nurse Midwives, and health inspectors during field-level health work.
- The platform supports both online and offline data entry, which allows local storage of records in areas with poor internet connectivity.

Karnataka Launches Sandhya Kiran Cashless Healthcare Cover

- The Karnataka Cabinet approved the **'Sandhya Kiran' cashless healthcare scheme for state pensioners below 70 years, family pensioners and their eligible dependents.**

- The scheme aims to provide **financial and health security to retired employees** and their families and will initially cover State Government pensioners below 70 years and their eligible dependents.
- This scheme is a vital social security measure ensuring quality, affordable and cashless healthcare services for State Government pensioners and their families,
- the scheme will **provide eligible families cashless treatment of up to Rs 5 lakh a year on a floater basis for secondary, tertiary and emergency care** at empanelled hospitals.
- **The Suvarna Arogya Suraksha Trust will implement the scheme.**

Bengaluru Police Launch Operation Mukta Against Illegal Immigrants

- The Bengaluru City Police launched Operation Mukta on 8 August 2026 to identify and track suspected illegal immigrants across the city.
- The drive focused on suspected Bangladeshi nationals .
- The operation, conducted across six police station limits, marked one of the biggest recent verification drives in the city amid heightened scrutiny of undocumented foreign nationals.

Bengaluru to host India International Coffee Festival in February 2027

- The third edition of the India International Coffee Festival (IICF) 2027 will be held in Bengaluru from February 26–28, 2027.
- Organised by the **Coffee Board of India** in association with the Specialty Coffee Association of India (SCAI).

National Conclave on Tribal Languages & Museums begins in Mysuru, Karnataka

- Recently, the Ministry of Tribal Affairs began the three-day National Conclave on Tribal Languages & Museums in Mysuru, Karnataka in which a full-fledged **Adi Vaani Platform was launched.**
- Adi Vaani Platform is **India's first AI-powered translator for tribal languages.**
- It is designed to **bridge communication gaps between tribal and non-tribal communities**, while safeguarding endangered tribal languages using advanced Artificial Intelligence (AI).
- It is developed by a national consortium of premier institutions led by **IIT Delhi with BITS Pilani, IIIT Hyderabad, and IIIT Nava Raipur in collaboration with Tribal Research Institutes (TRIs) in Jharkhand, Odisha, Madhya Pradesh, Chhattisgarh, and Meghalaya.**

Features

- It converts images and documents to editable text in seconds.
- It transcribes live speech or audio files into text and translates into indigenous languages instantly.
- Speak or upload speech in English or Hindi and listen to real-time **voice translation in Santali, Mundari, or Bhili.**

Kerala

Cholanaikkan Tribe

- Recently, members of the Cholanaikkan tribe came out from the forest to receive essential government documents at an event organised by the district administration in Kerala.
- **Cholanaikkans are an ethnic tribal community distributed only in the Nilambur valley of Nilgiri Biosphere Reserve, Western Ghats of Kerala state**.
- The Cholanaikkans (coolanaaykkan) are called the **Cavemen of Kerala.**
- These people are regarded as **one of Asia's last surviving cave-dwelling indigenous communities.**
- They call themselves as Malanaikan or Sholanaikan. Shola or chola means deep thicket in the forest and naikan means king.
- **They live deep in dense forest, mostly in rock caves called Kallulai** (Kallu – rock, aalai – cave), near the banks of streams.
- They are divided into smaller groups called **Jenmam.**
- They speak **the Cholanaikkan language, which is categorised into the Dravidian family by linguistic experts,**

- Occupation: They are largely depending on collecting forest produce for their livelihood, rarely coming out of the forest.
- They are **classified as a Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Group (PVTG).**

Uthradam celebrated across Keralam

- Kerala is celebrating **Uthradam**, the penultimate day of the ten-day Onam festival, as the state prepares to welcome Thiru Onam.
- Known **widely as First Onam,** Uthradam marks the auspicious day when the **spirit of the righteous Asura King Mahabali is believed to arrive in Kerala.**
- The traditional Uthrada Paachil has brought markets and shopping centres across the state to life, with people making their final purchases for the celebrations.
- **Homes are being decorated with colourful Ona Pookkalams,** while preparations are underway for the traditional Ona Sadya to be served.

Festival of Onam being celebrated with traditional fervour

- **Onam is a 10-day-long harvest festival** celebrated by the **Malayali community** in Kerala and worldwide.
- Onam 2026 is celebrated on August 26, 2026 with **Thiruvonam** marking the most important day of the festival.
- **Onam** is observed in the **Chingam month on the Malayalam solar calendar (between August and September** in the Gregorian calendar).
- The festival commemorates the appearance of the **Vamana avatar of Vishnu** and subsequently the **homecoming of King Mahabali**.

Tamil Nadu

Aadi Perukku festival celebrated with religious fervour across Tamil Nadu

- In Tamil Nadu, on the **18th day in the auspicious month of Aadi.**
- It is called Aadi Perukku and is devoted to the **female deity Amman.**
- The festival involves **prayers on river banks for an increase in water**, the basis for agriculture.
- This is also a day when unmarried women pray to find a suitable life partner, married women pray for marital bliss and the longevity of their husbands, and they also offer a symbolic baby shower to the deity.
- The festival is celebrated **with religious fervour on the banks of the River Cauvery, as well as near water bodies across the state.**

V.O.C. Port becomes first in India to be accredited with ISO 50001:2018 certification for energy management

- The V.O. Chidambaranar Port Authority in Thoothukudi has become the first port in the country to be accredited with the ISO 50001:2018 certification for energy management system.
- **This certification marks a significant milestone in the port's commitment to energy efficiency and sustainable port operations.**
- the port became the **first Indian major port to obtain Quality Management System (QMS) certification under ISO 9001 in 1996** and the second to obtain **Environmental Management System (EMS) certification under ISO 14001 in 2005.**

Tamil Nadu Extends Maternity Leave for Third Child

- The Tamil Nadu government on Tuesday announced extending the **maternity leave for its women employees for the birth of their third child from 12 weeks to 365 days**, the same duration that they get for the first two children.
- Currently, married women government employees with fewer than **two surviving children are granted 365 days of maternity leave,** while those with two or more surviving children receive up to 12 weeks of maternity leave.

▪ Under the standard eligibility framework, **the 365-day benefit applies to regular female employees with fewer than two surviving children**

Tamirabharani River

▪ Recently, the **Madurai Bench of the Madras High Court** has declared **Tamil Nadu's Tamirabharani (Porunai) river a deity and granted it legal personhood** to curb pollution.
▪ It is a perennial river of southern India flowing entirely within Tamil Nadu.
▪ It originates from the Agastyarkoodam peak of Pothigai hills of the Western Ghats.
▪ It drains into the Gulf of Mannar.
▪ **It is fed by both southwest and northeast monsoons.**
▪ Tributaries: Major tributaries include **Servalar, Manimuthar, Gadananathi, Pachaiyar, Chittar, Ramanathi and Koraiyar, all originating from forested Western Ghats.**
▪ Waterfalls and Reservoirs: The river forms **Paanatheertham waterfalls and Kalyanatheertham and Agasthiar falls.**
▪ Major Dams: Karaiyar Dam, Manimuthar Dam, Gadananathi Dam and Ramanathi Dam.

The Zonal Council

▪ **Union Home Minister Amit Shah chaired the 31st Southern Zonal Council (SZC)** meeting on August 20, 2026, in Mahabalipuram, Tamil Nadu.
▪ **Zonal Councils are high-level statutory deliberative bodies** created to promote **interstate cooperation, resolve disputes**, and ensure coordinated socioeconomic planning among States and Union Territories grouped into distinct geographic zones.
▪ **Established In: 1956.**
▪ **Statutory Genesis**: Set up under Part III of the **States Reorganisation Act, 1956.**
▪ Constitutional Status: Zonal Councils are statutory bodies, **not constitutional bodies.**
▪ Composition of Zones: The 1956 Act divided the country into **five zonal councils—Northern, Central, Eastern, Western, and Southern.**
▪ **Note: The North-Eastern Council was created separately under the North-Eastern Council Act, 1971.**

Tamil Nadu Launches Annapoorani Super Six LPG Scheme

▪ Tamil Nadu announced the **Annapoorani Super Six Scheme in the State Assembly for domestic LPG cylinder reimbursement to eligible families**.
▪ The scheme provides reimbursement for domestic LPG cylinders after purchase, and the subsidy is credited directly to the bank accounts of beneficiaries.
▪ The government fixed eligibility for families with annual income below ₹2.5 lakh, middle farmers, marginal farmers, and families of persons with disabilities.

Andaman & Nicobar

Moken sea nomads living on the Andaman Sea can see underwater like dolphins

▪ Scientists recently confirmed that **Moken sea nomad children living on the Andaman Sea** can see underwater with **twice the clarity of other children, constricting their pupils to dolphin-like precision** through years of ocean training.
▪ Often called **sea nomads or sea gypsies**, the Moken are seafaring people who have been living off the **coast of Thailand and Myanmar on the Andaman Sea**.
▪ Their name, in their own language, means "sea drowned."
▪ The Moken have lived across the Andaman Sea for centuries, moving between the **roughly 800 islands that stretch along the coastlines of Myanmar and Thailand.**
▪ They are one of the last sea nomad peoples in the world.
▪ Traditionally, **they travel in wooden vessels called kabang**, moving with the seasons and tides.

- Fishing, diving, and gathering shellfish form the backbone of their subsistence lifestyle, and from a very young age, Moken children are immersed in the marine environment.
- Possessing a rich knowledge of the reefs, the Moken have exceptional underwater skills such as free diving and spear hunting.
- **They have their own language, which is Austronesian, a language used in Southeast Asia and Oceania.**
- Most Moken are stateless as a result of their nomadic lifestyle. They have no citizenship in Thailand or Myanmar.
- They came into the international spotlight following the 2004 Indian Ocean tsunami because they managed to sense warning signs from nature in the form of the water receding back into the ocean and moving away from dangerous areas.

Defence

Military Exercises

Exercise ROTOR CLAP III

- The Indian Air Force (IAF) recently concluded the week-long **Exercise ROTOR CLAP III at the Pokhran Field Firing Range in Rajasthan's Jaisalmer district.**
- It is a specialised helicopter exercise themed "Counter-Unmanned Aerial Systems (Counter-UAS)" conducted by the Indian Air Force (IAF).
- Location: Pokhran Field Firing Range in Rajasthan's Jaisalmer district
- It is the third edition of a series the IAF has built around rotary-wing counter-drone work.

'Mission accomplished': IAF concludes multi-nation Pitch Black exercise in Australia

- **The Indian Air Force (IAF)** recently said its contingent at the **multi-nation exercise 'Pitch Black' in Australia** had "accomplished the mission" and "mastered" the skies, while several partnerships were "strengthened".
- **It is a biennial and multinational exercise hosted by the Royal Australian Air Force (RAAF).**
- It is the RAAF's flagship international flying exercise.
- **The name 'Pitch Black' was derived from the emphasis on nighttime flying over large unpopulated areas.**

India and Malaysia Commence Exercise Udara Shakti 2026

- **The Indian Air Force (IAF)** and the **Royal Malaysian Air Force (RMAF)** commenced the **bilateral air exercise Udara Shakti 2026** on 10 August 2026.
- Udara Shakti is a bilateral air exercise between India and Malaysia.
- **The five-day exercise** is scheduled to continue until 14 August 2026 at **Subang Air Base in Malaysia.**

Australia Announces Dates for Exercise Talisman Sabre 2027

- Exercise Talisman Sabre 2027 is scheduled from 9 August 2027 to 22 August 2027.
- The multinational military exercise is being planned as the largest and most ambitious edition of the series, **with expanded participation from partner nations across the Indo-Pacific**.
- **Exercise Talisman Sabre is a major military exercise led by Australia and the United States.**
- It is designed to improve joint operations, interoperability, and combined planning among participating armed forces.
- Significantly, **India will participate in the Exercise Talisman Sabre 2027.**

Indian, American Navies to hold bilateral exercise in Kochi from August 10

- The Indian Navy–U.S. Navy Explosive Ordnance Disposal (EOD) Exercise 2026 will be held at the Southern Naval Command here from August 10 to 14.
- The bilateral exercise aims to enhance interoperability and strengthen professional cooperation between the specialist diving and EOD teams of the two navies, according to a communication.
- The Indian Navy and the U.S. Navy have been conducting joint salvage and EOD exercises since 2005.

India-Thailand Maitree Exercise Begins on August 18

- The 15th edition of the India-Thailand bilateral military exercise, MAITREE-XV, is scheduled from 18 August to 31 August 2026 at **Vibhavadi Rangsit Camp in Surat Thani, Thailand.**
- **Exercise Maitree is a bilateral army exercise between India and Thailand that began in 2006.**
- The **Indian Army is represented by the 9 Gorkha Rifles**, while the Royal Thai Army is represented by the 3rd Battalion, 25th Infantry Brigade, 5th Division.

Eagles of Civilisation 2026 Military Exercise

- The **"Eagles of Civilisation 2026**" joint air exercise began between the Egyptian Air Force and the People's Liberation Army Air Force in August 2026 in Egypt
- The exercise was the **second bilateral air drill between Egypt and China.**
- The **J-16 and the Dassault Rafale** are taking part in this year's Eagles of Civilization joint air exercise

Other Defence News

India Launches Fifth Diving Support Craft DSC A24



- DSC A24 (Yard 329)—the fifth and final ship of the Diving Support Craft (DSC) project—was launched at the **Titagarh shipyard in Kolkata (West Bengal).**
- DSC A24 (Yard 329) is a specialized catamaran-hulled naval vessel built to perform underwater diving support, salvage operations, and coastal deployments.
- **Manufacturer / Shipbuilder: M/s Titagarh Rail Systems Limited (TRSL) / Titagarh Naval Systems Limited, Kolkata.**
- Aim: To bolster the operational capacity of the Indian Navy's Command Clearance Diving Teams (CCDTs) by providing stable, indigenous platforms for complex underwater inspections, maintenance, salvage assistance, and harbour/near-shore deployments.
- Features an approximate displacement ranging between 300 and 400 tonnes, optimized for shallow-water and coastal operations.

Next Generation Offshore Patrol Vessel Shruti Launched



- Recently the **Next Generation Offshore Patrol Vessel** (NGOPV) **Shruti** was launched at **M/s GRSE, Kolkata**.
- It is the Next Generation Offshore Patrol Vessel (NGOPV).
- Construction by: The construction of NGOPVs is concurrently being undertaken **at two shipyards — Goa Shipyard Limited (GSL) and Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers Ltd (GRSE), Kolkata.**
- These ships derive their name from India's rich heritage, with this ship being **named as 'Shruti', referring to four Vedas**.
- The crest design of the ship depicts the constellation of Ursa Major and a red & white coloured light house.
- It is indigenously designed and will augment the existing OPVs/ NOPVs for multi domain operations, such **as maritime surveillance, search and rescue, protection of offshore assets, HADR and anti-piracy missions.**
- They are with a displacement of **3,000 tonnes and achieve speeds of up to 23 knots and have an endurance of 8,500 nautical miles at a cruising speed of 14 knots,**

Agni-4 medium-range ballistic missile test-fired from Odisha

- Recently, Agni-4' was successfully test-fired from the Integrated Test Range, Chandipur in Odisha.
- It is **an indigenously developed Medium-Range Ballistic Missile (MRBM).**
- It is developed by the **Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO).**
- It is operated by the Strategic Forces Command (SFC) as part of India's strategic missile arsenal
- It is capable of striking targets at a **range of up to 4,000 kilometres.**
- It is a **two-stage, surface-to-surface ballistic missile powered by a solid-fuel rocket motor**.
- Launch Platform: Road-mobile launcher
- It has a **payload capacity up to 1,000 kg**
- Technology: It has the most accurate **Ring Laser Gyro based Inertial Navigation System (RINS)** supported by a highly reliable redundant **Micro Navigation System (MINGS),** ensuring the vehicle reaches the target within two digit accuracy.

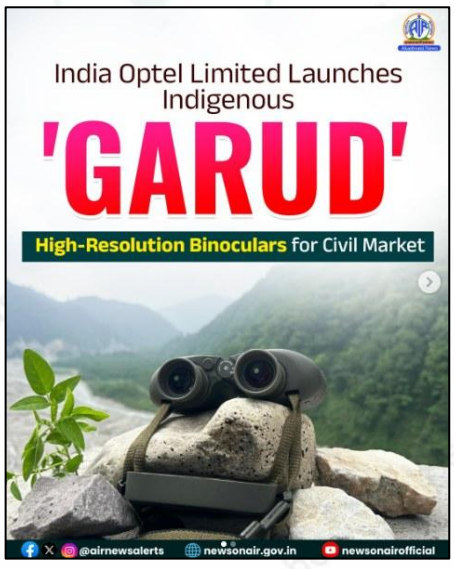
Kh-101 Missile

- A suspected Russian Kh-101 missile landed in eastern Poland recently, creating security tensions on NATO's eastern flank.
- **The Kh-101 (NATO: AS-23A Kodiak) is a Russian-made advanced stealthy long-range subsonic cruise missile that is launched from a strategic bomber**.
- The missile was developed in the late 1990s by Russia's Tactical Missile Armament Corporation (KTRV).
- It is designed to destroy ground targets such as buildings, bunkers, and military installations.
- **The Kh-101 is primarily carried by Russia's strategic bombers.**
- It has a length of approximately 7.5 m and a wingspan of about 4.4 m.
- The missile is powered by a turbofan engine and is capable of flying at a maximum speed of **Mach 0.76.**
- **It has a range of 2,500 km to 3,000 km.**
- It can carry a variety of conventional warheads, including high explosive, penetrator, and cluster munitions.

HAL airport becomes first in India to operationalise RNP CAT H helicopter approach

- **The Hindustan Aeronautics Limited (HAL) airport in Bengaluru** has become the first airport in India to operationalise the **Required Navigation Performance – Category H** (RNP CAT H) helicopter approach procedure.
- RNP CAT H helicopter approach procedure is a satellite-guided precision navigation system designed exclusively for helicopters.
- **Developed by the Airports Authority of India (AAI).**

India Optel Limited, launched the indigenous 'GARUD'



- **India Optel Limited (IOL), a Mini Ratna** Category-I Defence Public Sector Undertaking (DPSU), officially **launched the indigenous 'GARUD' High Resolution Binoculars for the civil market** at DPSU Bhawan, New Delhi.
- GARUD is an **indigenous, defense-grade high-resolution binocular platform adapted for civilian use.**
- **Derived from optical equipment used by the Indian Armed Forces and Central Armed Police Forces (CAPFs**), it offers high-precision optics in a compact, portable design.
- **Manufacturer: Ordnance Factory, Dehradun (a unit of India Optel Limited** – IOL under the Department of Defence Production, Ministry of Defence).
- **Aim: To commercialize indigenous defense optical capabilities under the Aatmanirbhar Bharat initiative,** making reliable, high-precision optical gear accessible to outdoor enthusiasts, researchers, and civilian professionals.

4th edition of Tri-Services Future Warfare Course to commence in New Delhi

- The fourth edition of the Tri-Services Future Warfare Course will commence in New Delhi.
- **The four-week course** is being conducted under the aegis of the **Headquarters Integrated Defence Staff and coordinated by the Centre for Joint Warfare Studies.**
- The course brings together officers from the three Services, along with representatives from government organisations, academia, industry and strategic think-tanks.
- The curriculum of the course covers subjects, including **geopolitical developments, artificial intelligence, quantum technologies, cyber and cognitive warfare, information warfare, technology-enabled warfare**

Operation Trishul Brings Back 274 Fugitives

- Operation Trishul is an Indian fugitive-tracking and extradition initiative linked to the return of 274 fugitives from 36 countries since 2019.
- The fugitives were wanted in cases involving **terrorism, organised crime, narco-terrorism, sexual offences, financial fraud, murder, and human trafficking.**
- Operation Trishul uses satellite imagery, surveillance inputs, and digital footprints to locate fugitives who change names or identities abroad.
- With **INTERPOL's cooperation, the location of the criminals in hiding was established based on satellite, surveillance, and digital footprint.**
- The operation involves coordination among the **Intelligence Bureau, Central Bureau of Investigation, Research and Analysis Wing, state police forces,**

On August 8, 1965 - Op Gibraltar: How India crushed 1965 infiltration in J-K

- Operation Gibraltar was a covert military operation launched by Pakistan in August 1965 to infiltrate Jammu & Kashmir and incite a popular uprising against India.
- Pakistan aimed to exploit local discontent and carry out sabotage behind Indian lines.
- The operation was named after the Muslim conquest of Spain in 711 AD, led by a small force that crossed the Strait of Gibraltar.
- On 8 August 1965, Indian troops captured Captain Ghulam Hussain and Captain Mohammed Sajjad near Narian, J&K. Their interrogation revealed details of Operation Gibraltar.
- Pakistani infiltrators received limited local support, notably around Mandi near Poonch, but failed to trigger a wider uprising.
- Indian forces detected and neutralised or captured many infiltrators, forcing others to retreat.
- Pakistan subsequently launched Operation Grand Slam in the Akhnoor sector, escalating the conflict.
- These developments led to the full-scale Indo-Pak War of 1965, with major fighting on both the western and eastern fronts.
- The war ended with a ceasefire, followed by the Tashkent Agreement (January 1966), which restored the pre-war territorial status quo.

Defence Minister flags off All India Girls High Altitude Long Trek 'Aparajita – Parang La 2026' in New Delhi

- Raksha Mantri Shri Rajnath Singh flagged-off the All India Girls High Altitude Long Trek **'Aparajita - Parang La 2026', a flagship adventure activity of the National Cadet Corps (NCC).**
- The trek will traverse the Parang La Pass (5,578 metres, 18,300 feet), **connecting the Spiti Valley of Himachal Pradesh with the Changthang region of Ladakh**

Indian Army Chief Dhiraj Seth Gets Nepal's Honorary General Rank

- Indian Army Chief General Dhiraj Seth was conferred the **Honorary Rank of General of the Nepali Army** by Nepal President Ram Chandra Paudel on **17 August 2026** at Sheetal Niwas, Kathmandu.

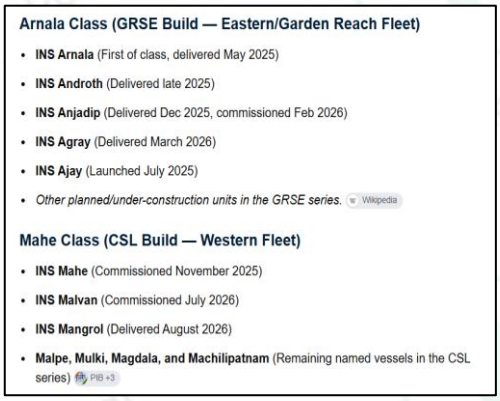
- During his visit, General Seth also **laid a wreath at the Army Pavilion in Tundikhel**.
- He is on a **three-day official visit to Nepal from August 17–19**, at the invitation of Nepali Army Chief General Ashok Raj Sigdel.
- **Indian Ambassador to Nepal Naveen Srivastava**

Bhawana Kanth Becomes India's First Woman Fighter Combat Leader



- Indian Air Force Squadron Leader **Bhawana Kanth became the first woman pilot in India to clear the Fighter Combat Leader (FCL) course**
- She **completed the course at the Tactics and Air Combat Development Establishment (TACDE) in Gwalior,** which trains selected IAF pilots in air combat tactics and leadership
- The Fighter Combat Leader course is a **20-week advanced training programme for Indian Air Force fighter pilots.**
- Bhawana Kanth **was commissioned into the Indian Air Force in June 2016** as part of **India's first batch of women fighter pilots.**
- **In May 2019, she became the first Indian woman fighter pilot to qualify for daytime combat missions.**

Cochin Shipyard Delivers ASW Craft Mangrol to Navy



- **Kochi-based Cochin Shipyard** Limited has delivered the **third Anti-Submarine Warfare Shallow Water Craft, Mangrol**, to the Indian Navy.
- The ship is equipped for underwater surveillance, Anti-Submarine Warfare operations in coastal waters, Low-Intensity Maritime Operations, along with mine warfare capabilities.
- The warship has been named 'Mangrol' after the historic and strategically significant **coastal township of Mangrol in Gujarat's Surat district.**
- Mangrol is a 78-metre vessel powered by a Diesel Engine-Waterjet Propulsion system.

Japan Defence Minister Shinjirō Koizumi visits Western Naval Command in Mumbai

- **Defence Minister of Japan Shinjirō Koizumi, who is on his maiden visit to India**, visited the Western Naval Command in Mumbai.
- He held discussions with Chief of the Naval Staff Admiral Krishna Swaminathan and Flag Officer Commanding-in-Chief, Western Naval Command Vice Admiral Sanjay Vatsayan.
- He also inspected the Guard of Honour, laid a wreath at Gaurav Stambh and visited the indigenous warship INS Chennai.

Visakhapatnam Gets New Submarine Rescue Test Plinth

- A new shore-based Launch and Recovery System (LARS) Test Plinth was inaugurated at the **Submarine Rescue Unit (East) in Visakhapatnam.**
- The **Eastern Naval Command is headquartered at Visakhapatnam in Andhra Pradesh.**
- The Launch and Recovery System is a **technical arrangement used to deploy and recover a Deep Submergence Rescue Vehicle (DSRV).**
- A DSRV is a specialised underwater rescue platform used for **submarine crew evacuation in emergency conditions**.

Divyastra Mk3

- **Kawa UAV Pvt. Ltd., a defence start-up** based in Lucknow, Uttar Pradesh, announced that it successfully conducted **a maiden flight test of the Divyastra Mk3.**

▪ It is an **indigenous loitering munition (kamikaze drone or suicide drone).**
▪ It is designed to destroy high-value enemy assets, infrastructure, and personnel in a warzone by striking the target directly with an onboard explosive warhead.
▪ It is powered by an **indigenous jet-propulsion system developed by New Delhi-based DG Propulsion.**
▪ It features autonomous flight control and AI-enabled target-engagement capabilities.
▪ Divyastra Mk3, by contrast, uses a compact indigenous jet engine designed to give it a higher speed.
▪ This could reduce the time available for an adversary to detect, track, and engage the incoming weapon.

India's first indigenised AK-203 Sher rifle test-fired in Amethi

▪ India has manufactured and tested a prototype of the 100 per cent indigenised AK-203 'Sher' rifle, with army trials for the weapon to begin in September this year.
▪ **The rifles are manufactured by the Indo-Russian Rifles Private Limited, a joint-venture of the Indian Defence Public Sector Undertakings (DPSUs), along with Concern Kalashnikov and Rosoboron export from Russia.**
▪ The AK-203 is a gas-operated, magazine-fed assault rifle chambered for the **7.62x39 mm cartridge** and belongs to the **Kalashnikov AK-100 series.**
▪ It features a folding and adjustable stock, an ergonomic grip and a rail system designed to accommodate modern optical and other accessories.

MQ-9B Sea Guardian HALE RPAS



▪ The Ministry of Defence inked a Rs 1,943-crore contract **with American defence major General Atomics Aeronautical** to lease **two MQ-9B Sea Guardian High-Altitude Long-Endurance (HALE) Remotely Piloted Aircraft Systems (RPAS)** for the Indian Navy for 30 months.
▪ The MQ-9B Sea Guardian HALE RPAS, equipped with advanced systems, state-of-the-art sensors and sophisticated payloads, will significantly enhance the Indian Navy's Maritime Domain Awareness capabilities.
▪ **The systems will provide persistent intelligence, surveillance and reconnaissance coverage over vast areas of the maritime domain,** strengthening India's ability to monitor and respond to developments across the Indian Ocean Region,
▪ Currently, the Navy operates two MQ9As on lease, which were procured in 2020 in the thick of border tensions between India and China for a period of one year, and their lease period was subsequently extended.

KN-30 Missile

▪ Russia recently received **North Korea's KN-30 ballistic missile** for the first time, according to Ukraine's defence intelligence directorate (HUR).
▪ **The KN-30 is the Western designation for the North Korean Hwasong-11C ballistic missile, also known as the Hwasong-11Da.**
▪ It is 10.1 to 10.2 m in length and 1.26 m in diameter.
▪ **It is powered by a solid-fuel engine and launched from a mobile ground-based launcher.**
▪ Its estimated range **reaches 600-900 km, and its claimed warhead mass reaches 2,500 kg.**
▪ **Maximum speed is approximately Mach 5-6.**
▪ The missile can fly in a low quasi-ballistic profile at nearly 50 km in altitude, which reduces the engagement window compared with a higher and more conventional ballistic trajectory.

Amit Shah Inaugurates 9th National Security Strategies Conference

▪ Union Home Minister Amit Shah inaugurated the **ninth two-day National Security Strategies Conference-2026 in New Delhi**

- To **discuss key national security issues, including detection and deportation of illegal migrants**, a policy framework to **combat cyber crime, and proxy warfare by Pakistan**
- Ministers of State for Home Affairs, the Union Home Secretary, Deputy National Security Advisers and heads of Central Armed Police Forces and Central Police Organisations attended
- **The National Security Strategies Conference has been held every year since 2021**.

Territorial Army Launches Terrier Cyber Quest 2026

- **The Territorial Army**, in collaboration with **CyberPeace**, has launched **Terrier Cyber Quest 2026 (TCQ 3.0),** a **national-level hackathon aimed** at developing innovative solutions to contemporary defence, cybersecurity and information-domain challenges.
- The initiative will **focus on emerging areas including Artificial Intelligence (AI), cybersecurity, threat mitigation and digital awareness**, while encouraging development of indigenous solutions relevant to national security.

Indian Army Organises Literary Festival in Kargil to Celebrate Ladakh's Heritage

- In Ladakh, Indian Army organised the '**Adab Aur Saqafat – Literary Festival 2026**' in Kargil to **celebrate the rich literary heritage**, cultural traditions and artistic spirit of Ladakh under the theme **"Celebrating the Culture of Ladakh Highland" at GDC Kargil.**
- The festival witnessed participation from Army officers, college faculty members, students, poets, writers and literature enthusiasts from different parts of Kargil.

Samarthak – The First Indigenous Multi-Purpose Vessel Of Indian Navy

- **Samarthak**, the first indigenously designed and constructed **Multi-Purpose Vessel (MPV)** built by **Larsen & Toubro (L&T)** at its Kattupalli shipyard, was formally delivered to the Indian Navy.
- Samarthak is the lead ship of the Indian Navy's new class of Multi-Purpose Vessels (MPVs).
- Builder: Larsen & Toubro Ltd. (L&T) at its Kattupalli Shipbuilding facility near Chennai, Tamil Nadu.
- **Named 'Samarthak**' (meaning The Proponent or supporter), **symbolizing its role as an enabler across diverse naval missions.**
- Displacing approximately 3,750 tonnes, it is a versatile naval auxiliary platform designed to carry out a **broad spectrum of secondary combat, trials, training, logistics, and environmental protection missions**.

Goa Shipyard Limited hands over ICGS Ajit to Indian Coast Guard

- Recently, the Goa Shipyard Limited (GSL) has handed over the **ICGS Ajit** to the Indian Coast Guard.
- **It is an indigenously built Fast Patrol Vessels (FPVs).**
- **Built By: It is built by the Goa Shipyard Limited (GSL).**
- It is 51.43-metre-long and 8-metre-wide vessel has a displacement of 330 tonnes.
- It is **powered by twin marine diesel engines driving controllable pitch propellers (CPP)**
- It reaches a top speed of more than 27 knots and an endurance of 1,500 nautical miles.
- It is equipped with an advanced integrated machinery control system to enhance operational readiness, efficiency and sustainability.

ICGS Adamya (256) – Lead ship, inducted/commissioned on September 19, 2025 (stationed at Paradip, Odisha).

ICGS Akshar (257) – Second ship, commissioned in October 2025 at Karaikal, Puducherry.

ICGS Amulya (258) – Third ship, commissioned on December 19, 2025 in Goa.

ICGS Akshay (259) – Fourth ship, commissioned on June 27, 2026 in Goa.

ICGS Achal – Fifth ship, commissioned on May 9, 2026, under the control of Coast Guard Region (North West), Gandhinagar.

ICGS Atal – Sixth ship, launched on July 29, 2025 (delivery/commissioning status follows).

Ajit – Seventh ship, delivered to the Coast Guard on August 25, 2026.

HAL, Safran seal deal to develop India's first high-power helicopter engine

- State-owned **Hindustan Aeronautics Limited (HAL) and France's Safran Helicopter Engines** have signed a deal to jointly develop a new **high-power engine for India's next-generation helicopters, Called 'Aravalli'**
- The **engine will power the 13-tonne Indian Multi-Role Helicopter** (IMRH) and its **12.5-ton naval version,** the Deck-Based Multi-Role Helicopter (DBMRH).

- This marks the first instance of a high-power helicopter engine being designed and developed in India
- The engine will be **manufactured by SAFHAL at Tumakuru in Karnataka.**

Defence Minister Rajnath Singh & Madhya Pradesh CM lay foundation stone of T-Series Tank Overhaul Project at Vehicle Factory Jabalpur

- Defence Minister Rajnath Singh laid the **foundation stone of a Rs 472-crore facility for the overhaul of T-series battle tanks at Vehicle Factory Jabalpur (VFJ),** an ordnance unit in Madhya Pradesh.
- The project is expected to boost self-reliance in the maintenance and production of defence equipment.
- the project will further strengthen Jabalpur's role in the defence sector and create new employment opportunities in the Mahakaushal region.
- Under the upcoming project, **the facility will overhaul 80 T-72 and T-90 tanks annually,**
- VFJ is a premier military vehicle manufacturing unit **operating under Armoured Vehicles Nigam Limited and the Ministry of Defence.**
- **Established in 1969**, the factory initially produced Shaktiman 3T vehicles in collaboration with Germany's MAN, as well as Nissan 1T and Jonga vehicles in collaboration with Japan's Nissan Motors Co.

DRDO successfully tests high-altitude combat parachute system at 22,000 feet in Ladakh

- Recently, the Defence Research and Development Organisation has successfully tested its **Military Combat Parachute System (MCPS) at 22,000 feet in one of the world's highest-altitude drop zones in Nyoma, Ladakh.**
- It is indigenously **developed by the Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO).**
- It has been designed by DRDO's Aerial Delivery Research and Development Establishment, Agra, and Defence Bioengineering and Electromedical Laboratory, Bengaluru.

Features of Military Combat Parachute System

- It has successfully undergone a **combat freefall jump from an altitude of 32,000 feet.**
- It is the only parachute system currently in operational use by the Indian Armed Forces capable of deployment above 25,000 feet.
- It consists of several enhanced tactical features, including a lower rate of descent and superior steering capabilities.

Science & Technology

NASA astronauts Anil Menon, Jessica Meir undertake spacewalk to upgrade space station

- NASA astronauts **Jessica Meir** and **Anil Menon** began a spacewalk outside the **International Space Station** to prepare the **3B power channel for the future installation of new roll-out solar arrays.**
- Once installed, the arrays will provide **additional power to support critical station operations, including its safe and controlled deorbit.**
- The **spacewalk lasts six hours and 27 minutes.**
- It marked **the 281st spacewalk conducted in support of the space station, Meir's sixth and Menon's first.**
- Their main task was to **install mounting hardware on the station's 3B power channel**, located on the Starboard 6 truss segment.
- The upgrade will pave the **way for the installation of additional roll-out solar arrays, known as IROSA,** which are designed to **boost the station's power supply.**

Recently, NASA's Voyager 2 got a power-saving upgrade and its mission extended by a year.

- **Voyager 2** is an unmanned space probe launched by NASA in 1977.
- Primary mission: Its mission was to **study the outer planets of our solar system, including Jupiter, Saturn, Uranus, and Neptune and their moons,** and then continue on an interstellar mission.
- **It is the only spacecraft to have ever visited Uranus and Neptune.**

Achievements by the Voyager 2 Mission

- It is the **only spacecraft to study all four of the solar system's giant planets at close range.**
- It discovered **the 14th moon of Jupiter.**
- It was the **first human-made object to fly past Uranus.**
- At Uranus, **Voyager 2 discovered 10 new moons and two new rings.**
- It was the **first human-made object to fly by Neptune**.
- At Neptune, Voyager 2 discovered five moons, four rings, and a "Great Dark Spot."

Pakistan's First Lunar Rover Named Jinnah-1

- Pakistan has named its first lunar rover "Jinnah-1", drawing on the legacy of the country's founder as it prepares to **send its first locally developed rover to the Moon.**
- **Jinnah-1 is scheduled to travel to the Moon in 2029 aboard China's Chang'e-8 mission.**

China Harvests First Rice Crop Grown in Space



- Chinese astronauts aboard the Tiangong space station harvested the first batch of rice grown in orbit.
- The harvest formed part of the Shenzhou-23 mission, which launched on 24 May 2026, and the rice samples were collected for further scientific study.
- Tiangong is China's modular space station, and it has supported long-duration human missions and biological experiments in low Earth orbit.
- The experiment aims to achieve the first continuous cultivation of two generations of rice in orbit.
- It is designed to complete two consecutive life cycles and to study how prolonged
- **microgravity affects genetic stability, plant development, and seed reproduction.**
- The experiment uses four cultivation units and two reproduction methods.
- One method is conventional seed-to-seed sexual reproduction, and the other is ratooning, in which new shoots grow from remaining roots after harvest.
- Scientists will **analyse the returned rice grains, stems, and leaves to study plant growth in space.**
- The findings are intended **to support future space farming and in-situ food production for missions to the Moon and Mars.**

India Develops Beam Catcher for FAIR Project

- Recently, the **first of three units of beam catcher equipment, an integral part of the beam line, has reached the International Mega Science Project, Facility for Antiproton and Ion Research (FAIR) site**.

About Facility for Antiproton and Ion Research

- It is a large multipurpose particle accelerator facility being built at Darmstadt, Germany.
- It is being developed and built in cooperation with international partners.
- India's contribution to this is **funded jointly (50:50) by the Department of Science and Technology (DST) and Department of Atomic Energy (DAE)** of Government of India.
- **Bose institute, Kolkata has been designated as the Indian shareholder** in the FAIR GmbH and the nodal Indian Institution for the implementation of FAIR programme in India.
- **India became one of the founding members of this initiative in 2010.**

Beam Catcher Equipment

- It is one of the key elements of the **super fragment separator (super-FRS) that produces the radioactive beams.**
- The absorbers of the beam are housed in a vacuum chamber, made of **fine-grained graphite and hyper pure copper.**
- It was **designed by the Central Mechanical Engineering Research Institute (CSIR-CMERI) in Durgapur** under the supervision of Bose Institute

Magellanic Bridge

- A team led by **Inter-University Centre for Astronomy and Astrophysics (IUCAA)** team has discovered the first known system of its kind in the **Magellanic Bridge by using eROSITA X-ray telescope.**
- Magellanic Bridge is a **stream of stars and gas created by the close encounter of two nearby galaxies**, the Large and Small Magellanic Clouds.
- It is mainly a **gaseous feature connecting the two galaxies**, with a small fraction of in situ formed young stars.

Key Features of **eROSITA X-ray Telescope**

- eROSITA (extended ROentgen Survey with an Imaging Telescope Array) is a **wide-field X-ray telescope on-board the Russian-German "Spectrum-Roentgen-Gamma" (SRG) observatory.**
- It was developed under the leadership of the **Max-Planck Institute for extraterrestrial Physics (MPE) in Germany (DE).**
- eROSITA is a sensitive X-ray telescope capable of delivering deep, sharp images over very large areas of the sky in the energy range ~0.2-8 keV.
- It is placed in a **halo orbit around the L2 point**
- It has been performing an all-sky survey, in which the whole celestial sphere is mapped once every six months...

Astrobase Unveils India's First Private 800 kN Rocket Engine

- Bengaluru-based Astrobase Space Technologies unveiled EVEREST as India's first privately built 80-tonne-class Full-Flow Staged Combustion rocket engine.
- India has become the fourth nation to have FFSC engine technology after Russia, the U.S., and China.
- The engine uses liquid oxygen and liquid methane, produces 800 kilonewtons of thrust, and is designed for reusable medium-lift launch vehicles.
- Full-Flow Staged Combustion, or FFSC, is a liquid rocket engine cycle in which both propellants pass through preburners before entering the main combustion chamber.
- The cycle is used in high-performance engines and is associated with higher efficiency and lower thermal stress than simpler engine cycles.
- EVEREST has a specific impulse of about 340 seconds and a throttle range from 50% to 110%.
- The engine is intended for reusable launch systems, where controlled thrust variation is required during ascent, landing, and recovery operations.

Why Use LOX-Methane (Methalox)?

- Clean Burning for Reusability: Unlike kerosene (RP-1), methane does not leave carbon soot (coking) inside engine pipes and turbines, making rapid inspection and engine reuse possible.
- Global Precedent: SpaceX's Raptor engine (powering Starship) is currently the only operational FFSC engine flying to space, using the same LOX-methane propellant combination.

NASA invites ISRO to join its ambitious Moon Base programme

- India and the United States are set to strengthen their cooperation in space exploration, with **NASA inviting ISRO to join its ambitious Moon Base program, building on the two countries' partnership under the Artemis Accords.**

Artemis Accord

- It was launched **in 2020.**
- The Artemis Accords are a **non-binding set of principles designed to guide civil space exploration.**
- It provides a common set of principles to enhance the **governance of the civil exploration and use of outer space.**
- It was co-led by NASA and the U.S. Department of State, together with seven other founding member nations (**Australia, Canada, Italy, Japan, Luxembourg, the United Arab Emirates, and the United Kingdom)**.
- **India is also a signatory to this accord.**

PowerBank-50

▪ Hyderabad-based space startup **TakeMe2Space** recently announced that **its PowerBank-50 satellite battery pack has now earned the 'flight heritage' tag.**

▪ It is an indigenously built satellite battery pack developed by Hyderabad-based spacetech startup TakeMe2Space.

▪ It is India's first indigenously developed satellite battery to earn the coveted 'flight heritage' status.

▪ The recognition comes after the battery pack has successfully completed its **first mission aboard Skyroot Aerospace's Vikram-1 on its maiden flight — Mission 'Aagaman'.**

▪ Vikram-1 became the first privately developed Indian rocket to reach orbit, making **India only the third country in the world, after the United States and China**, where a private company has achieved orbital launch capability.

▪ A PowerBank-50 unit powered Cosmoserve Space's experimental payload aboard the rocket's Orbital Adjustment Module (OAM) at an altitude of 450 km.

▪ The battery performed as designed throughout launch and in the harsh conditions of space, including vacuum, radiation, and extreme temperature fluctuations

Features

▪ It is a compact **lithium-ion battery pack designed specifically for small satellites.**

▪ Weighing just 380 grams and roughly the size of a paperback book, it stores over 50 Wh of energy , Multiple PowerBank-50 units can be stacked together to power CubeSats and microsatellites, with an operational life of up to five years in low-Earth orbit.

VIHAAN: India's Indigenous Broadband Networking Chip Achieves First-Pass Silicon Success

▪ Chennai-based fabless semiconductor startup **Aheesa Digital Innovations, supported under the Ministry of Electronics and IT's (MeitY) Design Linked Incentive (DLI) Scheme**, achieved first-pass silicon success for its indigenous **broadband networking System-on-Chip (SoC) named 'VIHAAN'.**

▪ **VIHAAN is India's first domestically designed broadband networking System-on-Chip (SoC).**

▪ Built on open-standard RISC-V architecture and powered by the indigenous VEGA processor developed by C-DAC, **it is purpose-built to deliver high-throughput, secure, and sovereign semiconductor solutions for optical fiber and broadband customer premises equipment (CPE).**

IISc Releases SraVaani Voice AI Model

▪ Researchers at **IISc's SPIRE Lab, in collaboration with ARTPARK and Google, have released SraVaani**, the **first multilingual Indian speech recognition model** trained on 65 Indian languages and dialects, including over 40 languages that today's speech recognition systems do not officially support.

▪ **SraVaani extends automatic speech recognition to several regional and non-scheduled Indian languages.**

Hexavalent vaccine could improve India's immunisation programme: Study

▪ **Introducing the hexavalent (six-in-one) vaccine into India's Universal Immunisation Programme (UIP) could improve the efficiency of the country's childhood immunisation programme,** according to a recent study conducted by the Union Health Ministry.

▪ It is a **combination vaccine that protects infants against six different diseases with a single injection.**

The hexavalent vaccine protects against: **Diphtheria, Tetanus, Pertussis (Whooping Cough), Hepatitis B, Polio, Haemophilus influenzae type b (Hib) infections**

Hexavalent vaccine could deliver several benefits, including:

▪ **Fewer injections for infants, making vaccination more convenient for children and caregivers.**

▪ Lower cold-chain storage requirements.

▪ **Reduced use of syringes and other vaccination supplies.**

▪ Less time spent by Auxiliary Nurse Midwives (ANMs) administering vaccines and maintaining records.

▪ **Time savings for parents and caregivers during immunisation visits..**

22 children die of Chandipura virus in Gujarat this monsoon

▪ Chandipura virus (CHPV) is an arbovirus in the genus Vesiculovirus that spreads mainly through **sandflies and can cause acute encephalitis.**

▪ It was first identified in 1965 in Chandipura village in Maharashtra, India, from which it gets its name.

▪ The virus is known to cause **Acute Encephalitis Syndrome (AES), a serious condition that leads to inflammation of the brain.**

▪ Although cases are uncommon, outbreaks have been reported in different parts of India over the years, with children being the most affected group.

▪ Most reported outbreaks have occurred in **western and central India, particularly during the rainy season.**

▪Transmission:

▪ It is **vector-borne and primarily spread through the bite of infected sand flies, which are tiny blood-feeding insects.**

Common symptoms include:

▪ High fever, **Severe headache**, Vomiting, Weakness and tiredness

▪ Muscle pain

▪ Irritability or unusual drowsiness

▪ Convulsions or seizures

▪ Confusion

▪ Loss of consciousness in severe cases

▪ It can progress very rapidly, especially in children.

▪ In some cases, symptoms may worsen within a short period and lead to serious complications involving the brain and nervous system.

▪ **CHPV can cause high case fatality ratios, ranging from 56% to 75%,** as reported during previous outbreaks in India.

▪ There is **currently no specific antiviral medicine or vaccine to treat the infection.**

ICAR Develops First Fully Annotated Pigeonpea T2T Genome

▪ The Indian Council of Agricultural Research (ICAR) developed India's first fully annotated telomere-to-telomere (T2T) reference genome of pigeonpea variety 'Asha'.

▪ The genome assembly, designated NIPB_CcT2T_4, was released on 20 April 2026 and is available in the National Center for Biotechnology Information database under accession number GCF_000230855.1.

▪ Popularly known as 'Arhar' or 'Tur', pigeonpea is one of India's most important pulse crops and a major source of dietary protein.

▪ The fully annotated T2T reference genome will serve as a valuable national genomic resource for advanced gene and pangenome analyses, discovery of genes associated with important agronomic and nutritional traits, and the application of molecular breeding and genome-editing technologies

▪ NOTE : the launch of the Mission for 'Aatmanirbharta in Pulses' (2025-26 to 2030-31)

Indigenous African Swine Fever (ASF) Vaccine Developed by ICAR Bolsters India's Biosecurity

▪ **ICAR–National Institute of High Security Animal Diseases (ICAR-NIHSAD), Bhopal,** have developed **India's first indigenous MA-104_Cell_Line-Based Live Attenuated African Swine Fever (ASF) Vaccine for pigs.**

▪ Developed using a novel attenuated ASFV Genotype II virus with unique gene deletions in the MA-104 cell line, the vaccine is a major breakthrough in veterinary research and is well suited for large-scale production.

▪ At present, **only a couple of commercially licensed ASF vaccines are available in Vietnam.**

▪ African Swine Fever (ASF), caused by **the African Swine Fever Virus (ASFV),** is one of the most devastating trans-boundary animal disease affecting domestic and wild pigs worldwide.

▪ Characterised **by high fever, haemorrhages and mortality rates that may approach 100 per cent**, the disease has caused severe socio-economic losses to the global pig farming sector.

▪ **Since its first detection in India in 2020**

Three common medicines classified as carcinogenic by WHO cancer agency

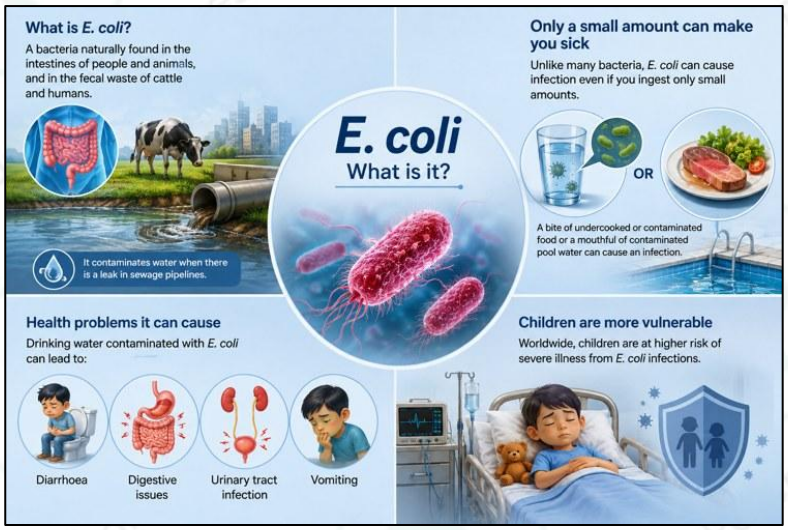
- Three widely-prescribed medicines used to treat high blood pressure, fungal infections, and organ transplant rejection have been classified as "carcinogenic to humans" (Group 1) by the International Agency for Research on Cancer (IARC), the World Health Organisation's (WHO) cancer research agency.
- Experts stressed that the classification is a hazard identification and should not prompt patients to discontinue treatment without consulting their doctors.
- The three medicines — **hydrochlorothiazide (hypertension), voriconazole (fungal infections), and tacrolimus (an immunosuppressant preventing transplant rejection)** — are on the WHO Model List of Essential Medicines, prescribed to millions worldwide.

E. coli in drinking water, just 11% stations have all basic amenities: Why CAG is concerned

- In a recent report titled 'Passenger Amenities and Sanitation at Non-Suburban Railway Stations in Indian Railways'. the CAG said **E. coli bacteria was detected in drinking water samples collected from eight railway stations out of 49 stations**, including several Mumbai local stations.
- Other stations were the sample discovered the contamination **were those in Kerala, Tamil Nadu, and Jharkhand.**
- The **audit covered the period from 2019-20 to 2023-24.**

What is E. coli?

- Escherichia coli (E.coli) is a bacterial strain that is commonly found in the intestines of people and animals, fecal waste of cattle and humans.
- The most common manner in which this bacteria contaminates water is **if there is a leak in the sewage pipelines in a locality.**
- Unlike other disease-causing bacteria, E. coli can cause an **infection even if you ingest only small amounts.**
- Consumption of water contaminated with E.coli can cause **diarrhoea, digestive issues, urinary tract infection and vomiting.**



How does E. coli infection spread?

- Eating contaminated, undercooked or raw food like salads whose vegetables haven't been washed enough.
- **Drinking contaminated water**: E. coli is around us as poop from infected animals and people can contaminate natural water sources and swimming pools. Sharing objects or surfaces with someone with an infection.
- **What's the treatment?**
- **It is treatable with antibiotics.** Unfortunately, some E.coli strains have **become drug resistant too because of overuse of antibiotics.**
- A sensitivity test can show which antibiotics can work, whether injectables are required or not.

Mission Cosmo Cube

- A proposed suitcase-sized satellite could give astronomers a new way to study the universe's earliest stages by listening for faint radio signals from more than 13.5 billion years ago.
- **The mission, called CosmoCube, would operate near the Moon and use the lunar far side as a natural shield against radio interference from Earth.**
- Researchers say the concept could help scientists study the **poorly understood period between the Big Bang and the formation of the first stars.**

▪ The international team behind CosmoCube proposes placing the small spacecraft in orbit around the Moon, allowing it to collect measurements as it passes behind the Moon's far side.
▪ The Moon would **block radio noise originating from Earth, creating a much quieter environment for the spacecraft's instruments.**
▪ According to the researchers, **Cosmo Cube would spend around 40 minutes on the far side during every two-hour orbit.**
▪ Over a proposed two-year mission, the satellite could collect roughly 1,000 hours of data at extremely low radio frequencies.
▪ The measurements could offer scientists a clearer picture of the cosmic dark age and the transition towards the formation of the first stars and galaxies.

The GISAT-1A Mission

▪ The Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) is preparing to **launch the GISAT-1A (EOS-05) Earth observation satellite** aboard the GSLV-F17 rocket in September 2026.
▪ GISAT-1A (designated as EOS-05) is a state-of-the-art, agile **Geo-Imaging Satellite designed to operate from a Geostationary Orbit (36,000 km altitude).**
▪ Unlike conventional remote sensing satellites operating in Low Earth Orbit (LEO), GISAT-1A remains **stationed over the Indian subcontinent, enabling continuous, near real-time optical surveillance and environmental monitoring.**
▪ **Nodal Agency: Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO).**
▪ **Launch Vehicle**: **GSLV Mk-II** (Flight F17), featuring the indigenous Cryogenic Upper Stage (CE-7.5) and a 4-metre Ogive payload fairing.
▪ **Aim:** To provide near **real-time, high-temporal-resolution imaging of the entire Indian subcontinent** and surrounding oceanic bodies to enable rapid disaster monitoring, continuous agricultural assessment, and **enhanced national security surveillance.**

Key Features :

▪ **Stationed in a geostationary orbital slot** (~36,000 km above the equator), keeping almost the entire Indian landmass in continuous line of sight throughout daylight hours.
▪ **Capable of capturing images of the entire Indian mainland every 30 minutes at a spatial resolution of 42 metres**, with rapid target steering capable of capturing designated high-priority areas every 5 minutes.
▪ **Equipped with** a 700 mm Ritchey–Chrétien telescope and high-sensitivity sensors operating across Multispectral (VNIR) and Hyperspectral (VNIR and SWIR) bands to discern fine surface mineralogy, crop stress, and vegetation indices.
▪ **Designed for an operational mission life of 10 years.**

Scientists Discover Mega-Earth GJ 523b

▪ **GJ 523b** is an exoplanet **identified as a "mega-Earth" with a radius about 2.55 times that of Earth** and a mass of 23.5 Earth masses.
▪ **It orbits a mid-K dwarf star** and has an estimated bulk density of about 7.8 grams per cubic centimetre.
▪ It is the **first exoplanet discovered** and cataloged by researchers **with the Wisconsin Center for Origins Research (WiCOR),**
▪ Exoplanets are also called **extrasolar planets because they orbit stars beyond the Solar System.**

Scientists identify S301 as fastest star in Milky Way

▪ S301 is a star in the Milky Way galaxy that has been identified as the fastest-moving star recorded on a secure orbit.
▪ **S301 reaches a maximum speed of about 15,500 miles per second, or 25,000 kilometres per second.**
▪ This speed is roughly 8% of the speed of light.
▪ The orbit of S301 takes 8.7 years to complete.
▪ The discovery used the **European Southern Observatory's Very Large Telescope Interferometer at the Paranal Observatory in Chile**

Sophie Adenot Becomes First French Woman to Walk in Space

- **European Space Agency astronaut Sophie Adenot** became the **first French woman and the second European woman to perform a spacewalk** on 18 August 2026.
- She carried out U.S. Spacewalk 97 **outside the International Space Station with NASA astronaut Anil Menon** during a 6-hour and 23-minute extravehicular activity.
- The main task of the spacewalk was to **replace a failed Space-to-Ground antenna, or SGANT, on the ISS Z1 truss.**
- The SGANT provides a communication link for high-speed data transfer between the International Space Station and Mission Control in Houston.

The Ministry of Science and Technology informed, about a new smart drug named RK-251

- Recently, the Ministry of Science and Technology informed, about a new **smart drug named RK-251 that can replace traditional chemotherapy**.
- It is a **smart cancer drug designed to activate primarily in cancer cells and does not harm healthy cells**.
- It is developed in collaboration with Dr. Asis Bala from the Institute of Advanced Study in Science and Technology (IASST) and Dr. K.P. Bhabak from the Indian Institute of Technology-Guwahati.
- It exhibited strong activity against aggressive triple-negative breast cancer cells, with much less effect on healthy cells.

Govt restricts use of Chlorpheniramine and Phenylephrine combinations for children below 4

- The Union ministry of health and family welfare announced that it has banned **Fixed Dose Combinations (FDCs)** containing **chlorpheniramine maleate and phenylephrine hydrochloride** for use in **children below four years of age.**
- The government has imposed restrictions on the manufacture, sale and distribution of all fixed dose combinations (FDCs) containing Chlorpheniramine Maleate and Phenylephrine Hydrochloride, mandating a clear warning that these medicines shall not be used in children below four years of age,"
- **Chlorpheniramine** is a histamine-H1 receptor antagonist indicated for the management of symptoms associated with **upper respiratory allergies.**
- **Phenylephrine** is used as a **nasal decongestant to temporarily unblock a nose or relieve sinus pressure in people with nasal and sinus congestion** caused by colds or allergies.

C. P. Radhakrishnan launches India's first non-GMO popcorn maize hybrid seed

- Vice President C. P. Radhakrishnan launched India's first non-GMO, high-expansion popcorn maize hybrid seed at Musunuru in Andhra Pradesh's Eluru district,
- **Popcorn maize is a specialised form of Zea mays selected for kernel expansion after heating.**
- High-expansion hybrids are bred for larger popped volume, which is a key quality parameter in the popcorn industry.
- **Non-GMO seeds are developed through conventional breeding methods and do not contain genetically modified traits**

India developed two genome-edited rice varieties — DRR Dhan 100 (Kamala) and Pusa Rice DST1 is set to for commercial production

- India developed two genome-edited rice varieties **— DRR Dhan 100 (Kamala) and Pusa Rice DST1** is set to for commercial production in the upcoming rabi season.

Pusa DST Rice 1

- It is derived from **MTU1010, which is suitable for rabi season in southern states.**
- It is developed by **Indian Council of Agricultural Research (ICAR)-Indian Agricultural Research Institute (IARI),** New Delhi.
- The edit in its genome targets the **Drought and Salt Tolerance (DST) gene,** with the aim of improving the plant's ability to **cope with drought and salt-affected soils.**

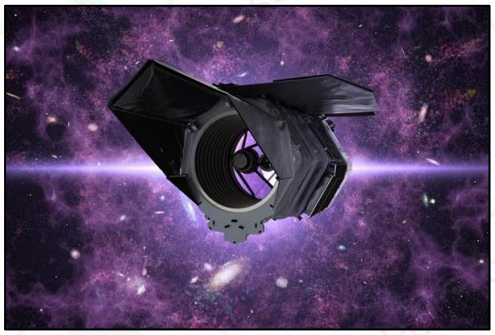
- It is expected to be grown in Andhra Pradesh, Telangana, Karnataka, Tamil Nadu, Kerala, Chhattisgarh, Odisha, Madhya Pradesh, Maharashtra, Jharkhand, Bihar, Uttar Pradesh and West Bengal.

About DRR Dhan 100

- It is also called **Kamala variety.**
- It was developed **by ICAR-Indian Institute of Rice Research, Hyderabad,** from the popular Samba Mahsuri (BPT 5204) variety.
- Scientists edited a gene involved in cytokinin metabolism, **with the aim of increasing the number of grains produced** by each panicle.
- Properties: **The resulting variety is said to mature about 20 days earlier than Samba Mahsuri, in around 130 days,** and has a stronger stalk that is less prone to lodging, or falling over

NASA Launches Nancy Grace Roman Space Telescope to Explore universe's biggest mysteries

- NASA's **Nancy Grace Roman Space Telescope** has been launched from Florida
- Named after **Nancy Grace Roman, NASA's first chief astronomer and** widely regarded as the **"mother of the Hubble Space Telescope."**
- With a **2.4-metre-wide primary mirror,** Roman can **capture an area of sky more than 100 times larger than Hubble**
- Over the next five years, Roman could help scientists discover previously **unseen galaxies and exoplanets while providing new insights into the nature of dark energy and the evolution of the universe.**
- It is designed to revolutionise infrared astronomy
- It carries a **specialised instrument called a coronagraph**, which can **block the intense glare of stars, making it easier to observe faint objects such as exoplanets and planet-forming disks.**



Environment

Supreme Court Extends 10-Km Mining Buffer to Wetlands

- The Supreme Court recently clarified that a direction banning mining activities within a 10 km radius of the **Asan wetland conservation reserve, a Ramsar site in Uttarakhand,** would apply to other wetland conservation reserves across the country for the sake of parity.
- It is located in **the Dehradun district of Uttarakhand.**
- Spanning 444.4 ha, it is situated at the confluence of the Asan and Yamuna Rivers.
- The **Asan River, unlike other rivers which flow north to south, flows in a west to east direction.**
- The reserve comprises the Asan Barrage and the wetland formed by damming the Asan River in 1967.
- The barrage created a freshwater reservoir with habitats ideal for migratory and resident birds.
- **It was declared a Conservation Reserve in 2005 under Section 36A of the Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972.**
- It was **declared a Ramsar site in 2020. It is the first Ramsar site in Uttarakhand.**
- The wetland is especially known for hosting large flocks of ruddy shelduck during winter.

Heatwaves and Lightning Added to NDRF Protocol

- Heatwaves and lightning were added to the list of notified natural calamities under the operational guidelines for the State Disaster Response Fund (SDRF) and the National Disaster Response Fund (NDRF) .
- The Union Home Ministry informed the Lok Sabha about the inclusion, which follows recommendations of the **16th Finance Commission for the award period 2026-31.**
- The SDRF is the primary fund available with State governments for immediate relief in the event of notified disasters.
- The NDRF is a central fund used for additional assistance when a disaster requires support beyond the SDRF allocation.

▪ Heatwave refers to the period of abnormally high temperatures, more than the normal maximum temperature, that occurs during the summer season.

▪ In India, heat waves typically occur between March and June, depending on the advent of the Monsoon. **The heat wave is also called a "silent disaster".**

▪ Heat waves should not be considered until a **station's highest temperature exceeds 40℃ for plains and 30℃ for hilly regions**.

▪ Lightning is a powerful atmospheric **electrical discharge occurring between charged regions in clouds or between cloud and ground.**

▪ It releases massive energy ranging from 200 megajoules to 7 gigajoules, heating surrounding air and producing visible flashes and thunder.

Chhattisgarh to Translocate Wild Buffaloes from Assam for Population Revival

▪ The wild buffalo population plummeting over the last few decades, **the Chhattisgarh Forest Department is planning to translocate wild buffaloes from Assam** and keep them in enclosures at the **Pamed Wildlife Sanctuary, the Udanti Sitanadi Tiger Reserve, and the Indravati Tiger Reserve (ITR).**

▪ **Wild buffalo is the state animal of Chhattisgarh,** and officials hope the translocation will help boost their population naturally.

▪ **The Asiatic wild buffalo is the largest wild bovine in the world,** weighing twice as much as its less muscular cousin.

▪ India is home to more than 90% of the global wild water buffalo population (3,500-3,700 individuals), mainly in **two disconnected clusters: northeast and central India.**

▪ **While Assam hosts most of India's wild buffaloes across various protected areas.**

▪ Once found in **Chhattisgarh, Maharashtra, Madhya Pradesh, Odisha, Jharkhand and Telangana in central India, it is today confined to small herds in Chhattisgarh and Maharashtra.**

▪ In India, the wild buffalo enjoys the highest protection under **Schedule I of the Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972.**

▪ The **2016 IUCN Red List** for threatened species places it in **the "endangered" category.**

India unveils action plan to strengthen clouded leopard conservation

▪ Recently, on the occasion of International Clouded Leopard Day, India has reaffirmed its commitment to the conservation of one of Asia's most elusive wild cats through the newly launched **Clouded Leopard Conservation Action Plan (CAP).**

▪ It is prepared **under the Government of India–GEF–UNDP initiative.**

▪ It provides a comprehensive framework for **securing habitats, restoring forest connectivity, strengthening scientific monitoring and empowering local communities** for conservation of the species.

▪ The CAP provides for standardised scientific monitoring through **camera traps, occupancy surveys, genetics and environmental DNA (eDNA).**

▪ It also encourages **transboundary cooperation** with neighbouring range countries for coordinated conservation of the species across its range.

Clouded Leopard

▪ It is a wild cat inhabiting dense forests of the Himalayas through mainland **Southeast Asia into South China.**

There are two species of clouded leopards:

▪ **The clouded leopard (Neofelis nebulosa),** found on the mainland of southeastern Asia, and the **Sunda clouded leopard (Neofelis diardi),** found on the islands of Sumatra and Borneo.

▪ It is found from **Nepal, Bangladesh, and India through Indochina to Sumatra and Borneo, and northeastward to southern China.**

▪ In India, it is found in Sikkim, northern West Bengal, Meghalaya, Tripura, Mizoram, Manipur, Assam, Nagaland, and Arunachal Pradesh.

▪ **They prefer to live in lowland tropical rainforests.**

- It is named after the distinctive 'clouds' on its coat – ellipses partially edged in black, with the insides a darker colour than the background colour of the pelt.
- It has an exceptionally long tail for balancing, which can be as long as the body itself, thick with black ring markings.
- **Conservation Status: IUCN Red List: Vulnerable**

The Indonesian Babirusa

- Chester Zoo in the UK announced **the birth of Rana**, a **rare babirusa piglet,** amid declining wild populations **threatened by African swine fever, habitat loss, and hunting in Indonesia.**
- The babirusa (genus Babyrousa)—commonly known as **the pig-deer**—is one of the **oldest living and strangest wild pig species.**
- **The name babirusa comes from the Malay language.**
- Geographic Range: **Endemic exclusively to four Indonesian islands**: Sulawesi, Togian, Sula, and Buru.
- Inhabits tropical rainforests, swamps, and wetlands, frequently choosing areas near riverbanks and natural ponds rich in aquatic plants.
- **IUCN Status: Vulnerable**



Colletes bhutanicus

- Recently, **Colletes bhutanicus has been recorded for the first time in India from Tawang district of Arunachal Pradesh** by scientists of the Zoological Survey of India (ZSI).
- It is a rare solitary **Himalayan plasterer bee, recorded from Arunachal Pradesh for the first time.**
- The bee was found at elevations ranging from 1,500 metres to 3,800 metres.
- It has been recorded from **Bhutan and China.**
- **Unlike honeybees, Colletes bees are solitary and do not live in large colonies.**
- Individual bees **generally nest separately** and play an important role in pollination by moving between flowers to collect pollen and nectar.

Pteris madhusoodananii

- A team of Indian botanists recently discovered a rare new species of fern named **Pteris madhusoodananii within the misty Kolli hills of the Eastern Ghats.**
- It was discovered within the **misty Kolli hills of the Eastern Ghats in Tamil Nadu.**
- It has been immediately classified as **'Critically Endangered' due to its extremely small habitat** and the threat of human encroachment.

Begonia neelamorum Named After the Neelam Clan of the Nyishi Tribe

- Researchers named Begonia neelamorum after the Neelam clan of the Nyishi tribe, whose members helped them navigate rugged terrain and locate the plant during a difficult expedition.
- The Nyishi are the largest ethnic group in Arunachal Pradesh.
- In Nishi, their traditional language, Nyi refers to "a man" and the word shi denotes "a being", which combined together refers to a civilized human being.
- They are concentrated in eight districts of Arunachal Pradesh, East Kameng, Pakke Kesang, Papum Pare, Lower Subansiri, Kamle, Kra Daadi, Kurung Kumey, and Upper Subansiri.
- **The Nyishi support themselves with slash-and-burn agriculture and hunting and fishing.**
- Along with agriculture and allied activities, the Nyishis are experts in handicrafts such as weaving, cane and bamboo works, pottery, blacksmith, wood carving, carpentry, etc.
- **Festivals:** The Nyishi celebrates three major festivals, namely, Boori-Boot (February), Nyokum (February), and Longte (April).
- Polygaymy is prevalent among the Nyishi.



- They trace their descent patrilineally and are divided into several clans.
- One striking feature of Nyishi society is that it is neither based on a caste system nor stratified into classes, except for a loose type of social distinction which is not determined by birth or occupation.

India's Asiatic Lion Population Reaches 891

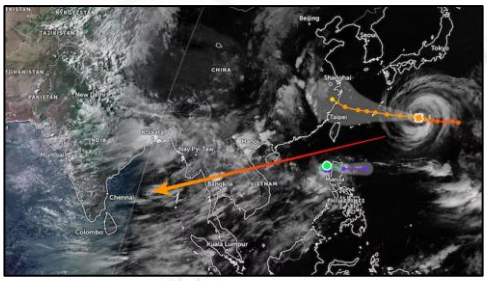
- India's Asiatic lion population increased from **523 in 2015 to 891 in 2025**, as recorded in the **16th Asiatic Lion Population Estimation.**
- The species is **found mainly in Gujarat's Gir and Greater Gir landscape**, and its range has expanded from about 30,000 square kilometres in 2020 to nearly 35,000 square kilometres.
- The Asiatic lion is a subspecies of lion scientifically known as **Panthera leo persica.**
- Its only natural wild population survives in India, mainly **in the Saurashtra region of Gujarat.**
- Due to sustained conservation, the IUCN moved the Asiatic lion from **"Endangered" (2008) to Vulnerable (2025) on its Red List.**
- The 16th Asiatic Lion Population Estimation was conducted from 10 to 13 May 2025 across 11 districts in Gujarat.

Assam Finance Minister inaugurates new Kalamati Wildlife Range Office at Sonai Rupai Wildlife Sanctuary

- The Assam Finance Minister recently inaugurated the newly constructed **Kalamati Wildlife Range Office at Sonai Rupai Wildlife Sanctuary in Sonitpur.**
- Spread over an area of 220 sq.km., the core area covers 175 sq.km., extending over the foothills of the Himalayan range.
- The sanctuary experiences a **subtropical type of climate with hot and humid summers, with heavy summer rains often causing floods and river overflows.**
- **The Burhidihing River traces its course through the sanctuary.**
- The Namchang River, flowing from the state of Arunachal Pradesh, enters this region and joins the Burhidihing River.
- The **main attractions of the sanctuary are Elephant and Indian bison.**
- Avifauna includes endangered species like White Winged Wood Duck. Other birds commonly found here are Woodpecker, Hill Myna, Indian Roller, Nightjar, Horned Owl, etc.

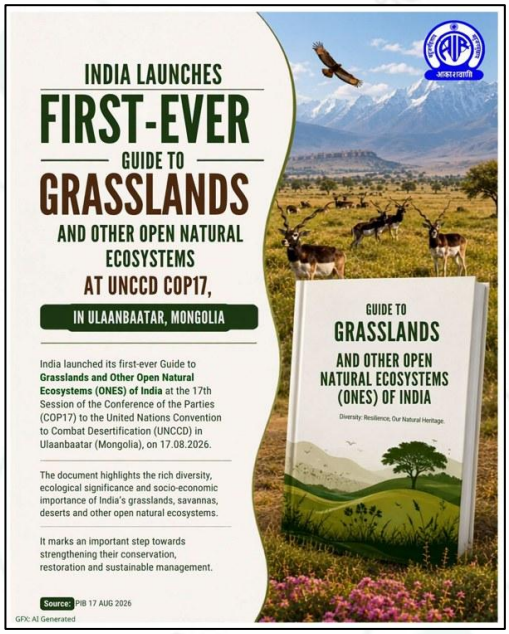
Super Typhoon Dolphin

- **Super Typhoon Dolphin**, with sustained winds of **175 kmph** and gusts up to **210 kmph**, is moving towards Japan's **Daito and Ryukyu Islands**.
- Meteorologists are assessing its potential impact on the **Indian summer monsoon**.
- A **strong western Pacific typhoon** can temporarily alter large-scale atmospheric circulation, disrupting monsoon moisture transport.
- This may **suppress rainfall over parts of India** by weakening monsoon weather systems and reducing moisture inflow.



India launched its first-ever Guide to Grasslands and ONEs

- Recently, India **launched its first-ever Guide to Grasslands and Other Open Natural Ecosystems (ONEs) of India** at the 17th Session of the Conference of the Parties **(COP17) to the United Nations Convention to Combat Desertification (UNCCD) in Ulaanbaatar, Mongolia.**
- India's Guide to Grasslands and ONEs marks an **important step in the direction of strengthening their conservation, restoration, and sustainable management.**



- It highlights the rich diversity, ecological significance, and socio-economic importance of India's grasslands and other open natural ecosystems.
- It brings together information on major ONEs across India, covering their geographical settings, ecological characteristics, biodiversity, and the communities and tribes associated with them.
- It also contains sections on pastoralism, fire ecology, and carbon sequestration
- Notably, India's ONEs range from Himalayan and Terai grasslands to the Thar and Banni landscapes, rocky plateaus, ravines, scrublands, Deccan savannas, coastal ecosystems, and desert landscapes.

Giloy

- Giloy, the climbing herb found in gardens and forests across India, has found an **unusual patient in Madhya Pradesh**, a **young tigress battling canine distemper,** one of the most dangerous viral diseases affecting wild carnivores.



- **It is a climbing shrub that grows on other trees**, from the botanical family Menispermaceae.
- **Giloy is also called giloe, guduchi, and amrita, among other names.**
- **It is native to India but also found in China and tropical areas of Australia and Africa.**
- It grows well in **almost all types of soils and under varying climatic conditions.**
- The plant is **cultivated by stem cutting in the months of May-June.**
- It's considered an **essential herbal plant in Ayurvedic and folk medicine, where people use it as a treatment for a wide range of health conditions.**

Nutritional Value:

- Giloy contains several **essential nutrients such as copper, iron, manganese, zinc, calcium, and phosphorus.**

Traditionally, giloy is used to treat

- fever
- urinary problems
- asthma
- dysentery
- diarrhea
- skin infections
- Hansen's disease (formerly called leprosy)
- diabetes
- gout
- jaundice
- anorexia
- eye conditions

Doronicum sanctum



- Researchers from the CSIR-Institute of Himalayan Bioresource Technology (IHBT) have announced the discovery of a new plant species and named it as Doronicum sanctum.
- It was discovered in the high-altitude wilderness of **Arunachal**

Pradesh.

- It is the **new plant species belonging to the sunflower family.**
- It was found at an elevation of approximately 4,086 metres above sea level in the Tawang district.
- The researchers chose sanctum name because the plant's type locality is situated near the **Chumi Gyatse Holy Waterfalls**

A rare weather phenomenon resembling a waterspout was observed over the Brahmaputra in Assam's Barpeta district

- A waterspout is a large column of air and mist rotating over a water body.
- It is **less intense and typically lasts for around five minutes — occasionally it can last up to 10 minutes**.
- The average waterspout can be **around 165 feet in diameter, with wind speeds of 100 kilometres per hour.**
- They occur when **there are high levels of humidity and relatively warm water temperatures** compared to the overlying air.

New Himalayan Plant Named After Nirmal Purja

- A newly identified Himalayan flowering plant has been **named Impatiens nimspurjai in honour of Nepali mountaineer Nirmal "Nimsdai" Purja.**
- The genus is known locally in Nepal
- The species grows on humid slopes and forest margins at elevations of about 2,800 to 2,900 metres.

Ahmedabad Science City welcomes two new penguin chicks as 'Space Festival' begins

- Ahmedabad's Science City has added **two new African penguin chicks to its Aquatic Gallery,** taking the total **number of penguins at the facility to 10.**
- The chicks, **named 'Shaurya' and 'Veer', were formally named**
- The announcement came as Science City began its three-day Space Festival-2026, ahead of 'National Space Day' on August 23.

ICAR Registers 16 New Indigenous Livestock Breeds

- The Indian Council of Agricultural Research (ICAR) registered 16 new indigenous livestock and dog breeds in 2026.
- **The registration was completed through the ICAR-National Bureau of Animal Genetic Resources (ICAR-NBAGR) in Karnal, Haryana,** and the total number of registered animal breeds in India rose to 262, including 258 indigenous breeds and 4 synthetic breeds.

Category	New Breed	State/Region
Cattle	Koppal	Karnataka
Cattle	Mahakaushali	Madhya Pradesh
Cattle	Periyar	Kerala
Cattle	Umarda	Maharashtra
Sheep	Asomi	Assam
Sheep	Kow Debar	Uttarakhand
Sheep	Madgyal	Maharashtra & Karnataka
Sheep	Seemanchali	Bihar
Buffalo	Gomanchali	Goa
Goat	Totapuri	Rajasthan
Goat	Battisi	Rajasthan & Uttar Pradesh
Pig	Nagal	Nagaland
Yak	Sikkimese	Sikkim
Donkey	Braj	Uttar Pradesh
Pony	Kashmiri	Jammu & Kashmir
Dog	Kombai	Tamil Nadu

The ICAR National Bureau of Animal Genetic Resources registered Periyar Cow as an indigenous cattle breed

- It is also locally known as **'Periyar Kullan' (Periyar dwarf), is only the second native cattle breed from Keralam to receive national recognition,**
- **First was the Vechur cow, which was recognised in 1996.**
- Other names: It is locally known as Kuttampuzha cattle and Andukanni,
- It is traditionally **found across Periyar River basin and adjoining plantation** and forest landscapes regions of Ernakulam and Thrissur.

Characteristics

- It has the distinctive ability to thrive under semi-feral, low-input management and agroforestry conditions, with extensive grazing on naturally available vegetation.
- It can have brown, black or grey colouring, with horizontally placed ears, slightly curved horns and a prominent hump in bulls.
- It is a compact, medium-sized animal weighing about 150-200 kg and standing approximately 105-110 cm tall.
- Its **small build and ability to survive on natural grazing make it relatively easy and inexpensive to maintain.**
- Its milk is valued for its nutritional characteristics. Milk is classified as A2 Beta casein, the healthiest variety
- **The lactation period ranges between 160 and 200 days**

What caused Nepal's deadly glacial flood?

- NEWS: Massive flash floods in a border area of Nepal and China killed at least 160 people and left hundreds of tourists, workers, and others missing, including 133 Indians.
- The US Geological Survey initially reported a **magnitude 5.2 earthquake**, about 66 kilometres (41 miles) north of Kathmandu near the border that **sent debris downstream and caused catastrophic flooding.**
- The Nepal Floods 2026 disaster occurred after an **ice rock avalanche** triggered a sudden surge in the **Bhotekoshi River.**

What is a Flash Flood?

- A Flash Flood develops rapidly **when a large volume of water reaches a river valley or low lying area within a short period.** In the Himalayas, glacial events can intensify this hazard.
- **A Glacial Lake Outburst Flood** occurs when water stored in or around a glacial lake is suddenly released, producing destructive downstream flooding
- The main causes of the Nepal Flash Flood disaster was a glacial collapse that generated an ice rock avalanche and powerful downstream debris flow.

The Hawk Fire

- Hawk Fire is **a fast-moving, human-caused wildfire near Peavine Peak, northwest of Reno in Nevada, USA.**
- Considering the seriousness of the situation, **Nevada Governor Joe Lombardo declared a State of Emergency in Washoe County** to strengthen firefighting, evacuation and emergency response efforts.
- **Due to strong winds and very dry vegetation, the fire spread rapidly through a Wildland-Urban Interface (WUI) area**, threatening nearby residential neighbourhoods and important infrastructure.

Khijadiya Bird Sanctuary Emerges as Major Black-Necked Stork Breeding Site



- **Khijadiya Bird Sanctuary in Jamnagar, Gujarat**, has been identified as a **major breeding site for the Black-necked Stork.**
- The **sanctuary is a Ramsar site .**
- the study documented a 100% fledging success rate with zero instances of nest abandonment, predation, or chick mortality.
- **Conservation Status --**IUCN status: **"Near Threatened".**

- **Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972: Schedule II**

The Central government has proposed a complete ban on Carbosulfan.

- It is **an insecticide belonging to the carbamate group.**
- It has been **used to control a range of insect pests affecting crops.**
- Its use has been reported across several agricultural sectors, particularly in paddy, cotton and horticultural production.

Properties

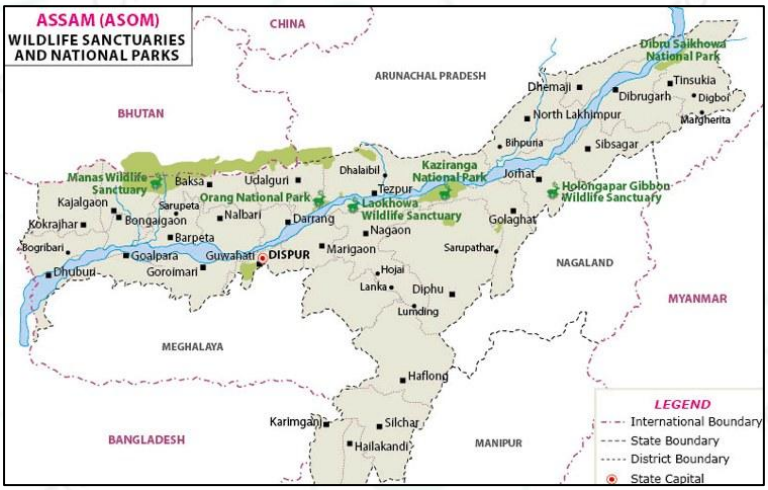
- It is a synthetic 1-benzofuran compound and carbamate acetyl-cholines-terase inhibitor.
- It is characterized as a toxic and nonpersistent orange-yellow or brown viscous liquid,
- It would not normally persist in soil or water systems.
- It can rapidly metabolize to carbofuran, a highly toxic metabolite responsible for severe cholinesterase inhibition and acute systemic toxicity.

Impact of Carbosulfan

- Carbosulfan is **minimally irritating to the eye, slightly irritating to the skin and is a dermal sensitizer**.
- It is extremely toxic to fish and its toxicity is mediated by the inhibition of acetylcholinesterase in the nervous system.

Laokhowa Wildlife Sanctuary

- **Assam's Laokhowa Wildlife Sanctuary** recorded its first-ever sighting of the **rare migratory Smew** (Mergellus albellus) during the **7th Kaziranga Waterbird Count 2026**, alongside sightings of the **critically endangered Bengal Florican.**



- Laokhowa Wildlife Sanctuary is a protected area that forms an **integral part of the contiguous Laokhowa-Burhachapori ecosystem.**
- It serves as an **officially notified buffer zone of the Kaziranga Tiger Reserve** and an essential wildlife migration corridor in the central Brahmaputra floodplain.
- **Located In: Nagaon District, Central Assam.**
- Situated on the southern bank of the Brahmaputra River, positioned strategically between Kaziranga National Park to the east, Orang National Park and Pobitora Wildlife Sanctuary to the west, Pakke-Nameri to the north, and the Karbi Anglong hills to the south.
- Historically known as a **prime habitat for the Great Indian One-Horned Rhinoceros,** Laokhowa suffered severe poaching pressures during the civil unrest of the early 1980s, which wiped out its resident rhino population.

MoEFCC urges NGT to direct States to submit annual plan of operation for Neelakurinji conservation



- Recently, the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change (MoEFCC) has **requested the National Green Tribunal** to **direct Keralam, Tamil Nadu, and Karnataka** to submit an **annual plan of operation** incorporating a **conservation action plan for Neelakurinji** (Strobilanthes kunthiana).
- Neelakurinji is **the purplish flowering shrub which blooms once in 12 years.**
- It is semelparous with showy synchronous **blooming and fruiting at every 12 years at the end of the life cycle, which has been reported since 1832.**

- It is seen only in the high-altitude shola grassland ecosystems of five mountain landscapes of southwest India at an elevation of 1,340–2,600 m.
- Neelakurinji Flowers **occur only in India**, confined to **five mountain landscapes of the Western and Eastern Ghats.**
- **Conservation Status:** Listed as **Vulnerable under IUCN Red List**
- Nilgiri Hills (Literally meaning the **blue mountains**), got their name from the **blue flowers of Neelakurinji.**
- The **Paliyan tribes (in Tamil Nadu) use it as a reference to calculate their age**.

A new plant has been discovered in Amrabad Tiger Reserve in Nagarkurnool district and named it as Ammannia telanganensis.

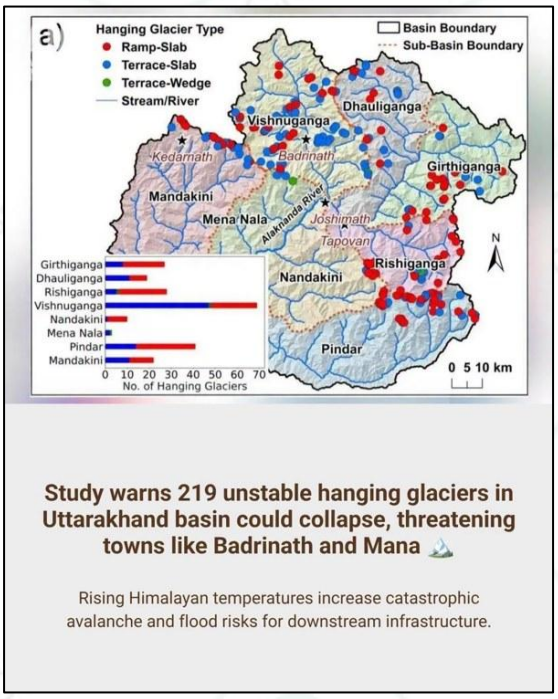
- Ammannia telanganensis is a new **freshwater flowering plant species discovered in Telangana.**
- The plant grows in wet sandy soils along seasonal streams and on the fringes of water bodies, alongside wetland plants such as Ammannia multiflora and species of Rotala.
- It flowers and **fruits between November and February.**

Amrabad Tiger Reserve

- It is located in the **Nallamala hills of the Eastern Ghats in the stat of Telangana**
- It was **originally part of the larger Nagarjunasagar-Srisailam Tiger Reserve before the bifurcation of Andhra Pradesh and Telangana in 2014.**
- The Krishna River and its perennial streams originating within the reserve contribute to the water supply of major reservoirs such as the Srishailam Dam and Nagarjunsagar Dam.
- The Chenchu tribe is one of the major tribal communities that live in the ATR.

Hanging Glaciers

- Study identified **219 hanging glaciers in Uttarakhand's Alaknanda basin,** warning that **warming and permafrost thaw are increasing break-off risks**, potentially triggering **ice-rock avalanches and outburst floods.**
- A hanging glacier is a glacier that **originates high on a mountain wall or valley flank and terminates abruptly at the edge of a steep precipice or cliff face,** rather than flowing down into a main valley floor.
- Prominently found in high-relief alpine environments worldwide, including the **European Alps, the Andes, the North American Rockies, and the Himalayas-Karakoram range.**
- **Heavily concentrated along** the steep, glaciated slopes of the **Garhwal and Kumaon Himalayas (Uttarakhand), Himachal Pradesh, Ladakh, and Sikkim.**



How It Forms?

- Heavy snowfall accumulates in steep niches, high shelves, and cirques on upper mountain faces, compacting into firn and glacial ice under freezing conditions.
- **During warmer periods, larger primary valley glaciers (trunk glaciers) melt, thin, and recede rapidly.**
- The smaller tributary glaciers feeding into them from steep sidewalls become disconnected and left stranded high up on the mountain walls.
- Thermal Destabilization and Basal Melting: **Accelerated climate warming elevates zero-degree isotherms.**
- The permafrost and subglacial ice adhering the glacier to the steep bedrock bed thaw, **creating basal meltwater that acts as a lubricant and converts stable ice masses into precarious, dynamically unstable hanging bodies.**

Index/rankings/reports

Hurun India Most Valuable Family Businesses 2026: Ambani Family claims top spot, Birla Family ranks second

- Barclays Private Clients Hurun India recently released data on the **most valuable family businesses**
- **India's top 300 family businesses are now valued at a massive Rs 138 lakh crore ($1.46 trillion)** combined.
- According to the '2026 Barclays Private Clients Hurun India Most Valuable Family Business List' - **Ambani family, owner of Reliance Industries**, has a net value of Rs 25,82,800 crore claimed the title of the **Most Valuable Family Business**
- **Birla family claimed the second spot** with a net value of Rs 8,13,700 crore

Rank	Family	Company	Value
1	Ambani Family	Reliance Industries	Rs 25,82,800
2	Birla Family	Aditya Birla Group	Rs 8,13,700
3	Jindal Family	JSW Steel	Rs 8,01,800
4	Bajaj Family	Bajaj Group	Rs 7,70,400
5	Mahindra Family	Mahindra & Mahindra	Rs 5,14,600

Mumbai Enters IWG Work From Anywhere Index 2026

- The first appearance of Mumbai in the **IWG 2026 Work from Anywhere Index has taken place and ranked 50th globally.**
- It is the **only Indian city included in the global ranking** that evaluates destinations suitable for professionals who are combining remote working with traveling.
- **Bangkok led the 2026 index** with 106.5 points, followed by,
- Tokyo – 96.5
- Barcelona – 95.5
- **Mumbai's score of 77**
- The ranking evaluates cities on factors such as climate, broadband connectivity, accommodation, transport, culture, food and availability of flexible workspaces.
- India recorded the highest score of 100 on its flexible workspace maturity index, ahead of the UK, France and the US.

Information Technology Resilience Index

- Recently, the Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) has introduced an **Information Technology Resilience Index (ITRI) for market infrastructure institutions (MIIs).**
- It is introduced to assess the functioning and resilience of information technology systems of market infrastructure institutions (MIIs), including stock exchanges, depositories and clearing corporations.
- Aim: It is aimed at strengthening oversight of the resilience of IT systems and identifying emerging weaknesses at an early stage, so that timely corrective measures can be taken

Jawaharlal Nehru Port in Mumbai emerges as world's fastest-growing container port

- Jawaharlal Nehru Port in Mumbai has emerged as the **world's fastest-growing container port.**
- The port has risen to the 21st position globally.
- JNPA was ranked 28th at the end of 2025 and has now moved to 21st place.



Who is Anima Anandkumar? Caltech scientist on TIME's 'most influential people in AI' list

- **Anima Anandkumar** is a world-renowned **Indian-born computer scientist** who serves as the **Bren Professor of Computing and Mathematical Sciences at the California Institute of Technology (Caltech).**

▪ She was recently **named to the 2026 TIME100 AI list, which honors the world's 100 most influential people in artificial intelligence**

▪ Her work focuses heavily on "**AI for Science**"—bridging **the gap between artificial intelligence and the physical world**

National Health Claim Exchange (NHCX)

▪ A sub-committee on **health insurance headed by Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (IRDAI) Chairman** considered measures that will **encourage insurers and hospitals to join the National Health Claims Exchange (NHCX).**

▪ National Health Claim Exchange (NHCX) is **developed under the Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission (ABDM).**

▪ It is developed by the **National Health Authority (NHA) in consultation with the Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (IRDAI).**

▪ NHCX serves as a gateway for exchanging health claim information among insurers, third-party auditors, healthcare providers, beneficiaries, and other relevant entities.

▪ **Purpose:** To streamline and standardize the processing of health insurance claims across the country, leveraging the Fast Healthcare Interoperability Resources (FHIR) standards to ensure interoperability across diverse systems.

International

Massachusetts Declares August 15 as India Day

▪ Massachusetts declared August 15, 2026, as India Day across the state, and Boston issued a similar proclamation for the same date.

▪ The observance coincides with the 79th anniversary of India's independence from British colonial rule in 1947.

▪ Governor Maura Healey issued the Massachusetts proclamation on August 1, 2026.

India invites Bangladesh PM Rahman to attend BRICS summit

▪ India has extended an invitation to **Bangladesh Prime Minister Tarique Rahman** to attend the outreach session of the upcoming **BRICS summit in his capacity as the current chair of the BIMSTEC grouping.**

▪ India is hosting the **annual BRICS summit in New Delhi on September 12 and 13**, which is expected to deliberate extensively on a number of pressing global challenges, including the economic consequences of the West Asia crisis.

▪ The grouping was first informally formed during a meeting of the leaders of BRIC (Brazil, Russia, India, and China) countries on the sidelines of the G8 Outreach Summit **in St.Petersburg, Russia, in 2006**.

▪ BRICS, originally comprising Brazil, Russia, India, China, and South Africa, expanded in 2024 to include Egypt, Ethiopia, Iran, and **the United Arab Emirates, with Indonesia joining in 2025.**

▪ **2001: The acronym was originally coined by Goldman Sachs economist Jim O'Neill.**

Nauru's Climate-Funded "Golden Passport" Scheme

▪ Nauru, a small Pacific island nation recently renamed the Republic of Naoero, has launched a Citizenship-by-Investment (CBI) Programme to raise funds for climate adaptation and resilience.

▪ Introduced last year, the programme allows eligible **foreign nationals to obtain Nauruan citizenship by making a financial contribution.**

▪ Under a limited-time offer, applicants can acquire citizenship by contributing **US$90,000, reduced from the standard fee of US$115,000.**

The Pacific island nation of Nauru has officially changed its name to the Republic of Naoero

▪ It is an island republic located in the southwestern Pacific Ocean.

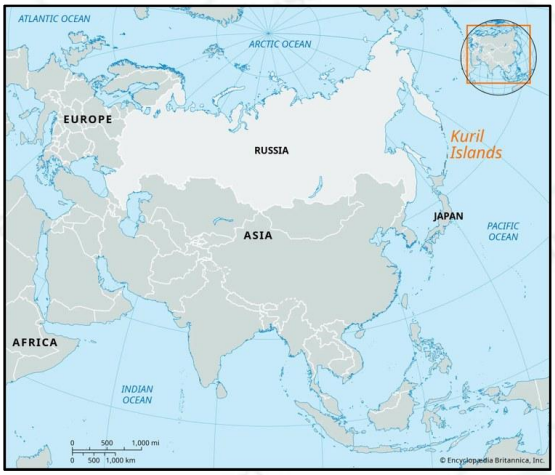
▪ It consists of a raised **coral island** located in **southeastern Micronesia, 40 km south of the Equator**.

▪ It is the **world's smallest independent republic, with a population of approximately 12,000** and a land area of just 21 sq.km.



- It has **no rivers or lakes.**
- Nauru has no official capital, but government offices are located in the district of Yaren.
- Nauruan is the national language.
- **Currency: Australian dollar**
- Its constitution, adopted upon gaining independence in 1968, established it as a republic with a Westminster-style parliamentary system of government.

Kuril Islands



- **Russian President Vladimir Putin has visited the disputed Kuril Islands for the first time**, travelling to Iturup as Moscow's relations with Japan remain deeply strained over Russia's war in Ukraine.
- **The Kuril Islands is an island group in the Russian Far East that forms the boundary between the Pacific Ocean and the Sea of Okhotsk.**
- These **are part of the Pacific Ring of Fire belt.**
- **The climate in the islands is severe, with long, cold, snowy winters and cool, wet, foggy summers**.
- Although **Russia administers all the Kuril Islands,** some islands are at the heart of the Russo-Japanese feud known as the Kuril Islands dispute.
- **Japan considers the four southernmost islands as part of its Northern Territories.**
- As a result of this dispute, **Russia and Japan have never formally concluded a peace treaty to end World War II.**

The Mecca Joint Deterrence Agreement

- **Turkiye, Saudi Arabia, and Pakistan signed the historic Mecca Joint Deterrence Agreement in Mecca** to establish a collective security and defence mechanism.
- The Mecca Joint Deterrence Agreement is a trilateral defense framework designed to align the military, financial, and strategic deterrence capabilities of three major regional powers—Turkiye, Saudi Arabia, and Pakistan—to safeguard national sovereignty and regional stability.

Nations Involved:

- Turkiye: Provides advanced defense-industrial technology, manufacturing scale, and NATO's second-largest standing army.
- Saudi Arabia: Contributes massive financial resources, regional diplomatic leverage, and strategic energy dominance.
- Pakistan: Contributes extensive combat experience, military manpower, and nuclear deterrence capabilities.

India Gifts Five Peacocks to UN Geneva

- India has donated five Indian peacocks, including **a rare white-feathered one, to the United Nations Office at Geneva**, reviving a decades-old tradition at the UN's European headquarters.
- The birds were formally handed over at a special ceremony by India's Permanent Representative to the **UN in Geneva, Arindam Bagchi, to UNOG Director-General Tatiana Valovaya.**
- The donation marks the **second time India has presented peacocks to UNOG.**
- The five young birds include **four blue peafowl and one white-feathered male**, reflecting the blue and white colours associated with the United Nations
- **In 1981, then prime minister Indira Gandhi had sent a breeding pair from the Delhi Zoo to UNOG.**

Lebanon becomes first Arab country to abolish death penalty

▪ Lebanon's parliament **abolished the death penalty, making it the first country in the Arab world** to replace the sentencing with life imprisonment with aggravated hard labour.

Recently, India welcomed Kenya's decision to recognise Persons of Indian Origin as indigenous community.



▪ Location: It is located in Eastern Africa.
▪ Bordering Countries: It is **bordered with Somalia (North East), Ethiopia (North), South Sudan (North West), Uganda (West) and Tanzania (South).**
▪ Maritime Border: It has a coastline on the Indian Ocean to the southeast.
▪ **Capital City: Nairobi**
▪ **Nairobi hosts UNEP (United Nations Environment Programme) and UN-HABITAT headquarters**

EAM S Jaishankar to co-chair 27th India-Russia Inter-Governmental Commission in Moscow

▪ The External Affairs Minister, **S. Jaishankar, was on an official visit to Russia on 23-24 August 2026** to co-chair the **27th Session of the India-Russia Inter-Governmental Commission on Trade, Economic, Scientific, Technological and Cultural Cooperation (IRIGC-TEC)** with the Russian First Deputy Prime Minister Denis Manturov in Moscow .

National Security Advisor Ajit Doval arrived in Beijing

▪ National Security Advisor Ajit Doval arrived in Beijing for a two-day visit to **participate in the 25th round of Special Representatives (SR) talks** on the **India-China boundary question** with Chinese Foreign Minister and his counterpart Wang Yi.

BRICS Tourism Ministers Adopt Jaipur Declaration

▪ **BRICS Tourism Ministers' Meeting** was held under **India's Chairship** and concluded with the unanimous adoption of the **Jaipur Declaration**.
▪ The meeting was held in **Jaipur, Rajasthan**, and was presided over by **Union Minister for Culture and Tourism Gajendra Singh Shekhawat**.
▪ It marked the culmination of the **BRICS Tourism Track under India's Chairship in 2026**.
▪ The Tourism Track was guided by the theme: **"Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability."**
▪ It reflects the work undertaken by the **BRICS Tourism Working Group** during India's Chairship.

The declaration focuses on **four key priority areas**:

▪ **Artificial Intelligence and Tourism**
▪ **Sustainability and Responsible Tourism**
▪ **Tourism Skilling and Capacity Building**
▪ **Tourism Exchanges and Seamless Travel Facilitation**

BRICS Youth Alliance organises the BRICS RI Debate 2026 in Sikkim

▪ The BRICS Youth Alliance organised the **BRICS RI Debate 2026 under the theme "BRICS and the Global South: Reforming Global Governance or Reproducing Existing Inequalities**?"
▪ The national rounds took place on August 22-23, 2026, online.
▪ It featured **postgraduate students discussing global governance, economic justice, and multilateral cooperation**.
▪ In the Indian National Round of the BRICS Research Institute (RI) Debate 2026, Passang Dolmu Tamang is representing Sikkim.
▪ Tamang is the sole participant from the entire Northeast and the only Nepali student selected from across India for the National Round of the debate.

California Assembly adopts resolution recognising November 8 as Diwali Day

- In the United States, the California State Assembly has adopted a resolution **recognising November 8 this year as Diwali Day and urging people across the state to join in the celebrations.**
- The resolution expressed deep respect for Indian Americans and the Indian diaspora in California and around the world on the occasion of Diwali.

France's first major Hindu temple set to open near Paris in September

- France is set to welcome its **first major Hindu temple, with the BAPS Swaminarayan Hindu Mandir in Bussy-Saint-Georges, near Paris,** scheduled to be inaugurated in September.
- The historic opening will be marked by a 13-day 'Festival of Culture' from September 2 to 14, 2026.

PM Modi conferred with Uzbekistan's prestigious 'Oliy Darajali Do'stlik' Order



- Prime Minister Narendra Modi was conferred with **Uzbekistan's prestigious 'Oliy Darajali Do'stlik' Order,** which he dedicated to the "enduring" bond between India and Uzbekistan.
- **'Dostlik' means friendship**.
- Prime Minister Narendra Modi's **36th international state honour**
- PM Modi is in Uzbekistan on a two-day visit to bolster ties in a range of areas including trade, clean energy and connectivity.
- He also met members of the Indian community at a hotel in Tashkent, where **he witnessed Kathak** and **Andijan Polka performances** by the diaspora and a dance by Uzbek children to the **Indian song "Ude Jab Jab Zulfe Teri".**
- Mr. Modi also watched **a fusion performance of tabla with traditional Uzbek instruments, Doira and Chang.**
- The Prime Minister is scheduled to travel to Kyrgyzstan from Tashkent to participate in the **26th Shanghai Cooperation Organisation summit on August 31-September 1.**
- **Uzbekistan, landlocked country in Central Asia.**
- Uzbekistan is bordered by **Kazakhstan** to the northwest and north, **Kyrgyzstan and Tajikistan** to the east and southeast, **Afghanistan** to the south, and **Turkmenistan** to the southwest.
- **Capital: Tashkent**



Trump Signs Order to Rename Lake Ontario



- US President Donald Trump signed an executive order directing federal agencies and the US Geological Survey (USGS) to refer to **Lake Ontario as Lake America** amid **escalating trade tensions and tariff disputes with Canada.**
- Lake Ontario is the **smallest by surface area** and the **easternmost of the five Great Lakes of North America** (Superior, Michigan, Huron, Erie, and Ontario).
- Geographical Position: **North America, forming a natural international boundary between the two nations.**
- Bordering Nations: **Canada and United States.**
- One of the five Great Lakes—Superior, Michigan, Huron, Erie and Ontario.

PM pays tribute to Lal Bahadur Shastri in Tashkent, plants tree with Uzbek President



- Prime Minister Narendra Modi paid floral tributes at the **Shastri Memorial in Uzbekistan's capital, honouring the legacy of former Prime Minister Lal Bahadur Shastri by planting a tree** along with Uzbek President Shavkat Mirziyoyev.
- Shastri, **India's second Prime Minister**, suddenly **died in the Uzbek capital on January 11, 1966**, just hours after signing the **historic Tashkent Declaration to end the 1965 Indo-Pakistan War.**
- Mr. Modi and Mr. Mirziyoyev also jointly planted a tree in the Presidential Palace garden under India's **'Ek Ped Maa Ke Naam' initiative and Uzbekistan's 'Yashil Makon' green efforts**

PM Modi pays tribute to Mahatma Gandhi in Kyrgyzstan's Bishkek



- Prime Minister Narendra Modi paid tribute to **Mahatma Gandhi at his memorial in Bishkek** ahead of the **26th Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO) Leadership Summit.**
- The statue was unveiled by PM Modi during his visit to Kyrgyzstan in 2015.
- The prime minister also met people from various communities in Bishkek and was **presented with a book titled Manas: Kyrgyz Veergatha Kavya.**

Short news

- **New York and New Jersey have officially declared August 15 as "India Independence Day"**, marking India's 80th anniversary of independence and recognising the longstanding ties between the United States and India.

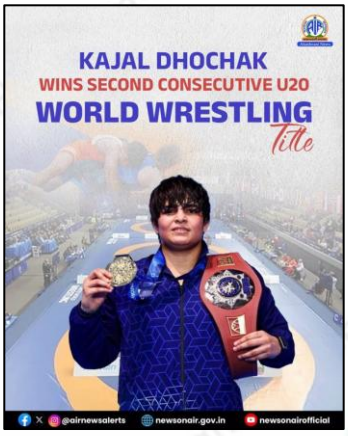
Sports

National/ International Championships

Glasgow Concludes Commonwealth Games 2026, Hands Over the Baton to Ahmedabad

- The **2026 Commonwealth Games** concluded, with **Scotland** officially handing over the **Commonwealth Games Flag** and the **Ceremonial Baton** to **India**, host of the landmark **2030 centenary edition**.
- The **2030 Commonwealth Games** will be hosted in **Ahmedabad, Gujarat.**
- India previously hosted the **2010 Commonwealth Games** in **New Delhi**.

Kajal Dhochak wins second consecutive U20 World Wrestling title



- India's Kajal Dhochak has won her **second consecutive U20 World Wrestling Championship title. She clinched the women's 76-kilogram gold medal .**
- She defeated China's Jingru Sun .
- Tanu Sharma won a silver medal in the women's 72 kg category after losing 3–5 to Japan's Chisato Yoshida.
- **Savita also secured silver in the 62 kg category after losing to Japan's Sakura Onishi**

Commonwealth Games 2026: Highlights & Milestones

- **Venue & Duration:** The Commonwealth Games 2026 were held in Glasgow, Scotland, from 23 July to 2 August 2026.
- Finnie is the official mascot of the Commonwealth Games 2026.

Opening Ceremony

- **Flag Bearer (India):** Mirabai Chanu
- **Baton Bearer (India):** Lovlina Borgohain
- The duo led the Indian contingent during the opening ceremony held at The Hydro, Glasgow, on 23 July 2026.

Australia finished the 2026 Commonwealth Games in Glasgow at the top of the medal tally, followed by England and Canada



- Australia: 70 gold, 45 silver, 56 bronze (171 total)
- England: 29 gold, 45 silver, 36 bronze (110 total)
- Canada: 19 gold, 20 silver, 23 bronze (62 total)
- India: 13 gold, 17 silver, 9 bronze (39 total)
- Scotland: 13 gold, 9 silver, 17 bronze (39 total)
- Overall, India's all-time **Commonwealth Games medal tally** now stands at **602 medals (215 gold, 207 silver, 180 bronze)**, placing them fourth in the all-time rankings behind Australia, England, and Canada.
- **India's most successful edition remains the 2010 Delhi Games**, where the country recorded its best-ever performance with **101 medals (38 gold, 27 silver, 36 bronze)** and finished second behind Australia.

Commonwealth Games Overall Historic Medal Tally

Rank	Countries	Gold	Silver	Bronze	Total
1	Australia	1,073	879	823	2,775
2	England	802	828	802	2,432
3	Canada	529	568	612	1,709
4	India	215	207	180	602
5	New Zealand	189	246	307	742

India's Medal Tally by Sport at the Commonwealth Games 2026

Sport	Gold	Silver	Bronze	Total Medals
Boxing	7	3	0	10
Athletics	0	5	5	10
Weightlifting	1	6	1	8
Para Athletics	3	2	1	6
Judo	2	1	1	4
Para Powerlifting	0	0	1	1
Overall Total	13	17	9	39

India's Medal Winners at the Commonwealth Games 2026

S. No.	Athlete	Sport	Event	Medal
1	Jhandu Kumar	Para Powerlifting	Men's Heavyweight	Bronze
2	Rishikanta Singh	Weightlifting	Men's 60 kg	Silver
3	Mirabai Chanu	Weightlifting	Women's 48 kg	Gold
4	Muthupandi Raja	Weightlifting	Men's 65 kg	Silver
5	Gyaneshwari Yadav	Weightlifting	Women's 53 kg	Silver
6	Bindyarani Devi	Weightlifting	Women's 58 kg	Bronze
7	Sharmila Dhankar	Para Athletics	Women's Shot Put	Gold

			(F57)	
8	Sarvesh Kushare	Athletics	Men's High Jump	Silver
9	Shilpa K. Shyla	Para Athletics	Women's Shot Put (F57)	Bronze
10	Valluri Ajaya Babu	Weightlifting	Men's 79 kg	Silver
11	Harjinder Kaur	Weightlifting	Women's 69 kg	Silver
12	Gulveer Singh	Athletics	Men's 10,000 m	Silver
13	Murali Sreeshankar	Athletics	Men's Long Jump	Silver
14	Dilip Gavit	Para Athletics	Men's 100 m (T47)	Gold
15	Mohammed Basil	Para Athletics	Men's 100 m (T47)	Silver
16	Lovepreet Singh	Weightlifting	Men's +110 kg	Silver
17	Seema Kaliramna	Athletics	Women's Discus Throw	Bronze
18	Asmita Dey	Judo	Women's 48 kg	Gold
19	Harsh Singh	Judo	Men's 60 kg	Gold
20	Yamini Mourya	Judo	Women's 57 kg	Silver
21	Tejaswin Shankar	Athletics	Men's Decathlon	Bronze
22	Yash Vir Singh	Athletics	Men's Javelin Throw	Bronze
23	Neeraj Chopra	Athletics	Men's Javelin Throw	Silver
24	Preeti Pawar	Boxing	Women's 54 kg	Gold
25	Praveen Chithravel	Athletics	Men's Triple Jump	Silver
26	Selva Prabhu	Athletics	Men's Triple Jump	Bronze
27	Jaismine Lamboria	Boxing	Women's 57 kg	Gold
28	Jadumani Singh	Boxing	Men's 55 kg	Silver
29	Shubham Juyal	Para Athletics	Men's Shot Put (F57)	Silver
30	Soman Rana	Para Athletics	Men's Shot Put (F57)	Gold
31	Unnati Sharma	Judo	Women's 63 kg	Bronze
32	Sakshi Chaudhary	Boxing	Women's 51 kg	Gold
33	Priya Ghanghas	Boxing	Women's 60 kg	Gold
34	Arundhati Choudhary	Boxing	Women's 70 kg	Gold
35	Lovlina Borgohain	Boxing	Women's 75 kg	Silver
36	Sachin Siwach	Boxing	Men's 60 kg	Gold
37	Ankush Panghal	Boxing	Men's 80 kg	Gold
38	Narender Berwal	Boxing	Men's +90 kg	Silver
39	Gulveer Singh	Athletics	Men's 5,000 m	Bronze

India emerge overall champions in Commonwealth Fencing

- India have emerged as the overall champions at the **Commonwealth Fencing Championship**, returning with **35 medals** from the event **held in Lagos, Nigeria.**
- **Indian fencers won 13 gold, 8 silver and 14 bronze medals across the U-23 and senior competitions.**
- **India win the Wilkinson Sword Trophy, for the first time,** awarded by the Commonwealth Fencing Federation to the country with the best overall results.

Maharajan Arumugapandian clinches Silver medal at Asian Junior Weightlifting Championships

- Indian weightlifter **Maharajan Arumugapandian** won the silver medal in the men's 65-kilogram category at the **Asian Junior Weightlifting Championships in Tashkent, Uzbekistan.**
- Maharajan produced a personal best total of 285 kilograms, lifting 128 kilograms in the snatch and 157 kilograms in the clean and jerk

Meghwal creates history with high jump silver, Shahnavaz wins long jump bronze

- Basant Kumar Meghwal's silver in the high jump and Shahnavaz Khan's bronze in the long jump marked a landmark moment for India at the World Athletics U20 Championships 2026.

▪ Basant Kumar Meghwal became the first Indian athlete to win a high jump medal at the World Athletics U20 Championships**, equalling a personal-best 2.21m.**

▪ Meanwhile, Shahnavaz Khan became the first Indian man to win a long jump medal at the World Athletics U20 Championships after securing bronze with a best effort of 7.84m.

Ashish Yadav Wins India's Second World U20 Javelin Medal

▪ Ashish Yadav is a 19-year-old Indian javelin thrower from Uttar Pradesh who won silver in the men's javelin at the 2026 World Athletics U-20 Championships in Oregon.

▪ **He produced a best throw of 74.09m**

▪ Ashish is now the second Indian to win a javelin medal at the World Athletics U-20 Championships after Neeraj Chopra, who won gold in 2016

India's Ariha Wins Historic Gold at Aerobic Gymnastics Asian Championships

▪ Ariha Pangambam has become the first Indian ever to win gold in the Senior Individual Women's event at the Asian Aerobic Gymnastics Championships.

▪ **The 22-year-old from Manipur topped the podium**

▪ The 2026 Asian Aerobic Gymnastics Championships were held in Tagaytay City, Philippines, from 4 to 7 August 2026

▪ **scored 19.100 in the final.**

Tennis

Ben Shelton Wins Montreal Title

▪ **American tennis player Ben Shelton** successfully **defended his Canadian Open title by defeating fellow American Brandon Nakashima** in the final of the National Bank Open in Montreal.

▪ **Shelton became the first Canadian Open champion since Novak Djokovic in 2016 to win the tournament without dropping a set**, while also becoming the first player since Rafa Nadal in 2019 to successfully defend the title.

Iga Swiatek beats Elena Rybakina to claim Women's Singles title at Canadian Open Tennis

▪ In Canadian Open Tennis, **Iga Swiatek of Poland** defeated second seed Elena Rybakina in straight sets **to claim the Women's Singles title in Toronto**

India's Ramkumar Ramanathan and Vijay Sundar Prashanth win Bonn Open doubles title

▪ In tennis, **India's Ramkumar Ramanathan and Vijay Sundar Prashanth clinched the doubles title at the Bonn Open 2026.**

▪ The unseeded Indians defeated England's Scott Duncan and Sweden's Adam in final.

▪ This title marks **Ramkumar's second ATP Challenger doubles trophy of the year.**

▪ 31-year-old Ramkumar has now won 13 ATP Challenger titles in his career.

Table Tennis

Commonwealth Table Tennis | Ankur, Yashaswini secure titles with contrasting wins

▪ Ankur Bhattacharjee and Yashaswini Ghorpade clinched the men's and women's singles title with contrasting wins at the 22nd Commonwealth Table Tennis Championships

▪ **The seven-day championship was held at the Thyagaraj Stadium from July 27 to August 2.**

▪ Women's Doubles: Final: Sreeja Akula/Syndrela Das (Ind) bt Yashaswini Ghorpade/Divyanshi Bhowmick (Ind)

▪ Mixed Doubles: Final: Taneesha Kotecha/Manav Thakkar (Ind) bt Ai Xin Tee/Richard Rui Zhe Yap (Mas)

▪ India dominated the competition, winning six of the seven gold medals

Men's team

▪ Gold: India

▪ Women's team

- Gold: India

Men's singles

- Gold: Ankur Bhattacharjee (IND)
- Silver: Payas Jain (IND)

Women's singles

- Gold: Yashaswini Ghorpade (IND)
- Silver: Sreeja Akula (IND)

Men's doubles

- Gold: Wong Qi Shen/Choong Javen (MAS)
- Silver: Manav Thakkar/Manush Shah (IND)

Women's doubles

- Gold: Sreeja Akula/Syndrela Das (IND)
- Silver: Yashaswini Ghorpade/Divyanshi Bhowmick (IND)

Mixed doubles

- **Gold**: Manav Thakkar/Taneesha Kotecha (IND)
- **Silver**: Richard Yap Rui Zhe/Tee Ai Xin (MAS)

Sports Ministry Suspends Table Tennis Federation of India Recognition

- The Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports suspended recognition of the **Table Tennis Federation of India (TTFI)** on 12 August 2026 **over governance deficiencies.**
- The order cited the **federation's failure to hold organisational elections within the mandated timeframe and an unsatisfactory reply** to a show-cause notice.
- The 2026 order kept the **sport under interim administration until a valid and compliant federation structure is restored.**
- In India, **recognition of a national sports federation is granted by the Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports** for administration of a sport at the national level.
- Recognition is **linked with compliance on elections, office-bearer tenure, athlete selection, and adherence to the National Sports Development Code of India, 2011.**
- The Ministry directed the **Indian Olympic Association to form an ad-hoc committee to administer table tennis** in India.

Tanishka, Prateek clinch U-15 titles in National Ranking tournament

- **Tanishka Kalbhairav** of Karnataka and **Prateek Tulsani** of Maharashtra won the **under-15 girls' and boys' singles titles,** respectively, at the season-opening **UTT National Ranking Table Tennis tournament in Kanpur.**

Badminton

Young Indian shuttler Tanvi Sharma wins maiden BWF Super 300 title at Taipei Open

- Teen Indian sensation **Tanvi Sharma** won her maiden BWF World Tour title after defeating Vietnam'in the women's singles final of the **Taipei Open Super 300 badminton tournament in Taipei.**
- Tanvi also became the **first Indian to win the women's singles title at the Taipei Open since Saina Nehwal,** who had lifted the trophy in 2008.

Ashmita Chaliha wins Korea Masters, defeating Chinese Han

- **Ashmita Chaliha won her first BWF World Tour title** after completing a comeback win over China's Han Qian Xi in the women's singles at the BWF Korea Masters 2026.
- **become the first Indian to win the Korea Masters - a BWF Super 300 tournament.**

▪ She joins an elite group of Indian women's singles players to have won BWF Super 300 or higher-level badminton titles, **alongside Olympic medallists Saina Nehwal and PV Sindhu, as well as Devika Sihag and Tanvi Sharma.**

▪ Ashmita Chaliha is now the fourth Indian woman to win a singles BWF World Tour title this year, following PV Sindhu at the Japan Open, Devika Sihag at the Thailand Masters and Tanvi Sharma at the Taipei Open.

▪ Satwiksairaj Rankireddy and Chirag Shetty are the other Indian winners on the BWF World Tour this year, having claimed the men's doubles title at the Singapore Badminton Open in May.

Treesa-Gayatri Secure Medal at BWF World Championships 2026

▪ India's **Treesa Jolly and Gayatri Gopichand** have etched their names in history by clinching the **bronze medal at the BWF Badminton World Championships.**

▪ They have become **only the second Indian women's doubles pair to win a World Championship medal,**

▪ **Jwala Gutta and Ashwini Ponnappa** won India's first women's doubles medal at the World Championships in 2011.

▪ **New Delhi hosted the BWF World Championships 2026 at the Indira Gandhi Indoor Stadium.**

Squash

Velavan Senthilkumar wins PSA Budapest Squash Open title in Hungary

▪ India's **Velavan Senthilkumar** won his **maiden PSA Copper-level squash title** after beating Hungarian No. 1 Balázs Farkas in the Budapest Open 2026 final

▪ **Squash will make its Olympic debut at LA 2028**, and the men's and women's singles champions at the Asian Games 2026 will earn qualification spots for the Olympics.

Cricket

Jammu and Kashmir to Host Irani Cup in Srinagar

▪ Jammu and Kashmir is scheduled to host the Irani Cup match at Sher-I-Kashmir Stadium in Srinagar from 1 to 5 October 2026.

▪ The fixture will be played between **Jammu and Kashmir and the Rest of India in a five-day first-class format.**

▪ The Irani Cup is a first-class cricket match **played between the Ranji Trophy champions and the Rest of India team.**

▪ Jammu and Kashmir qualified for the Irani Cup after winning the 2025–26 Ranji Trophy title on 28 February 2026.

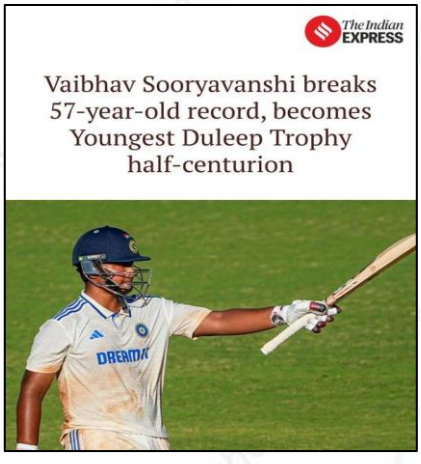
▪ The Irani Cup is named after **Zal R. Irani, a former BCCI president and cricket administrator.**

Rishabh Pant becomes first Indian & fourth in world to hit 100 sixes in Test Cricket

▪ Wicketkeeper-batter **Rishabh Pant became the first Indian player and fourth in the world to complete the rare milestone of 100 sixes in Test cricket** during the fourth day of the opening game against Sri Lanka.

▪ Pant also became the **fastest to 100 maximums in only his 51st game while former England skipper Ben Stokes had reached the mark in his 82nd Test.**

▪ Among Indians, both Virender Sehwag and Rohit Sharma, with 91 sixes each, are joint second in the list.



Vaibhav Sooryavanshi breaks 57-year-old record, becomes youngest Duleep Trophy half-centurion

▪ Teenage sensation Vaibhav Sooryavanshi etched his name into the record books, becoming the **youngest player to score a half-century in Duleep Trophy history at just 15 years and 157 days.**

▪ Playing for **East Zone in the semifinal against Central Zone at the BCCI Centre of Excellence Ground 1 in Bengaluru.**

▪ The record had stood for 57 years, previously held by **Laxman Singh, who**

scored a fifty at 16 years and 23 days in the 1969 edition.

- **Piyush Chawla had also registered a Duleep Trophy half-century at 16 years and 307 days in 2005**.

Chess

Indian-Origin Bodhana Sivanandan, Shreyas Royal Make British Chess History



- Indian-origin chess prodigies Bodhana Sivanandan and Shreyas Royal created history by winning titles at the 2026 British Chess Championships.
- **Bodhana Sivanandan became Britain's youngest-ever Women's Chess Champion at the age of 11.**
- **Shreyas Royal** won the **British Championship open title, becoming the youngest-ever British Chess Champion at 17.**

Chess: Grandmaster R Praggnanandhaa wins maiden St. Louis Rapid & Blitz Title in US

- Indian grandmaster R. Praggnanandhaa has clinched the Grand Chess Tour St. Louis Rapid and Blitz title in the United States.
- finished with 23.5 points.
- Earlier in June, **Praggnanandhaa scripted history by claiming the Norway Chess 2026 crown in Oslo**

Magnus Carlsen wins Esports World Cup chess title for second consecutive year

- World No. 1 Magnus Carlsen has won the Esports World Cup (EWC) chess title for the second consecutive year.
- Representing Team Liquid, the 35-year-old Norwegian remained completely undefeated throughout the entire tournament.
- Runner-up : Denis Lazavik

Vignesh Vermula, Saranya Devi win Asian Junior blitz titles

- Indian chess players **Vignesh Vermula and Saranya Devi won the Open and Girls' gold medals**, respectively, in **the Asian Junior Blitz Chess Championship.**
- The Asian Junior Chess Championship is a **continental chess event for junior players from Asia.**
- This tournament was organized by the Maharashtra Chess Association

India's Grandmaster Pranesh M wins Kanizsa Open title in Hungary

- India's 19-year-old Grandmaster Pranesh M clinched the Group A title at the prestigious Kanizsa Open 2026 in Nagykanizsa, Hungary,
- The Tamil Nadu player, who hails from Karaikudi, is rated 2673 and ranked 44th in the latest FIDE rankings for August 2026.

R Praggnanandhaa creates history; Becomes 1st Indian to win Grand Chess Tour

- Indian Grandmaster R. Praggnanandhaa created history, becoming **the first Indian to win the Grand Chess Tour** after **defeating defending champion Fabiano Caruana at St. Louis in the US.**
- The Grand Chess Tour is an elite circuit spanning **Classical, Rapid and Blitz events with the world's best players and a total prize pool of $2 million.**

Football

England, Bayern Munich star Harry Kane set to receive 'Golden Shoe' award

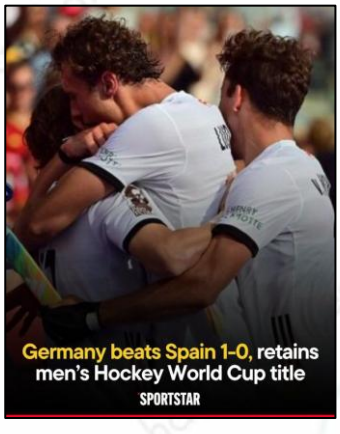
- **Harry Kane** is set to receive the prestigious **'Golden Shoe' honour for emerging as top scorer in European football for the 2025-26 season.**
- this is the **second time Harry is going to receive the prestigious honour,** joining the elite list of players having won it twice, with **only legends Lionel Messi and Cristiano Ronaldo having won it more.**

India withdraw from ASEAN Cup to prioritise Brazil; plan friendlies vs WC teams

- India have withdrawn from the **inaugural FIFA ASEAN Cup and will prioritise their high-profile friendly against Brazil**, avoiding a scheduling clash that had made their participation in both competitions untenable.
- India were invited to participate in the inaugural edition of the FIFA ASEAN Cup in June. **Indonesia were named hosts, with India drawn alongside the hosts, Singapore and Malaysia.**
- AIFF announced a friendly against Brazil, which will be played in Kolkata's Vivekananda Yuva Bharati Krirangan on 3 October.

East Bengal lift 135th Durand Cup for record 17th time, defeating arch-rivals Mohun Bagan

- East Bengal have won the Durand Cup for the 17th time, equalling Mohun Bagan's record as the most succesfull team in the 139-year history of the tournament.
- **Venue: : the final held at Vivekananda Yuba Bharati Krirangan (Salt Lake Stadium) in Kolkata**
- **Golden Glove** - Vishal Kaith (Mohun Bagan Super Giant)
- **Golden Boot** - Alaaeddine Ajaraie (NorthEast United)
- **Golden Ball** - Edmund Lalrinkdika (East Bengal)
- Runner-up: Mohun Bagan is handed a cheque of Rs. 60 lakh.
- Champion: East Bengal is awarded a cheque of Rs. 1.21 crore.
- The Durand Cup 2026 is the 135th edition of one of India's most historic football tournaments.
- **The Durand Cup was founded in 1888 by Sir Henry Mortimer Durand at Annadale in Shimla.**
- In 2025, the tournament was held across five states for the first time.
- **The Durand Cup 2026 is being played across five states – West Bengal, Jharkhand, Assam, Meghalaya and Manipur.**
- The major host cities are Kolkata, Ranchi, Guwahati, Shillong and Imphal.
- A unique feature of the Durand Cup is that the winning team receives three prestigious trophies.
- **These trophies represent different stages of the tournament's long history and add to its distinctive identity**.
- **The Durand Cup** is the original trophy of the competition and dates back to its beginning in 1888. It remains one of the most recognisable symbols of the tournament.
- **The Shimla Trophy** was presented by the residents of Shimla in 1905. It represents the tournament's early connection with its place of origin.
- **The President's Cup was introduced in 1956 by Dr. Rajendra Prasad.** It is awarded as a permanent keepsake to the winning team, while the other two trophies are treated as rolling honours.



Germany Retain FIH Men's Hockey World Cup Title with 1-0 Win Over Spain

- In the **FIH Men's Hockey World Cup 2026**, **Germany retained the World Cup title with a 1-0 win over Spain** in the final at the Belfius Hockey Arena in Wavre, **Belgium.**
- **Spain, appearing in their first World Cup final since 1998,**
- **Argentina defeated the Netherlands** 2-1 to claim the **men's bronze medal.**

Athletics

Neeraj Chopra finishes second at Lausanne Diamond League with season-best throw

- Ace Indian javelin thrower Neeraj Chopra finished **second at the Lausanne Diamond League** with a season-best throw of **88.05 metres**, just nine centimetres behind Sri Lanka's Rumesh Tharanga Pathirage, who won with 88.14 metres.

Miscellaneous

Uttar Pradesh NCC Directorate wins all-India shooting competition

- The Uttar Pradesh NCC Directorate emerged as the **overall champion of the Inter Directorate Sports Shooting Competition (IDSSC) 2026,** which concluded in Tiruchi, Tamil Nadu
- **The Maharashtra Directorate** finished as the **first runner-up** while the Karnataka and Goa Directorate secured the second runner-up position.
- The annual competition began on July 22 and was hosted **at K. Ramakrishnan College of Technology, Samayapuram.**
- A total of 340 NCC cadets from 17 NCC directorates across India competed in various rifle and pistol shooting events, **organised under the aegis of the Tamil Nadu, Puducherry, and Andaman and Nicobar NCC Directorate.**

Young cyclist Harshita Jakhar becomes first Indian woman to feature at Tour de France Femmes

- Young cyclist Harshita Jakhar rode into history books by becoming the first Indian woman to be a part of the Tour de France Femmes in Switzerland.
- **She is 19-year-old Hailing from Rajasthan .**
- The event started on 1st of this month in Lausanne and will end on 9th August in Nice.
- The team, handpicked by UCI (Union Cycliste de Internationale), cycled 4.5 kilometres on a neutralised section of the course along with some riders from the WCC Road Team.
- Tour de France Femmes is the women's multi-stage cycling race that corresponds to the men's Tour de France.
- It is part of the UCI Women's World Tour calendar.

Arunachal's Boleng to Host Asian Rafting Championships 2026

- Boleng in Siang district of Arunachal Pradesh will host the **Asian Rafting Championships 2026 from 5 October to 9 October 2026.**
- The five-day event will take place on the **Simang River, a Class III+ tributary of the Siang River,** and will bring paddlers from across Asia to compete in white-water rafting events.

India Wins Four Medals at International Linguistics Olympiad 2026

- The Language Technologies Research Centre (LTRC) at IIIT Hyderabad mentored the eight-member Indian contingent at the **International Linguistics Olympiad (IOL) 2026, held in Romania.**
- **The Indian team secured one gold medal, three bronze medals, and one honourable mention.**
- India has been participating in the International Linguistics Olympiad since 2009.

Uttarakhand CM inaugurates Asian Open Short Track Speed Skating Trophy 2026

- Uttarakhand Chief Minister Pushkar Singh Dhami inaugurated the Asian Open Short Track Speed Skating Trophy 2026 at **Maharana Pratap Sports Complex in Dehradun.**
- The competition is scheduled from August 17 to 20
- A total of 272 players from **14 Asian countries are participating in the event, including 130 Indian players.**
- **HOST – India, Uttarakhand**

India's Para-Cyclists Win 12 Medals in Denmark

- Indian para-cyclists won **12 medals at the UCI Parasport Denmark Grand Prix in Odense, Denmark,** that began on 7 August 2026 and ended on 10 August 2026.
- The Indian tally included **2 gold, 5 silver and 5 bronze medals in para-cycling events.**
- The UCI Parasport Denmark Grand Prix was a track cycling competition under the Union Cycliste Internationale framework.

Chinese humanoid robots smash human records in 100m sprint and high jump at Beijing robot games

- Chinese humanoid robots broke records set by humans, including beating Usain Bolt's 100-meter sprint world record**, in World Humanoid Robot Games in Beijing**
- At a 100-meter sprint, **a humanoid robot achieved a result of 9.39 seconds, beating the human record of 9.58 seconds set by Jamaican athlete Bolt in 2009.**
- In a **standing high jump**, a **humanoid robot was able to reach 2.88** meters, well above the 0.95 meters best result by a humanoid in last year's first edition of the games.
- It **surpassed the human high jump record of 2.45 meters set by Cuba's Javier Sotomayor in 1993.**

Aromal Chundan wins 72nd Nehru Trophy Boat Race in Alappuzha

- In Keralam, **Aromal Chundan has won the 72nd Nehru Trophy Boat Race at Punnamada Lake in Alappuzha**.
- Aromal Chundan crossed the finish **line in 4 minutes, 23 seconds, and 328 milliseconds to secure the coveted trophy.**
- Nadubhagom Chundan finished a close second with a time of 4 minutes, 23 seconds, and 448 milliseconds, one of the closest contests in the history of the legendary water festival

Anthony Andrews appointed India U17 women's assistant coach

- The All India Football Federation (AIFF) has appointed **Anthony Andrews as the assistant coach of the India Under-17 women's national team,** with Joakim Alexandersson continuing as the head coach.
- Andrews also serves as **head coach of East Bengal FC and will continue to hold that position too.**

Grand Master Trilok Subba selected to represent India at World Taekwondo Poomsae Championship

- Taekwondo player **Grand Master Trilok Subba, from Sikkim,** has been selected **to represent India at the World Taekwondo Poomsae Championship in Chuncheon, South Korea.**
- The Championship is scheduled to take place from **16th to 20th September.**
- Subba will compete in the Under-60 Male Individual Poomsae and team events in the Senior category.

Short news

- **Tingong Wangpan, from Arunachal Pradesh,** has been selected to **represent India at the Asian Para Games 2026 in the Men's 400m T37 category.**

Banking / Finance

RBI MPC keeps policy rate unchanged at 5.25%

- The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) announced its monetary policy
- The RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra-led Monetary Policy Committee (MPC) held its third bi-monthly policy meeting for FY27 from August 3 to August 5
- The policy **repo rate unchanged at 5.25% and maintain a 'neutral' stance.**
- The Standing Deposit Facility (SDF) rate at 5%, while keeping the **Marginal Standing Facility (MSF) rate and the bank rate unchanged at 5.5%.**

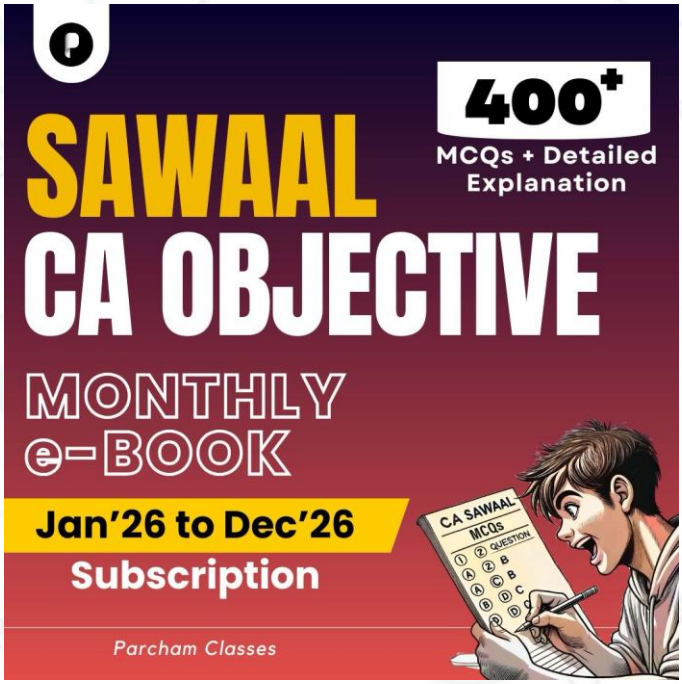
- The RBI revised its **FY27 GDP growth forecast upward to 6.7% from 6.6%**
- **CPI inflation for this year is now projected to be 5%,**
- It revised the Q1 FY27 inflation estimate down to 4.1% from 4.2% and cut the Q2 forecast to 4.7% from 5.1%
- The RBI adopted **a clear 'wait-and-watch' approach**, citing uncertainty over the Southwest monsoon, El Niño, geopolitics and global trade policy.







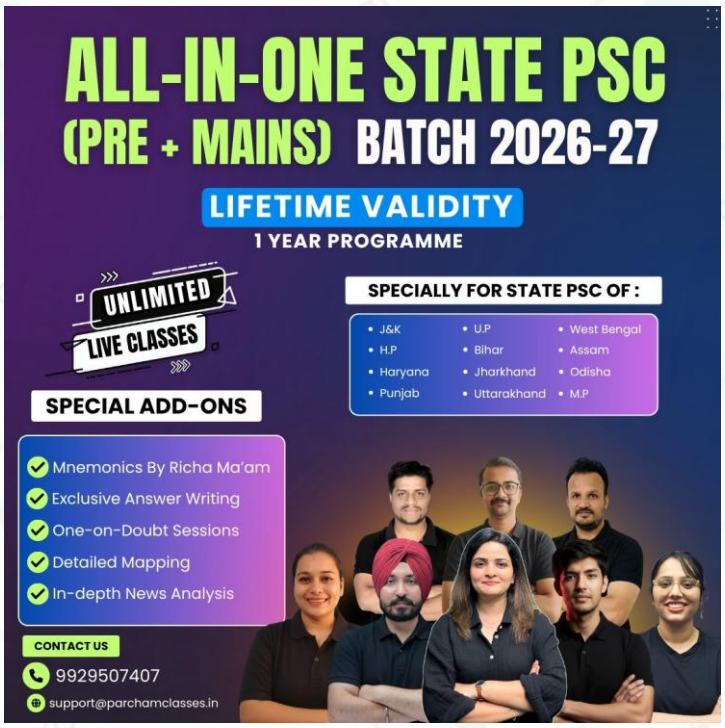





SSC+RAILWAY MEGA COMBO
BATCH 2026-27 (LIFETIME)
UNLIMITED LIVE + RECORDED BATCH | LIFETIME VALIDITY
6 MONTHS PROGRAMME
SUBJECTS
• English, Reasoning, Maths
• Science, Static GK
• History, Geography
• Polity, Economics
• Computer ,Environment
FREE!
SSC GENERAL AWARENESS
MOCK TEST SERIES
UNLIMITED LIVE CLASSES
COURSE OFFERS
• Live + Recorded Lectures
• Downloadable PDFs
• Computer Based Test
• Detailed PYQs Discussion
• World Mapping


RAFTAAR
CA HEADLINER
MONTHLY
e-BOOK
Jan'26 to Dec'26
Subscription
CA RAFTAAR
Parcham Classes


NCERT ADVANCED BATCH 2026
LIFETIME LIVE + RECORDED FOUNDATION COURSE
SPECIAL ADD-ONS
Mnemonics Workshop
Answer Writing
Personal Mentorship
News Analysis
World Mapping
PYQ Analysis
CONTACT US
9929507407
support@parchamclasses.in


ALL-IN-ONE STATE PSC
(PRE + MAINS) BATCH 2026-27
LIFETIME VALIDITY
1 YEAR PROGRAMME
UNLIMITED LIVE CLASSES
SPECIALLY FOR STATE PSC OF :
J&K
H.P
Haryana
Punjab
U.P
Bihar
Jharkhand
Uttarakhand
West Bengal
Assam
Odisha
M.P
SPECIAL ADD-ONS
Mnemonics By Richa Ma'am
Exclusive Answer Writing
One-on-Doubt Sessions
Detailed Mapping
In-depth News Analysis
CONTACT US
9929507407
support@parchamclasses.in